

CHESS99 BOOK 4 | ELO 900-1200 | SILVER

Opening Habits For Real Games

Safe development and useful opening principles without memorization.

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Control The Center

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Control The Center converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

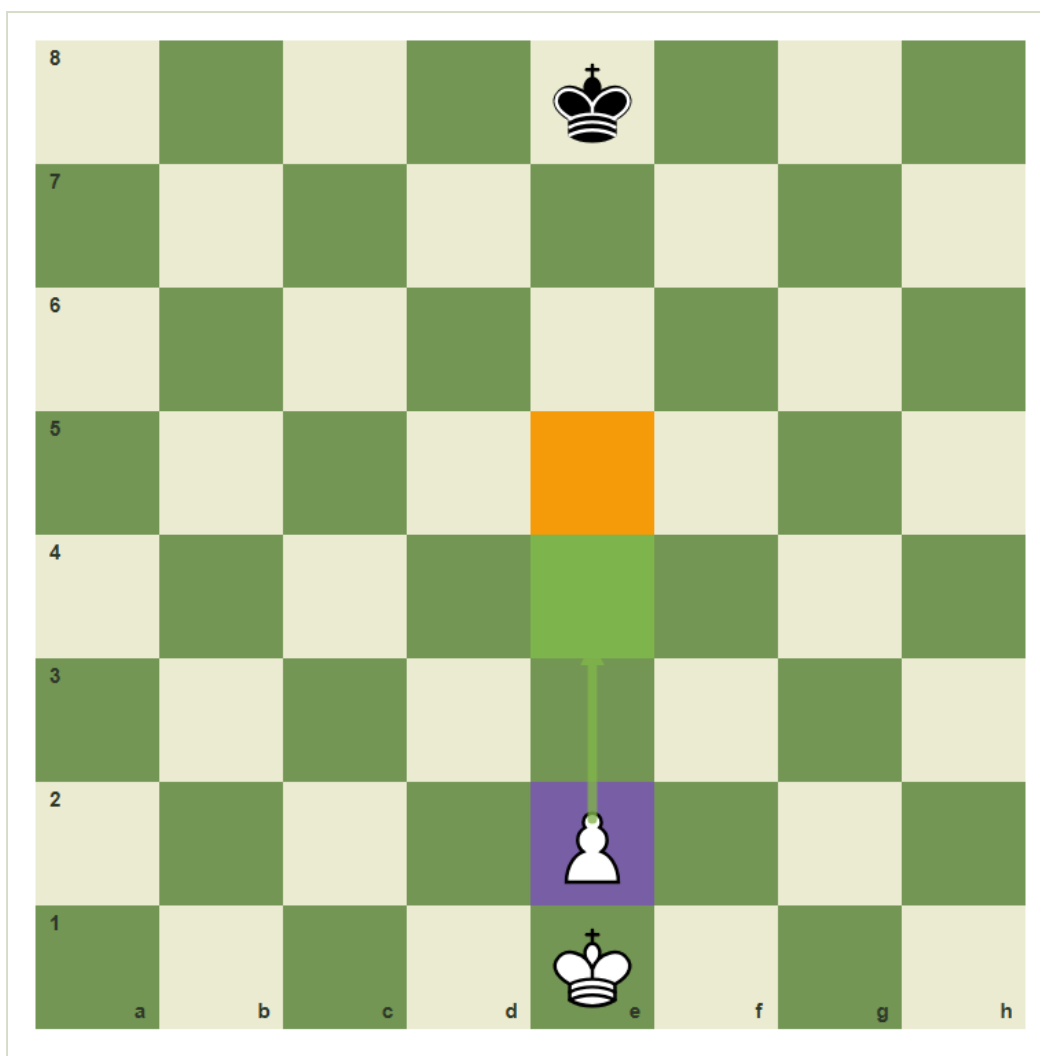
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for control the center.
- Choose a move or plan that fits control the center.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with control the center.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

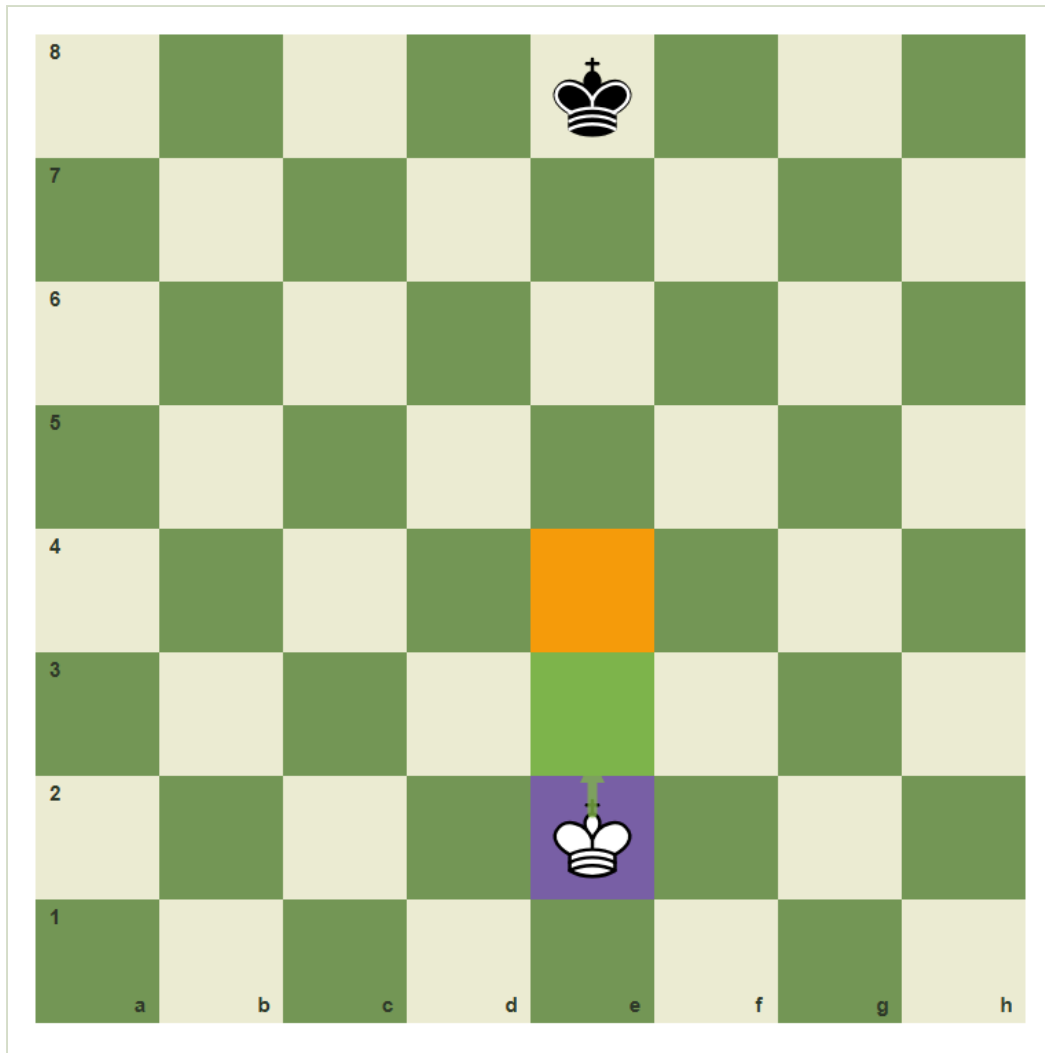
Control The Center is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

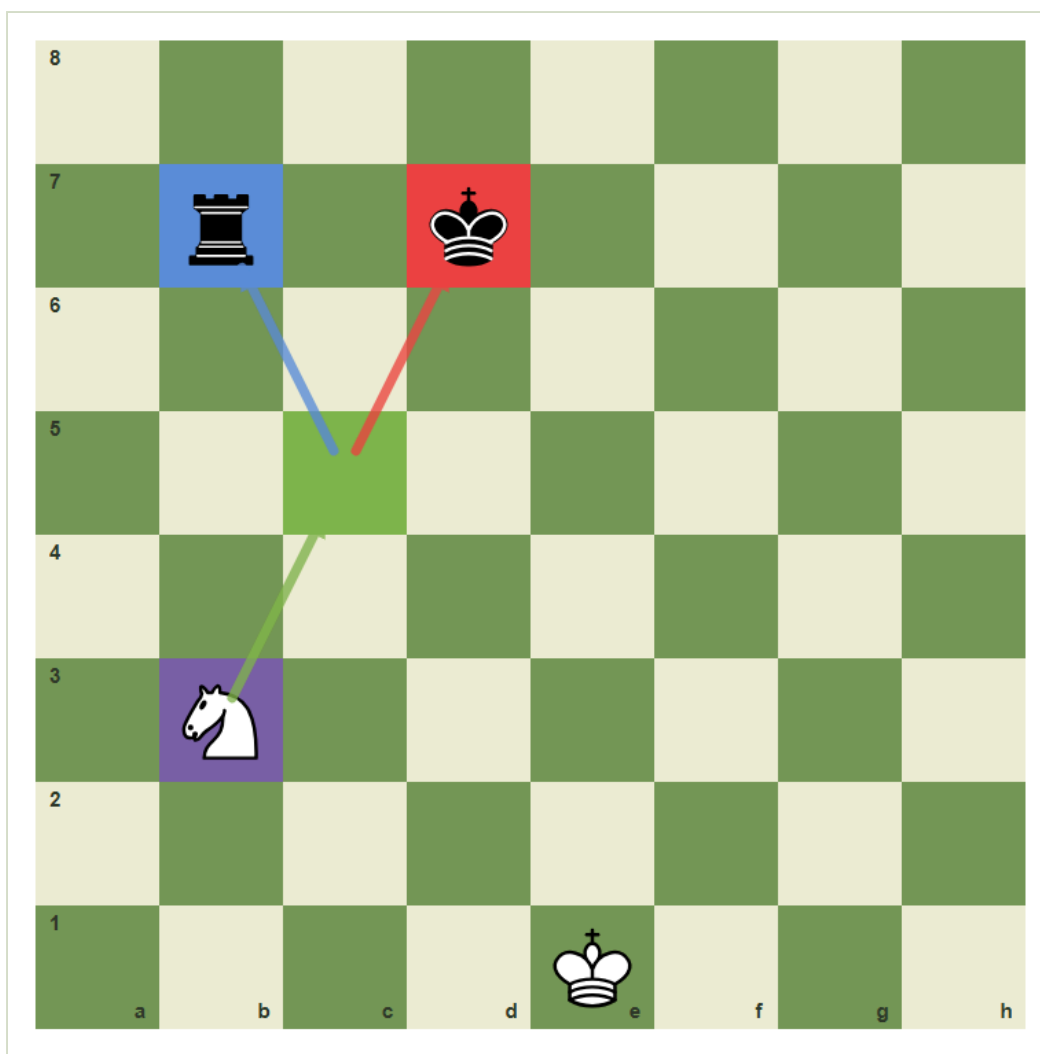


Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

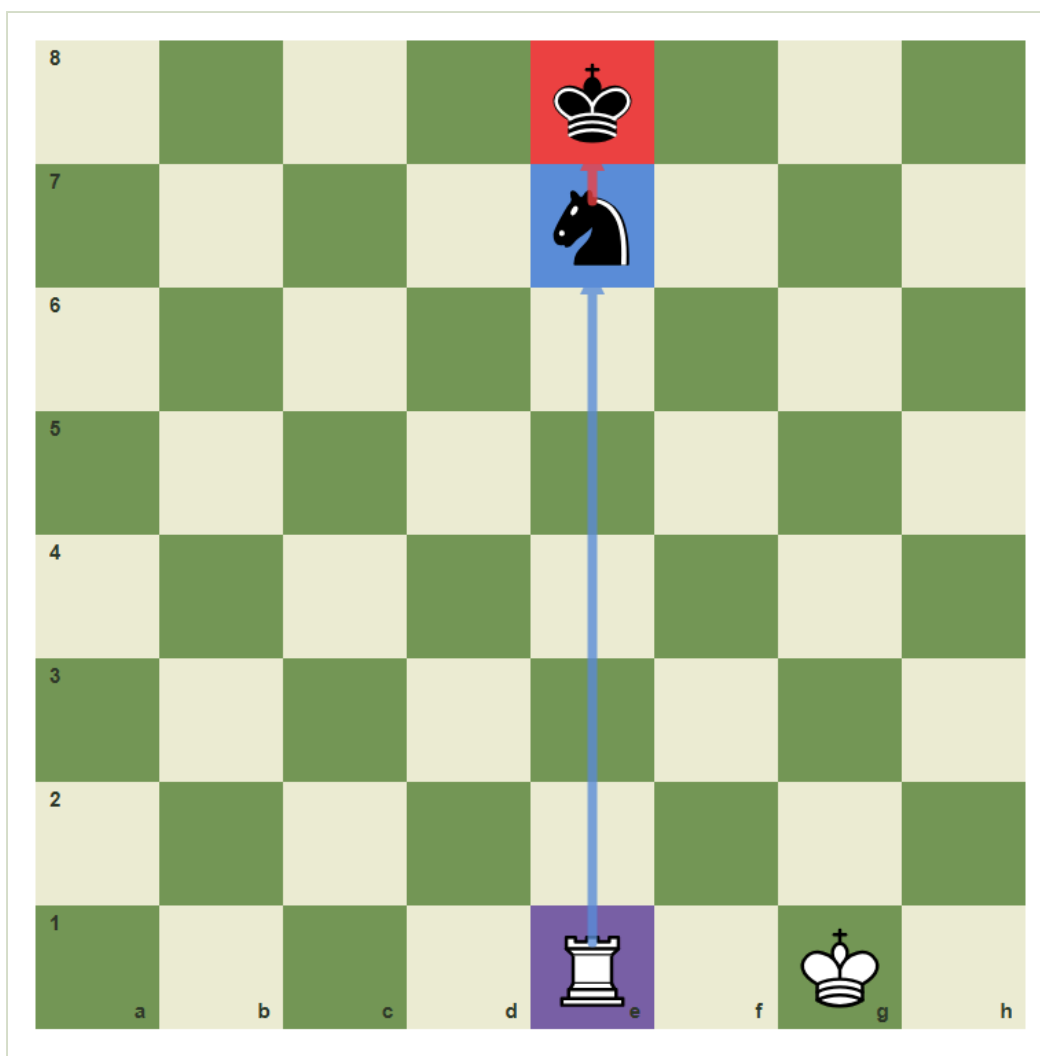
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



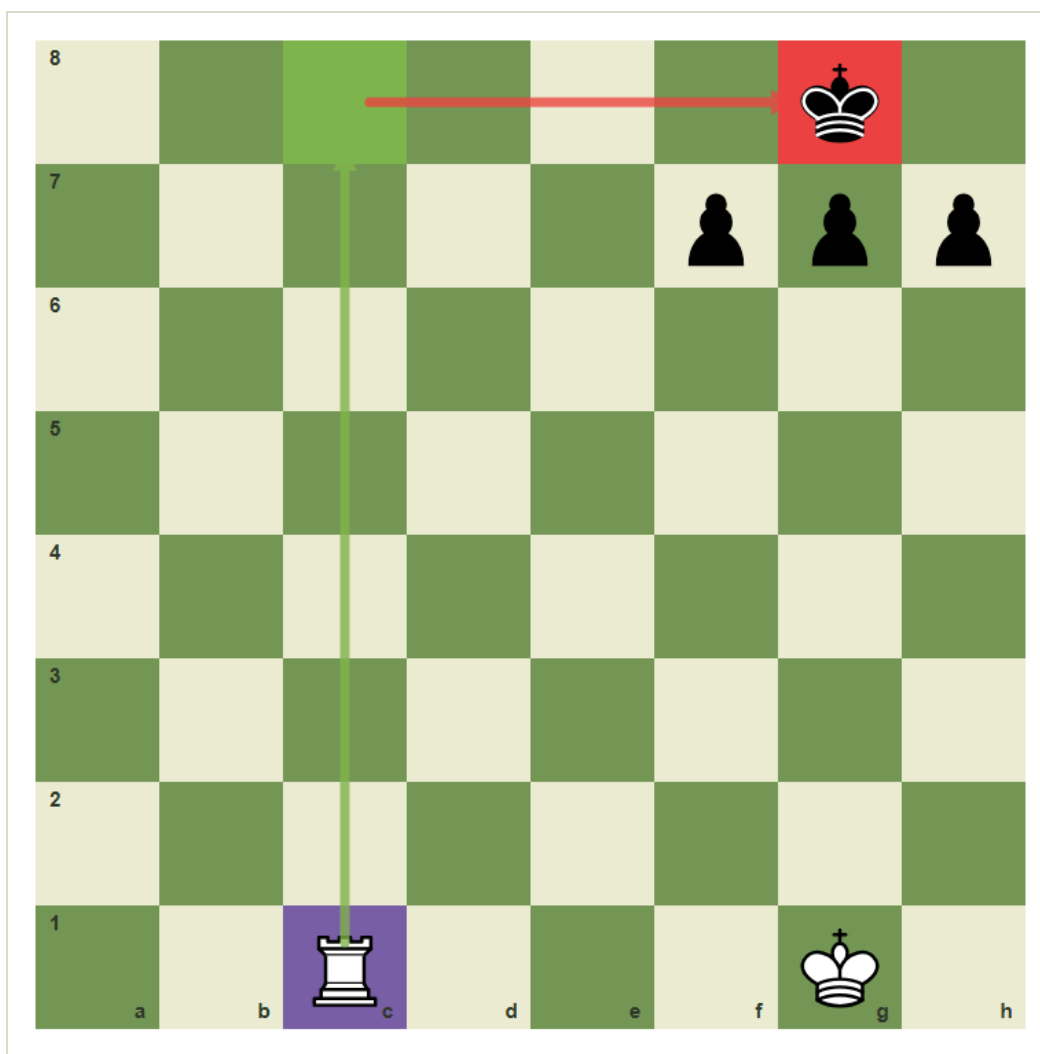
The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

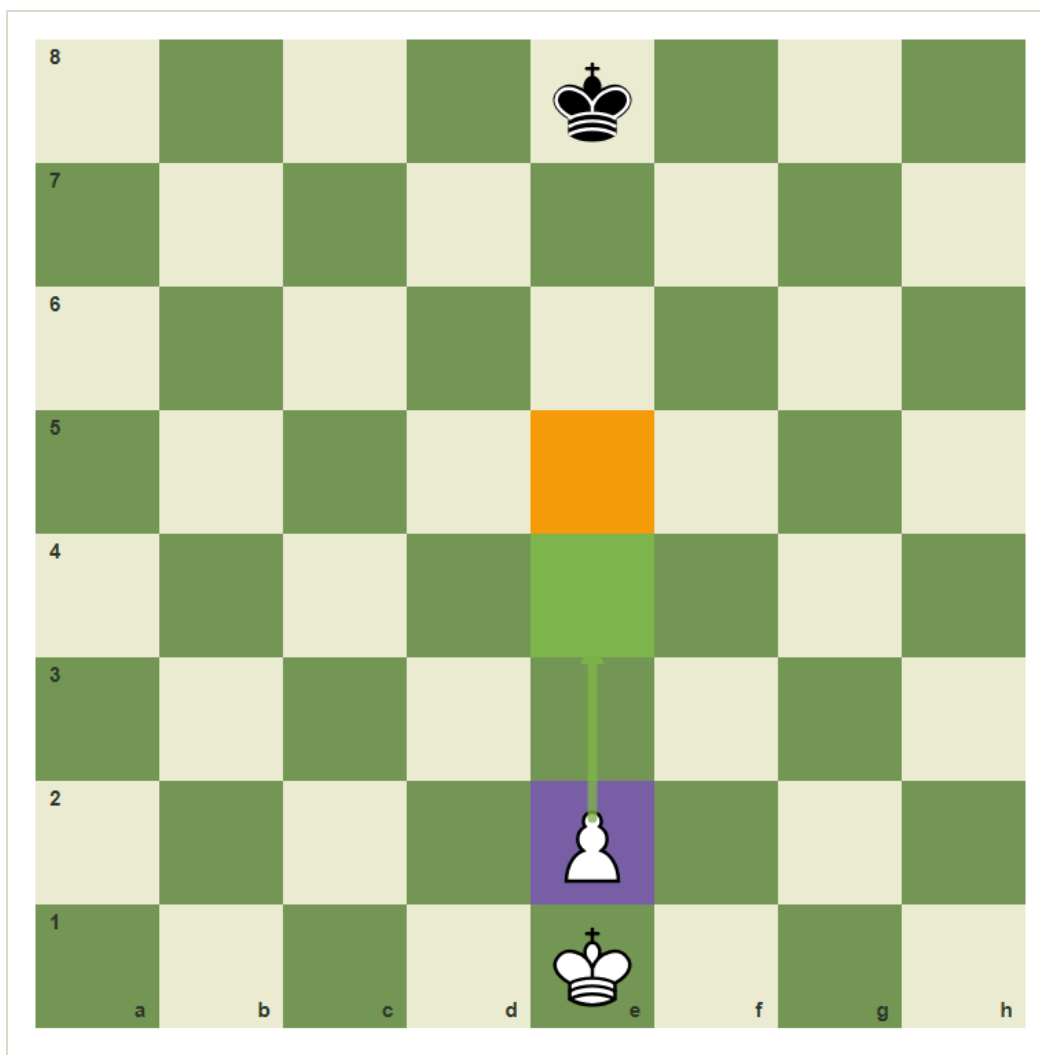
Training Diagram: review position



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

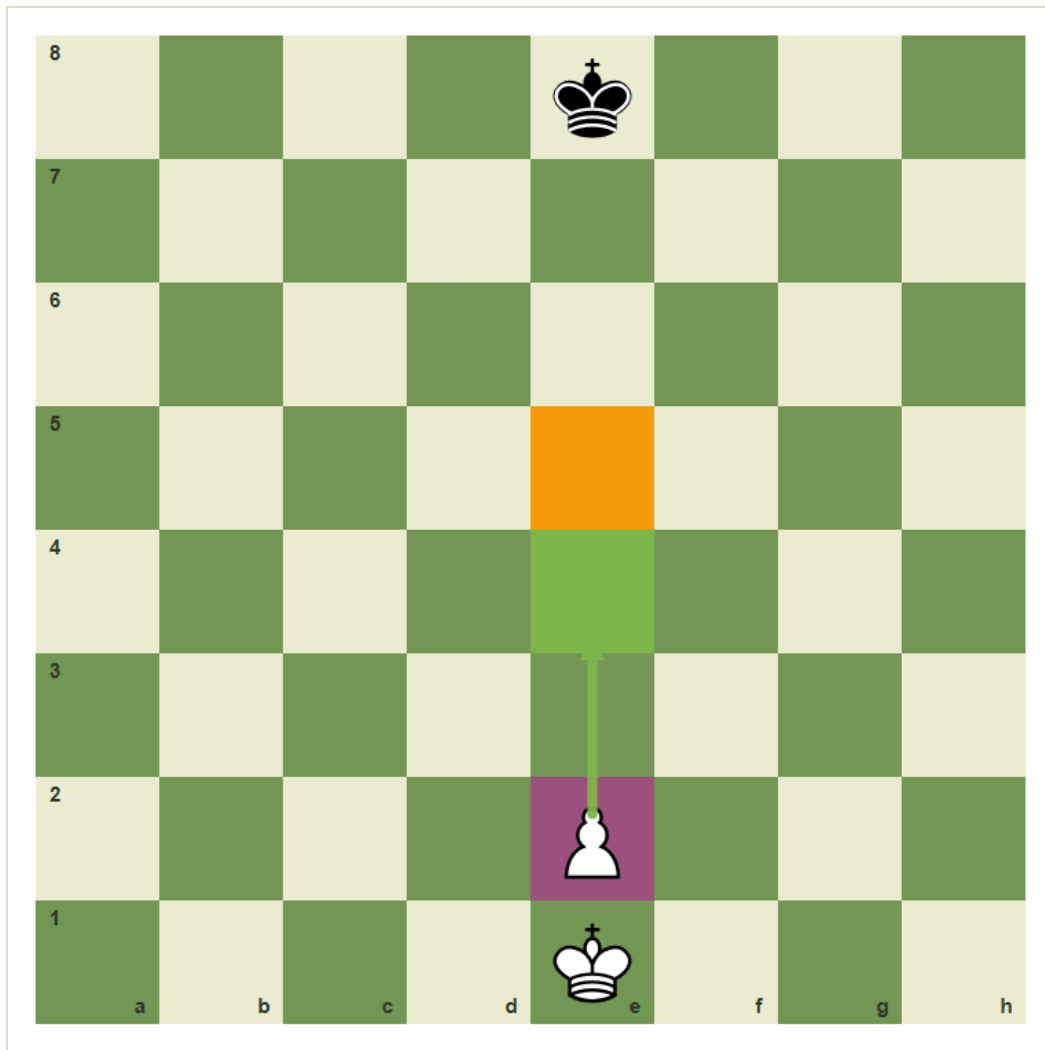
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Control The Center Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **control the center**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Control The Center Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **control the center**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Control The Center Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **control the center**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Develop Knights And Bishops

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Develop Knights And Bishops converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

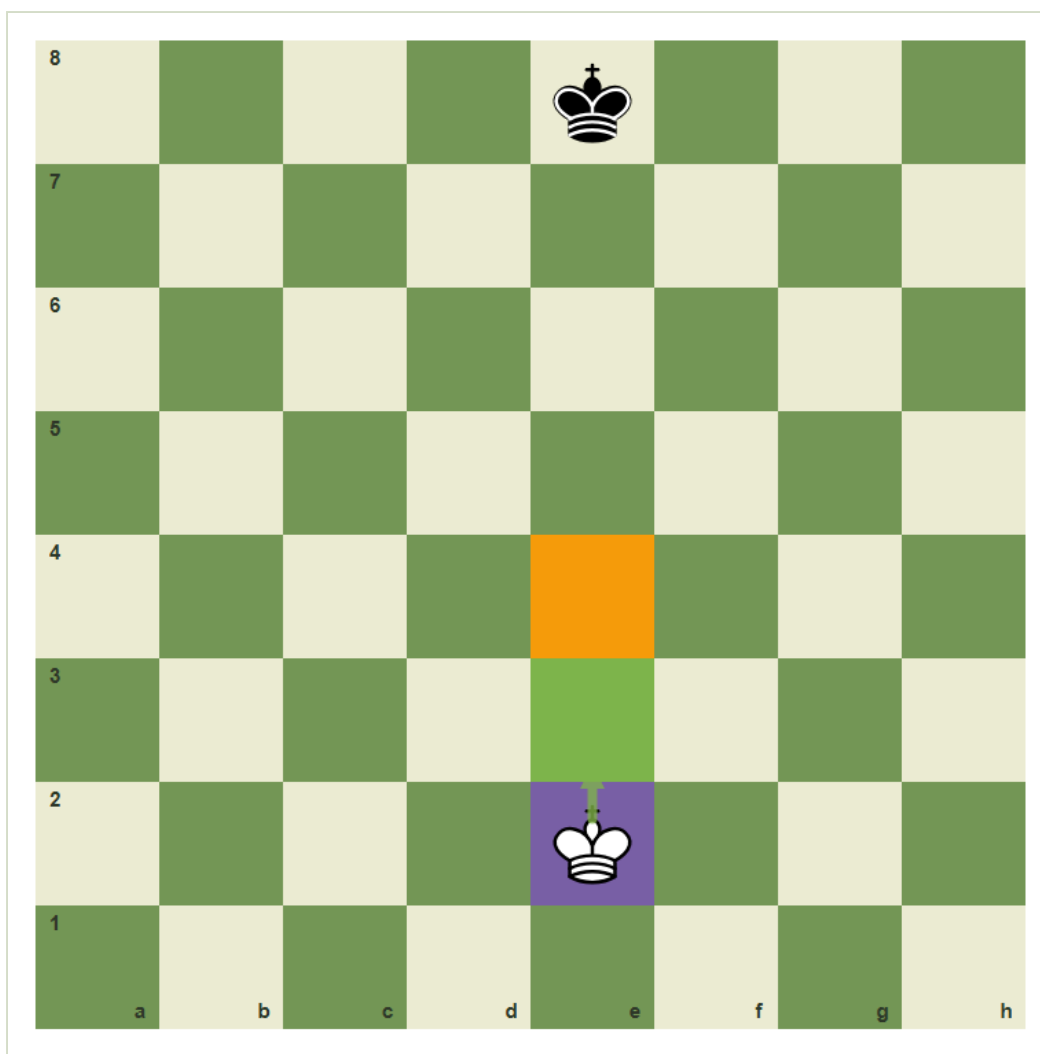
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for develop knights and bishops.
- Choose a move or plan that fits develop knights and bishops.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with develop knights and bishops.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

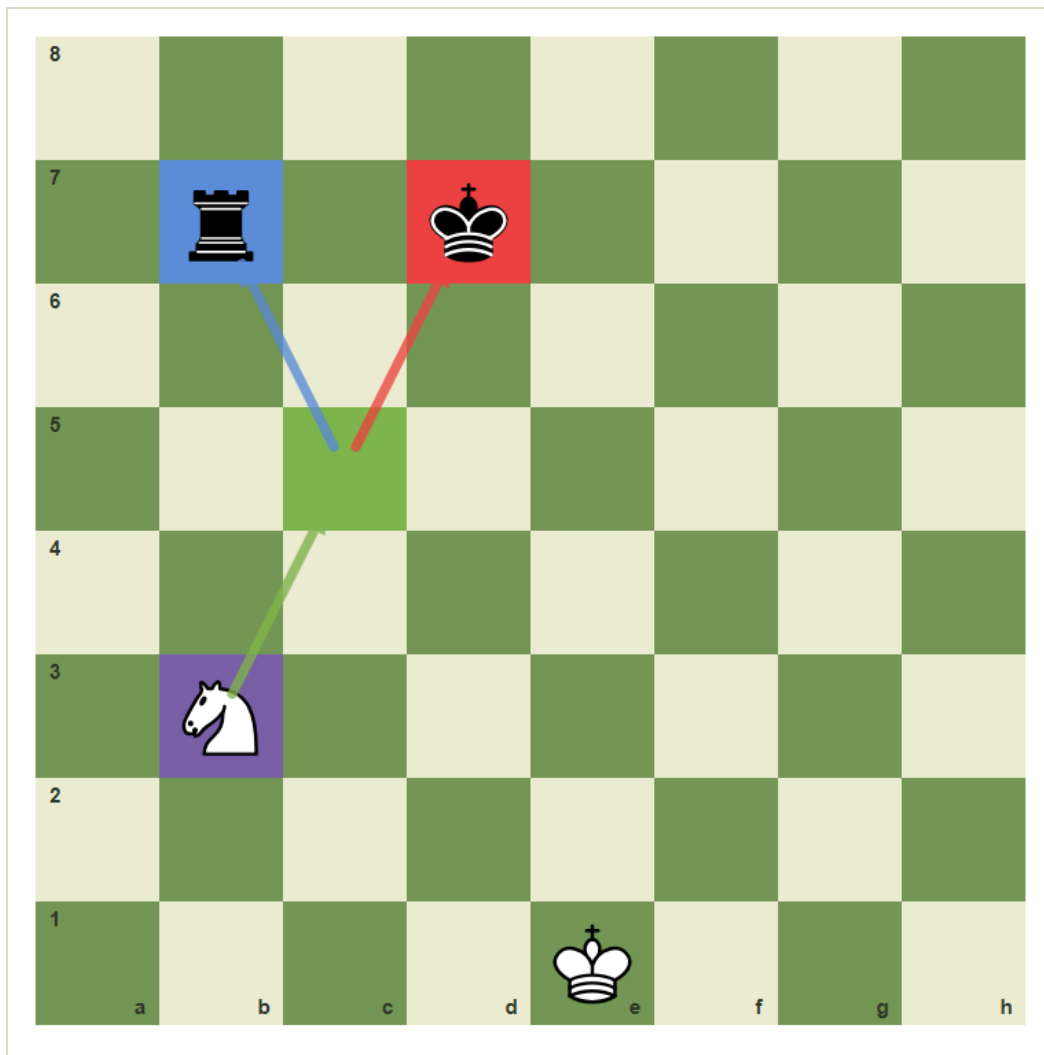
Develop Knights And Bishops is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

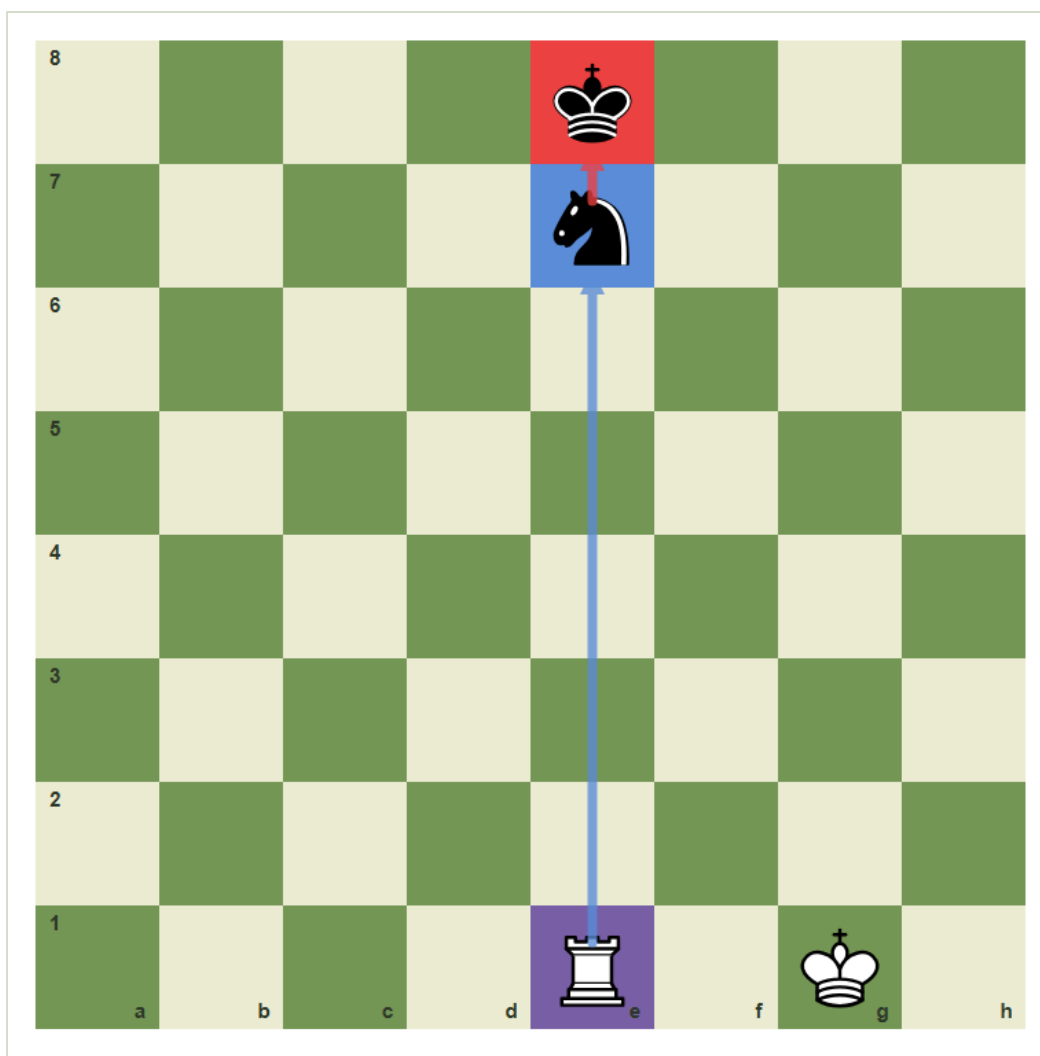


The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

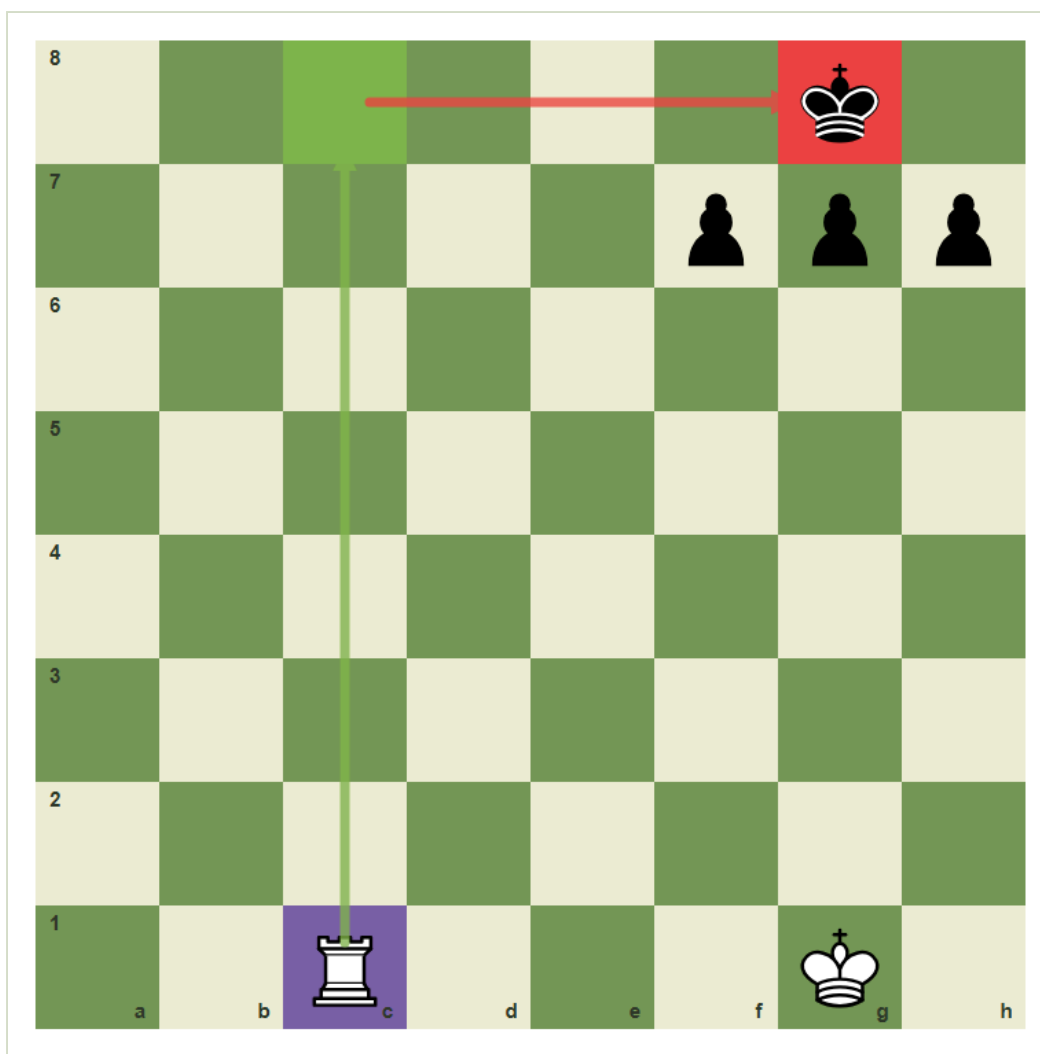
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



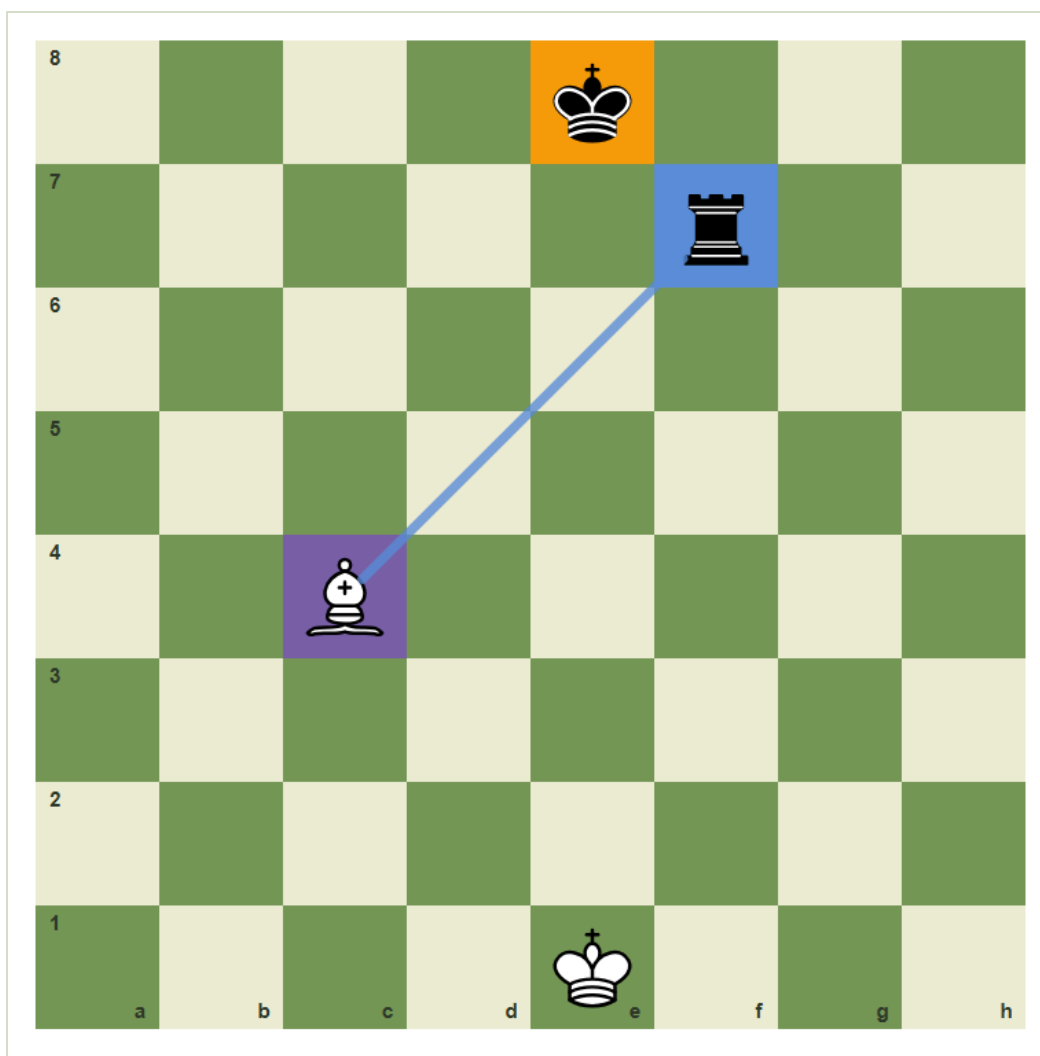
The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

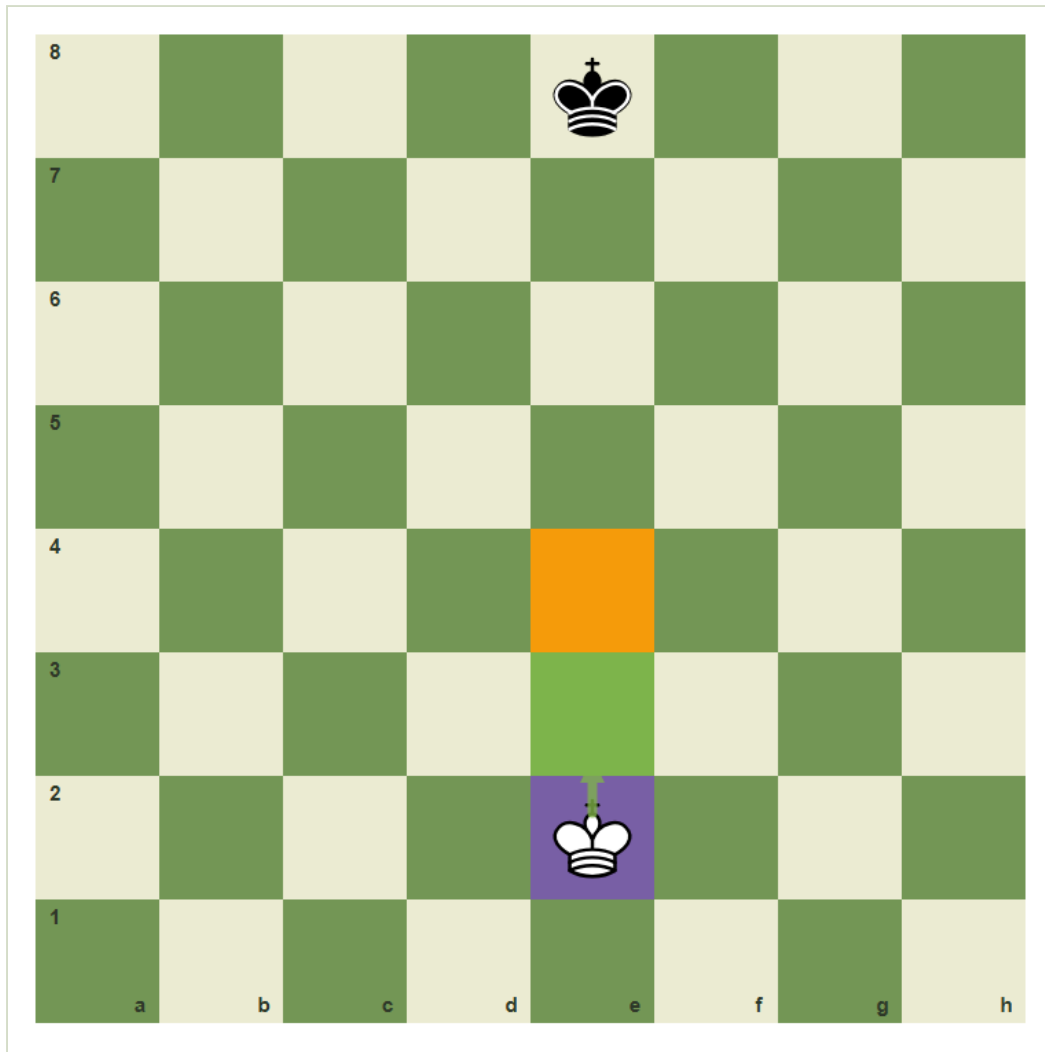
Training Diagram: review position



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

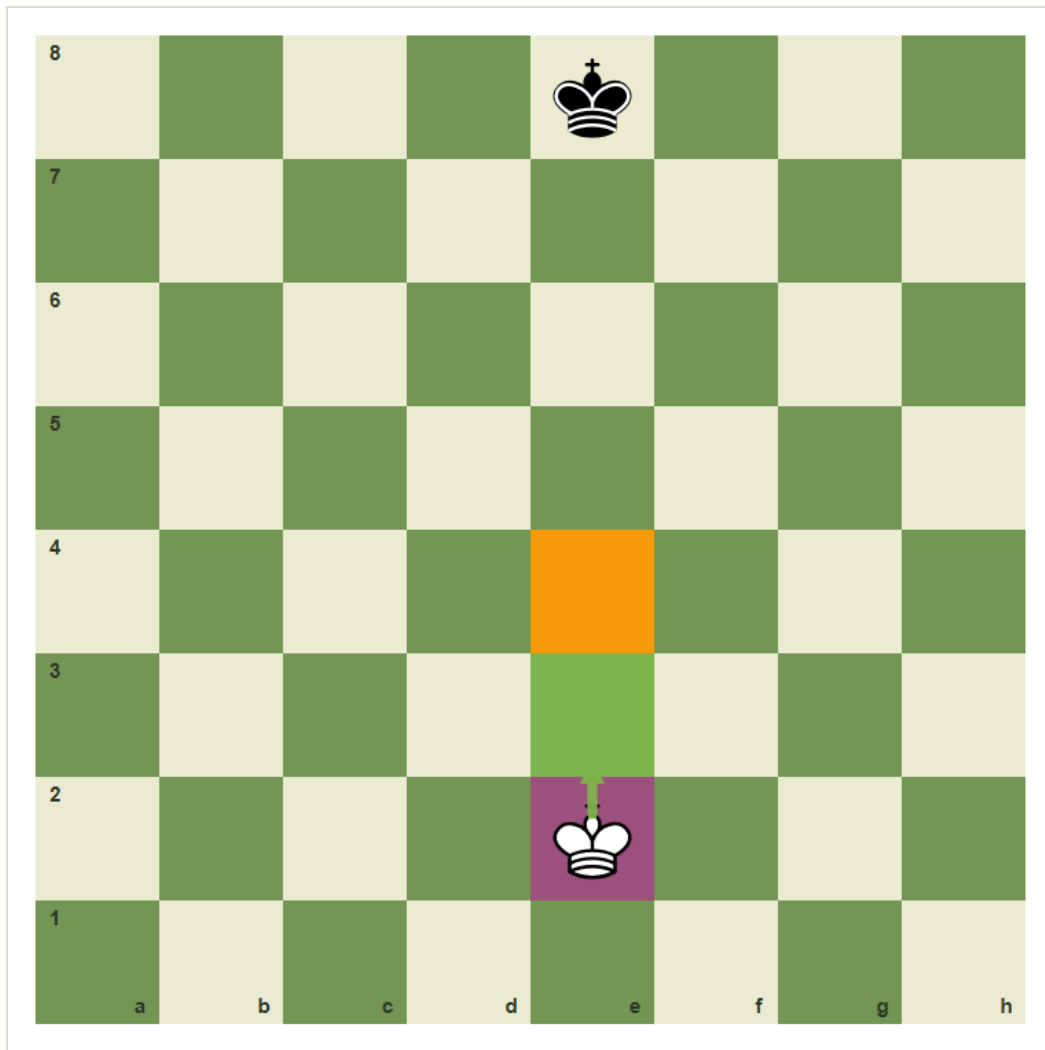
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e3**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Develop Knights And Bishops Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **develop knights and bishops**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Develop Knights And Bishops Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **develop knights and bishops**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Develop Knights And Bishops Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **develop knights and bishops**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

King Safety And Castling

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King Safety And Castling converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

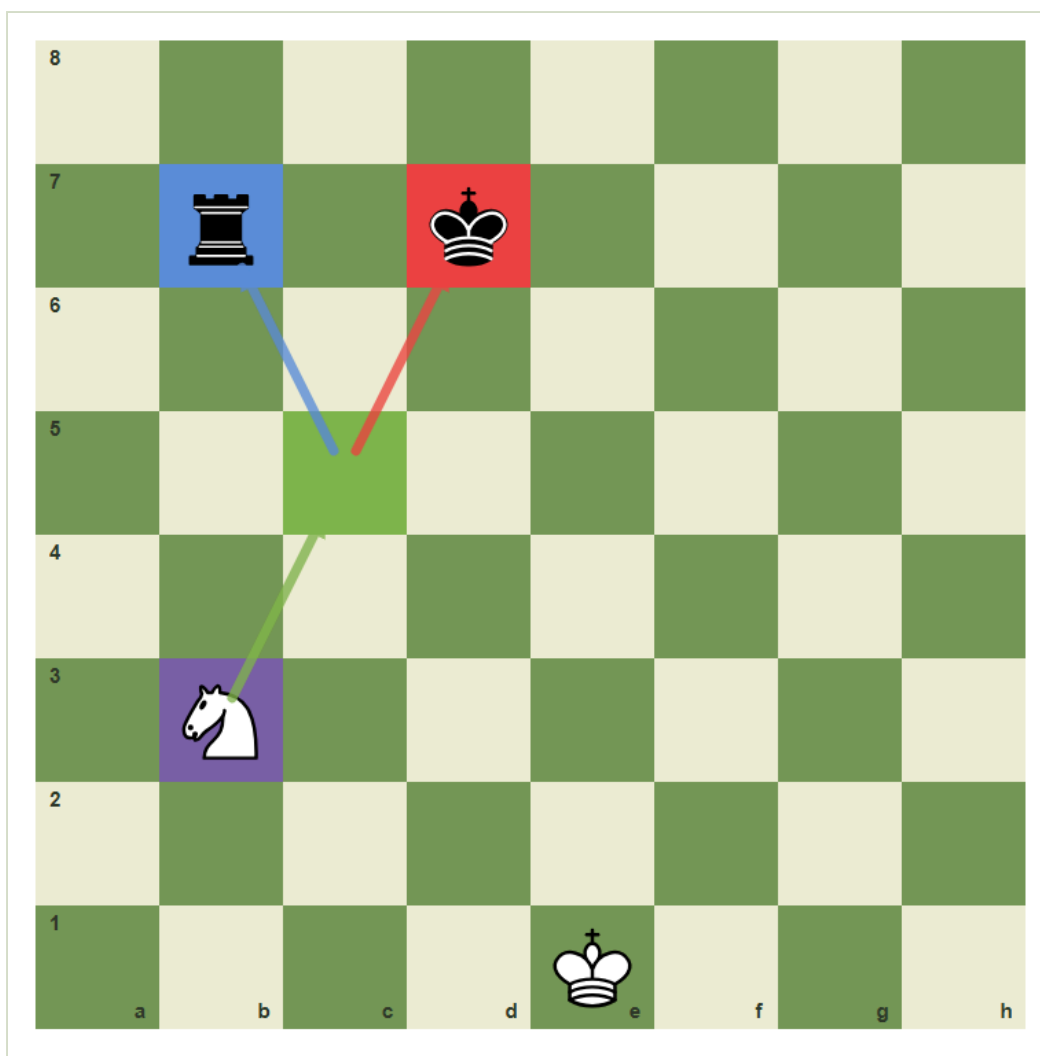
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for king safety and castling.
- Choose a move or plan that fits king safety and castling.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with king safety and castling.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

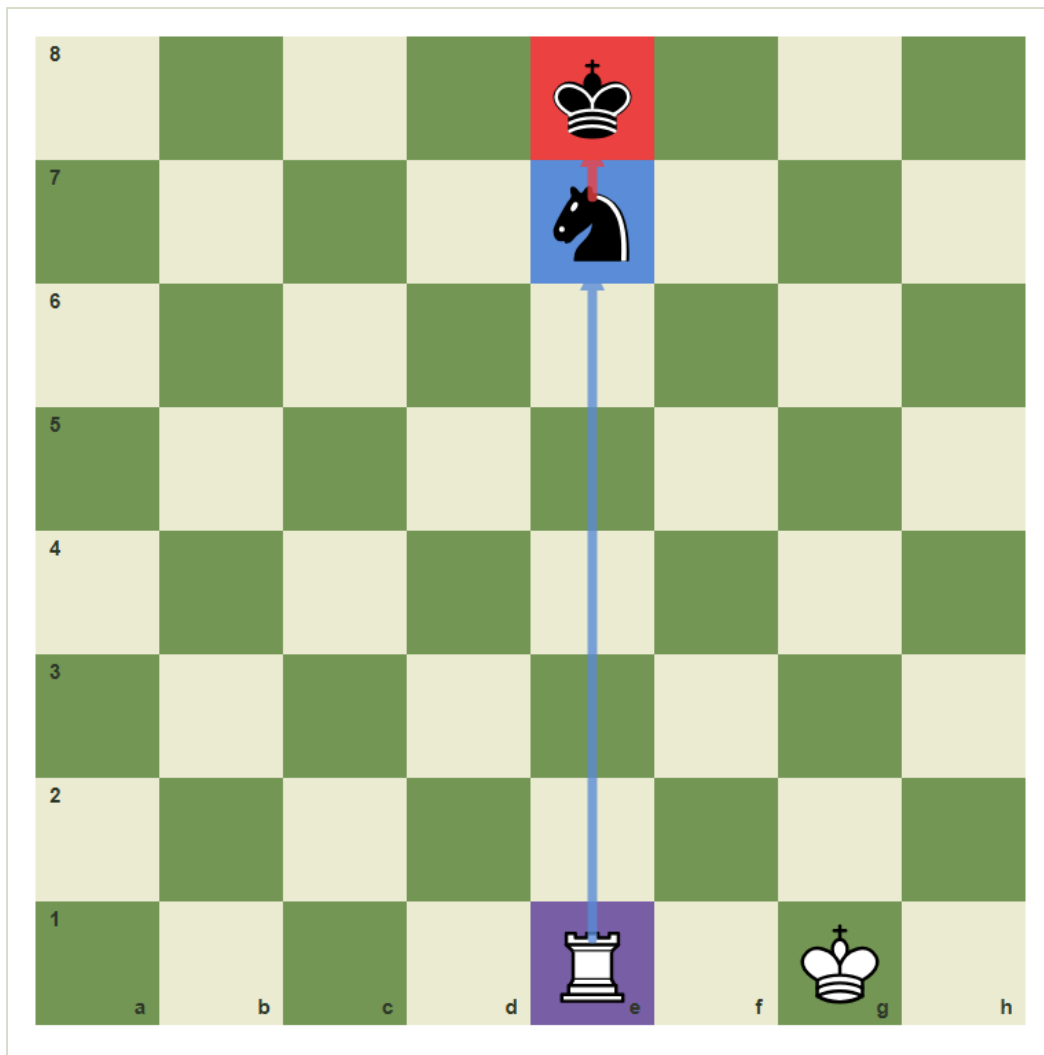
King Safety And Castling is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

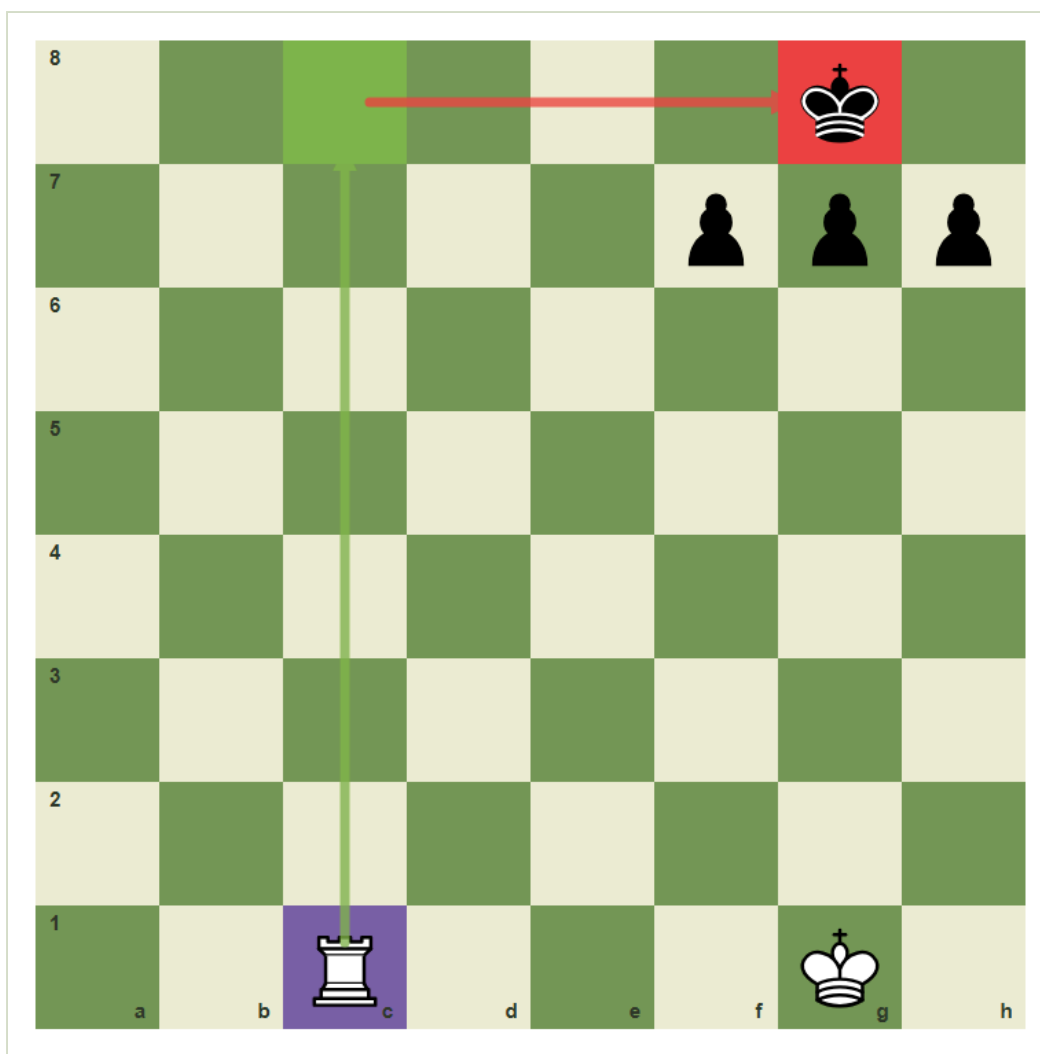


The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

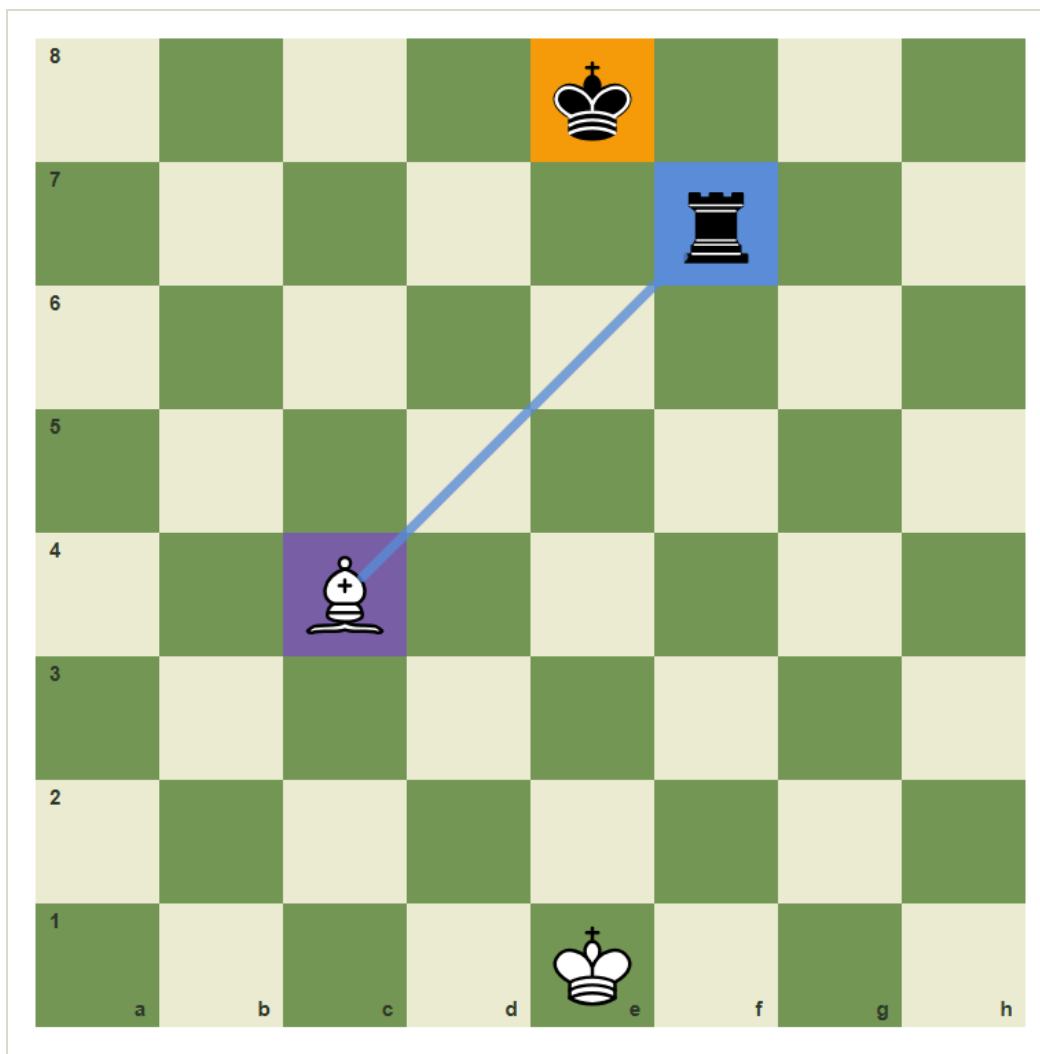
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



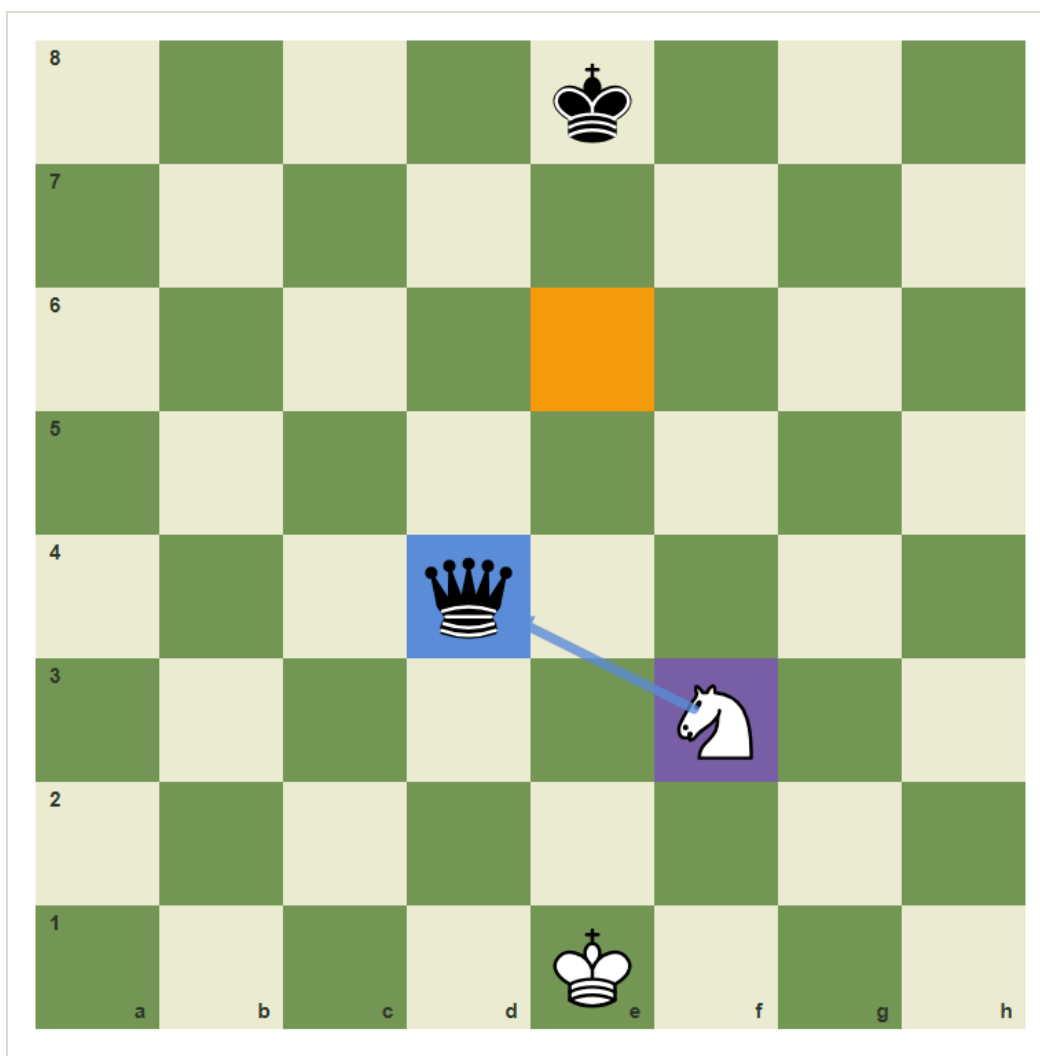
A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

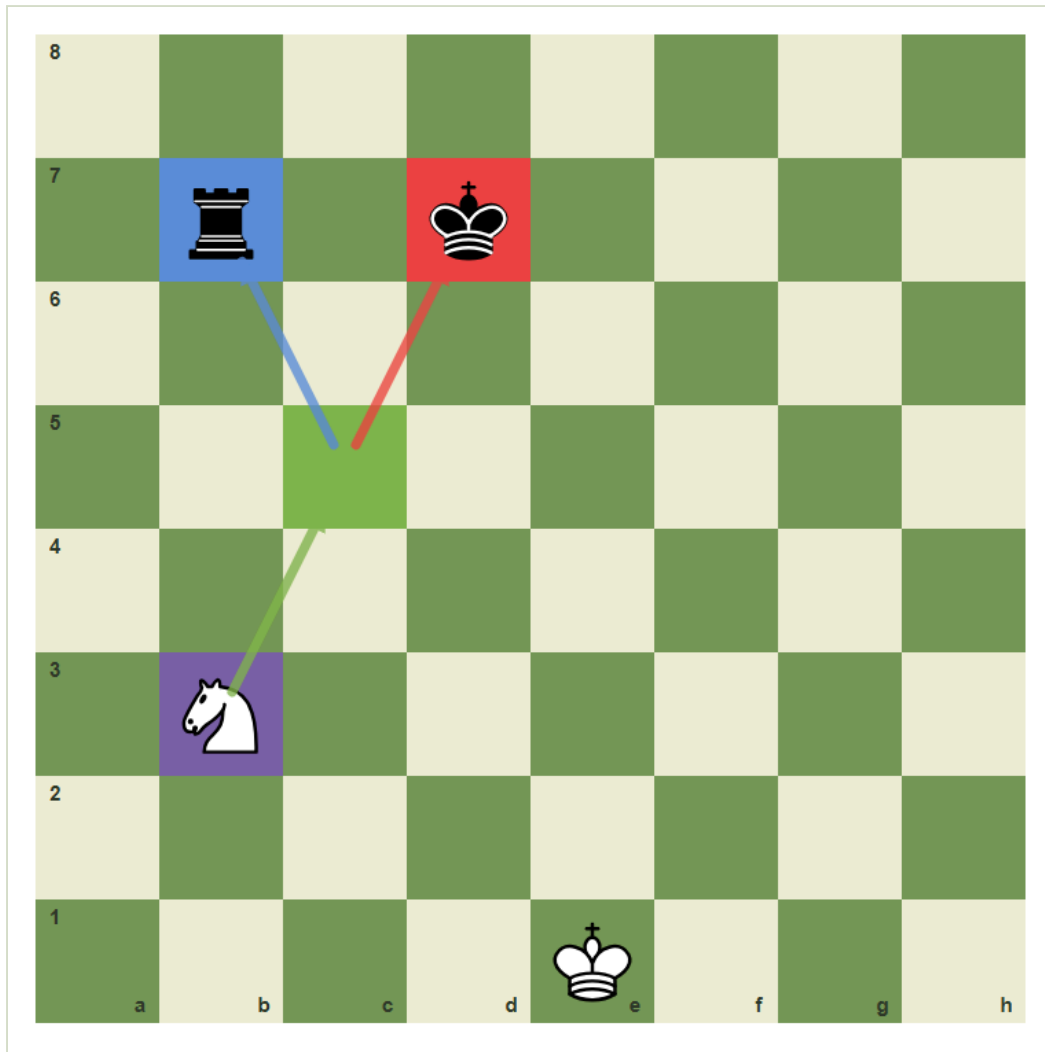
Training Diagram: review position



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

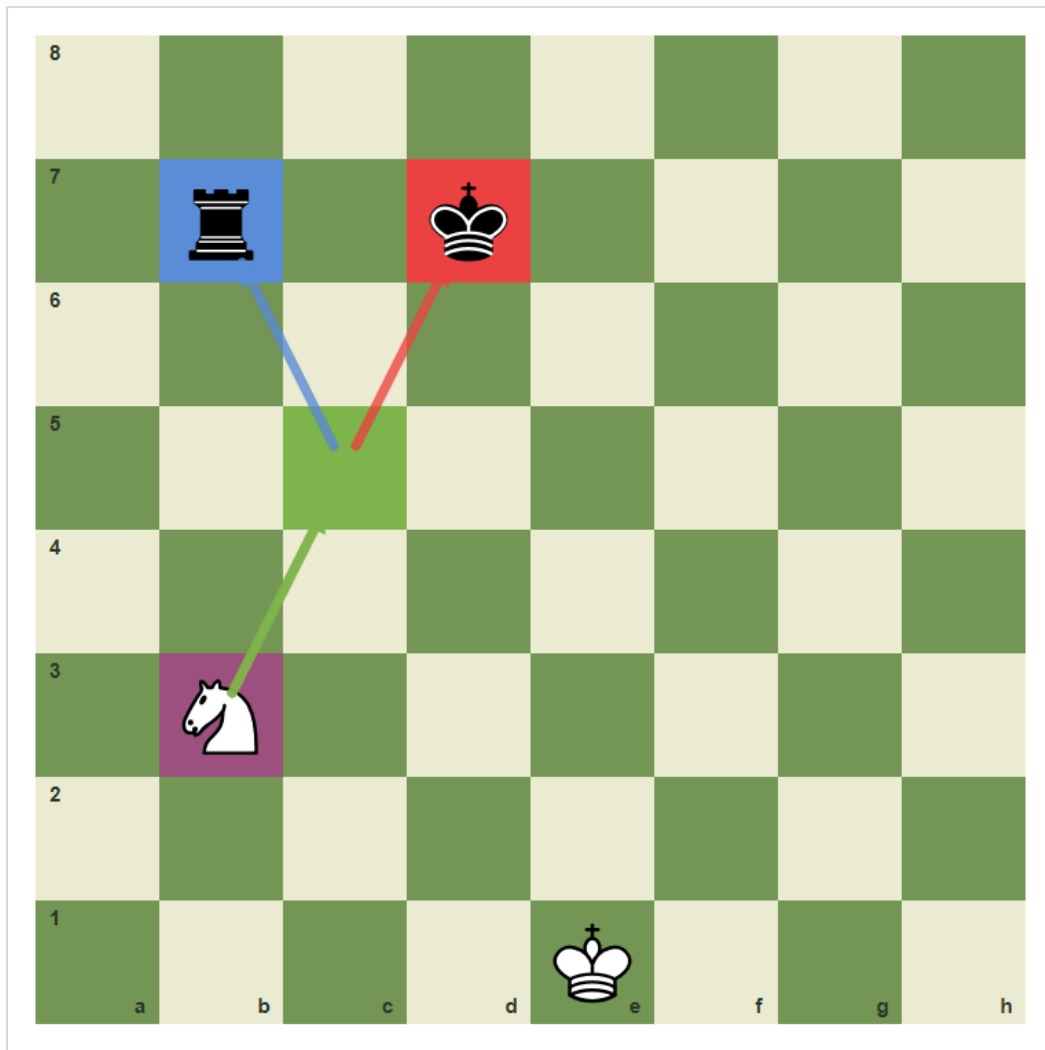
Play the highlighted move from **b3** to **c5**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

King Safety And Castling Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **king safety and castling**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

King Safety And Castling Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **king safety and castling**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

King Safety And Castling Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **king safety and castling**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early

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Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

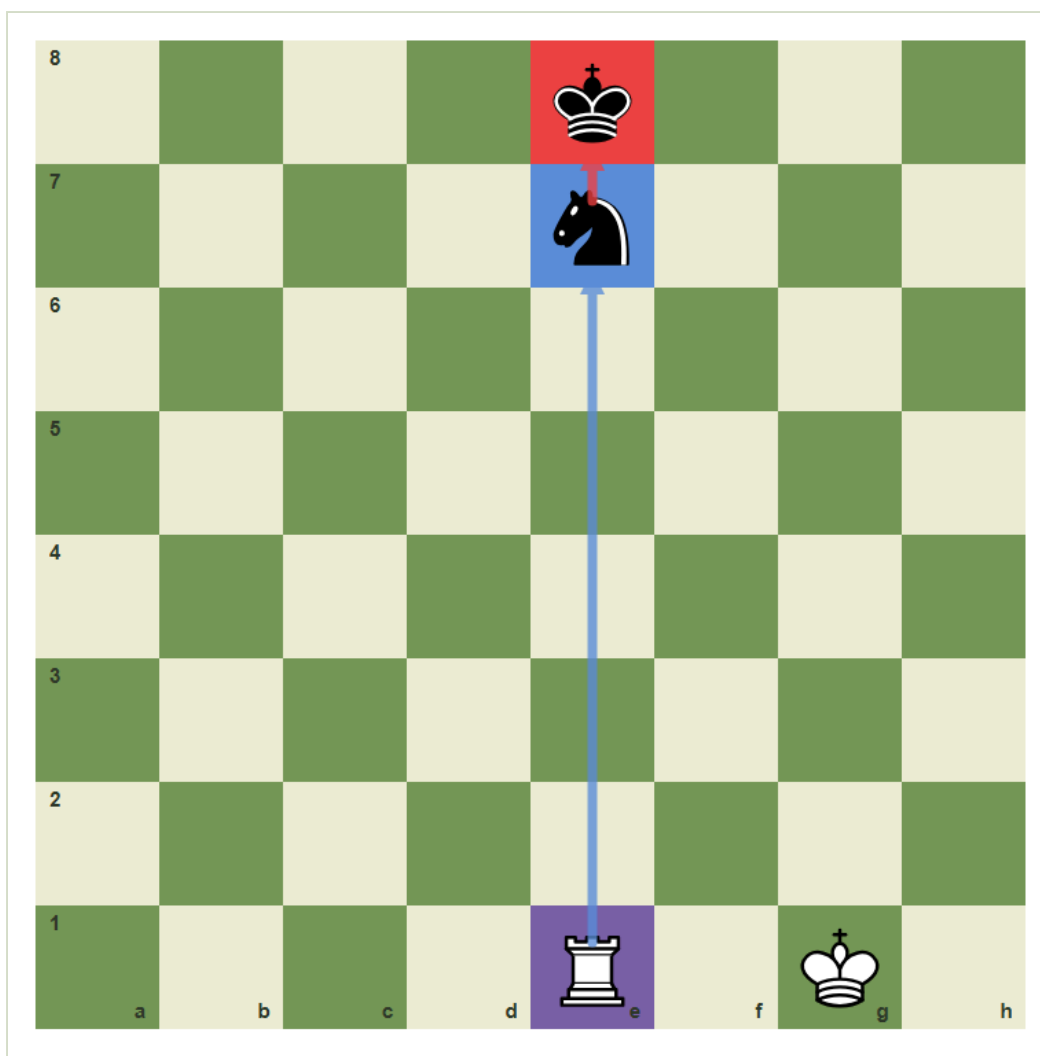
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for do not bring the queen out too early.
- Choose a move or plan that fits do not bring the queen out too early.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with do not bring the queen out too early.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

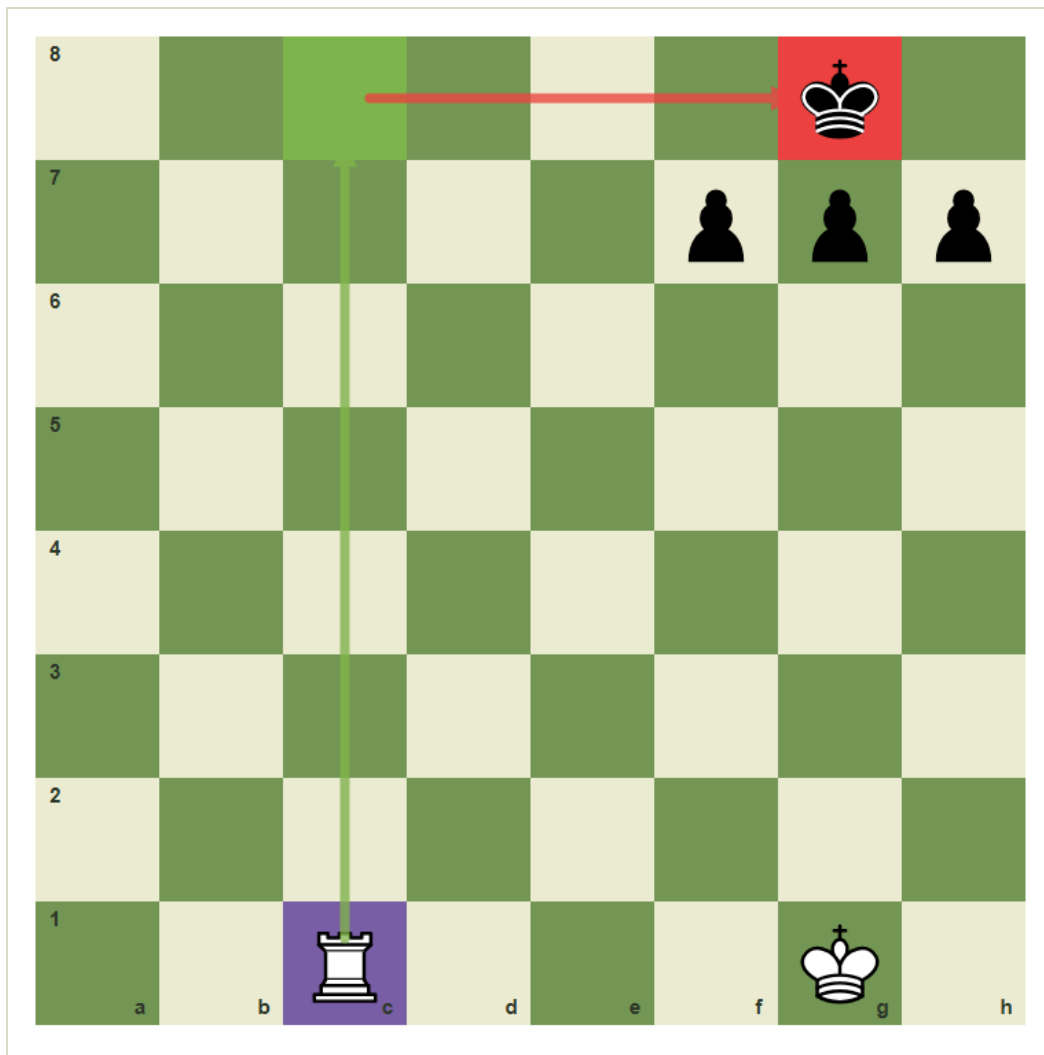
Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

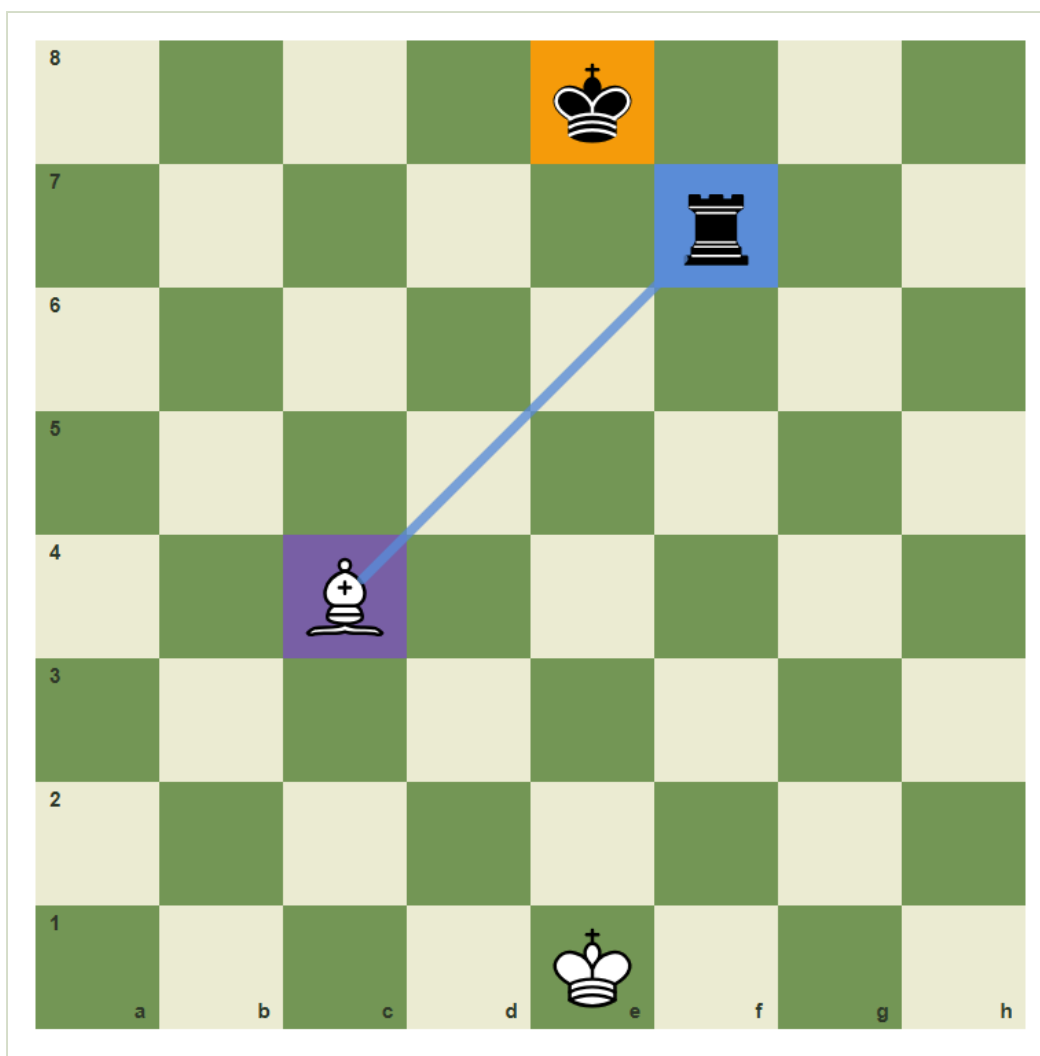


A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

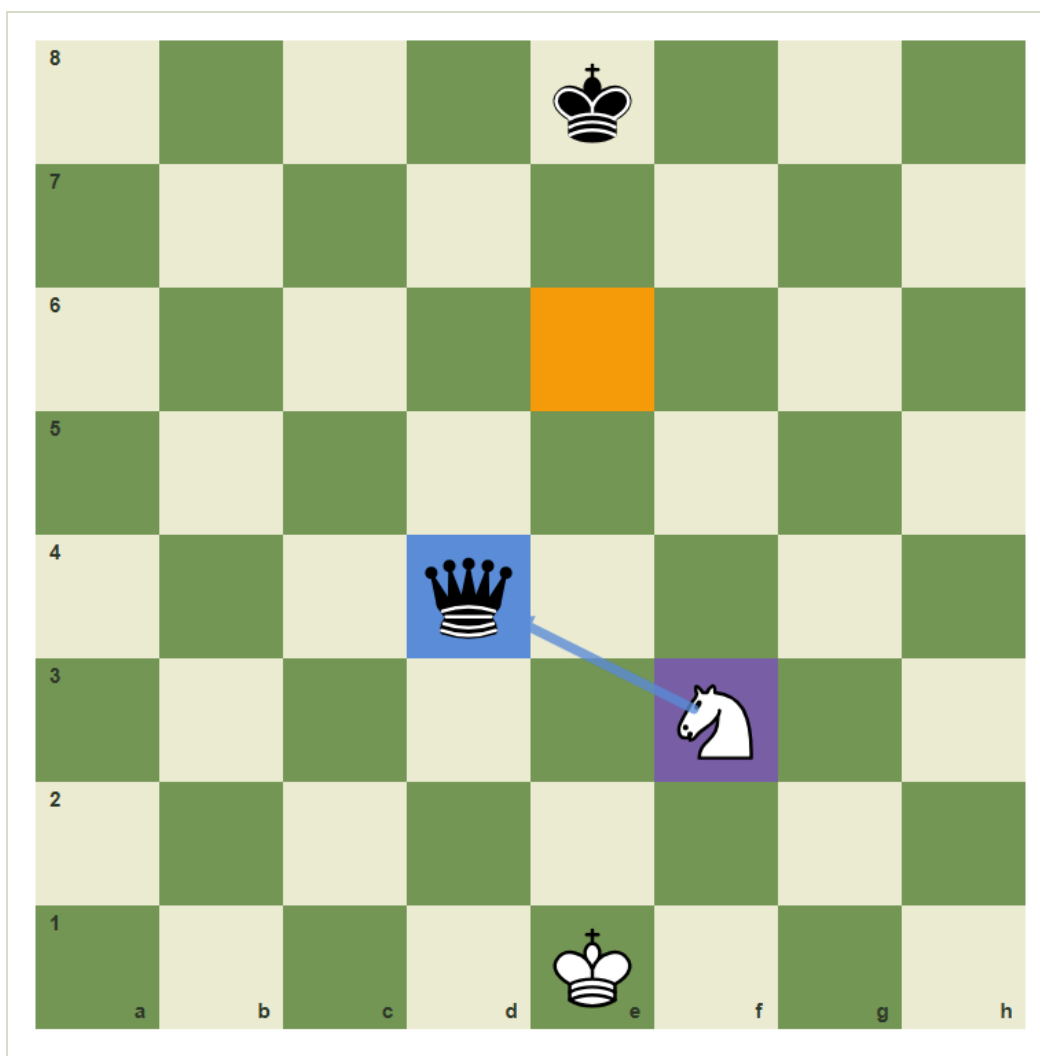
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



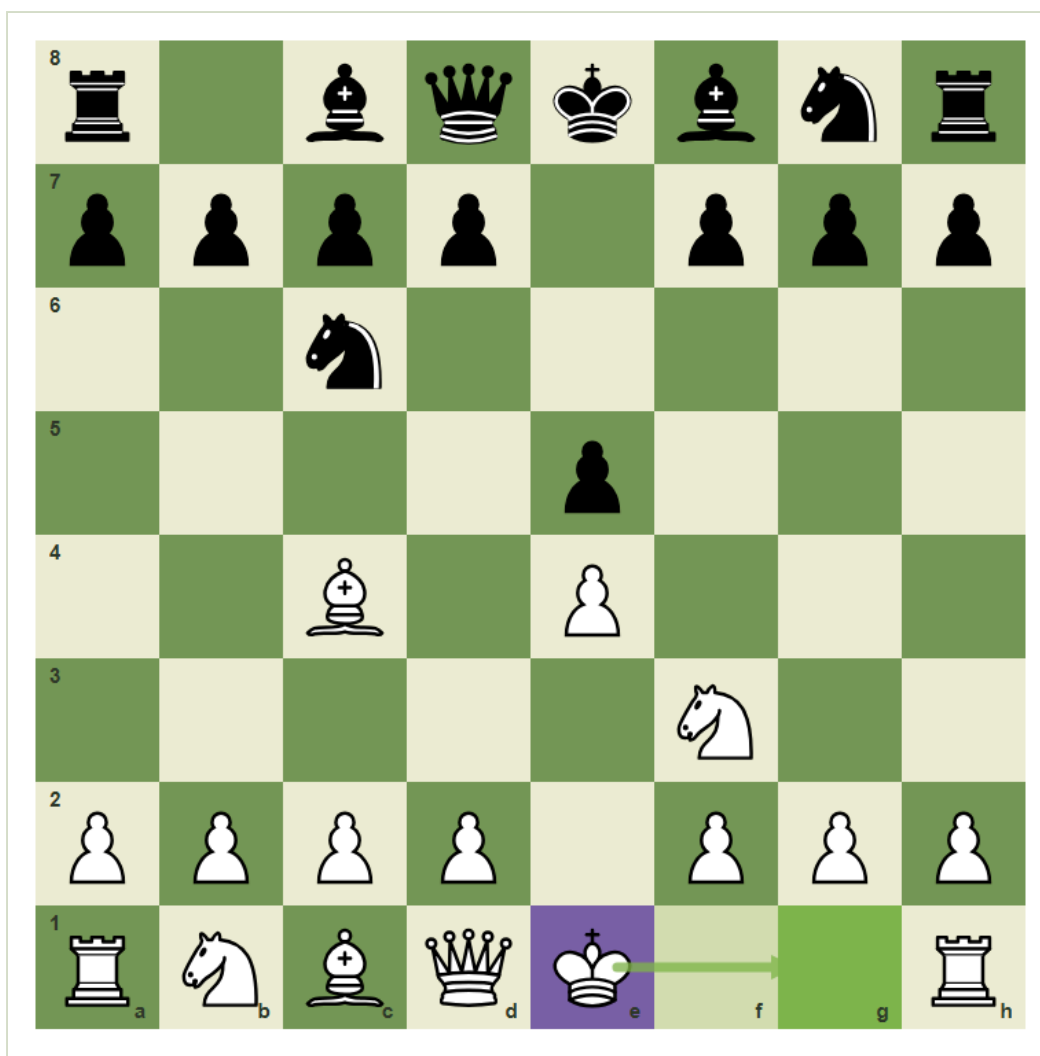
The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

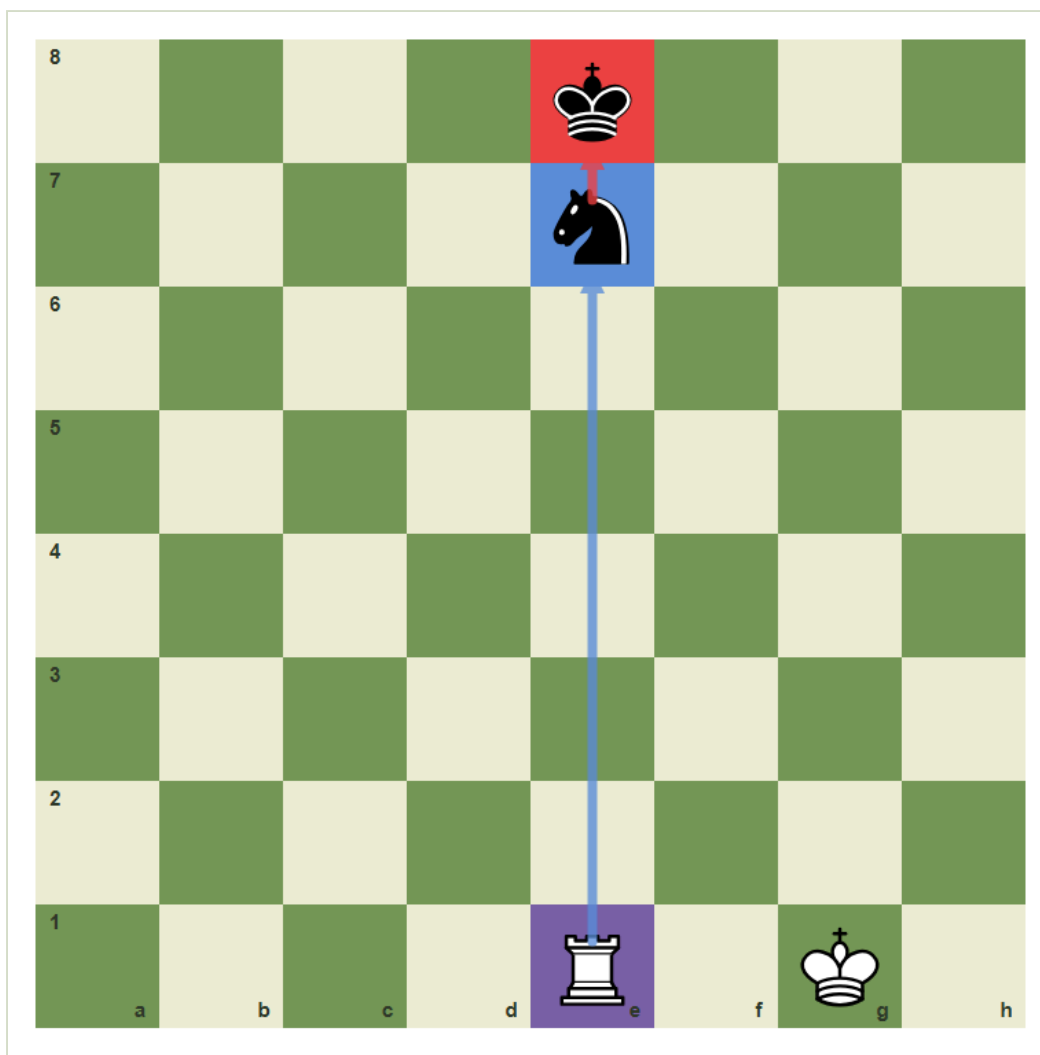
Training Diagram: review position



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

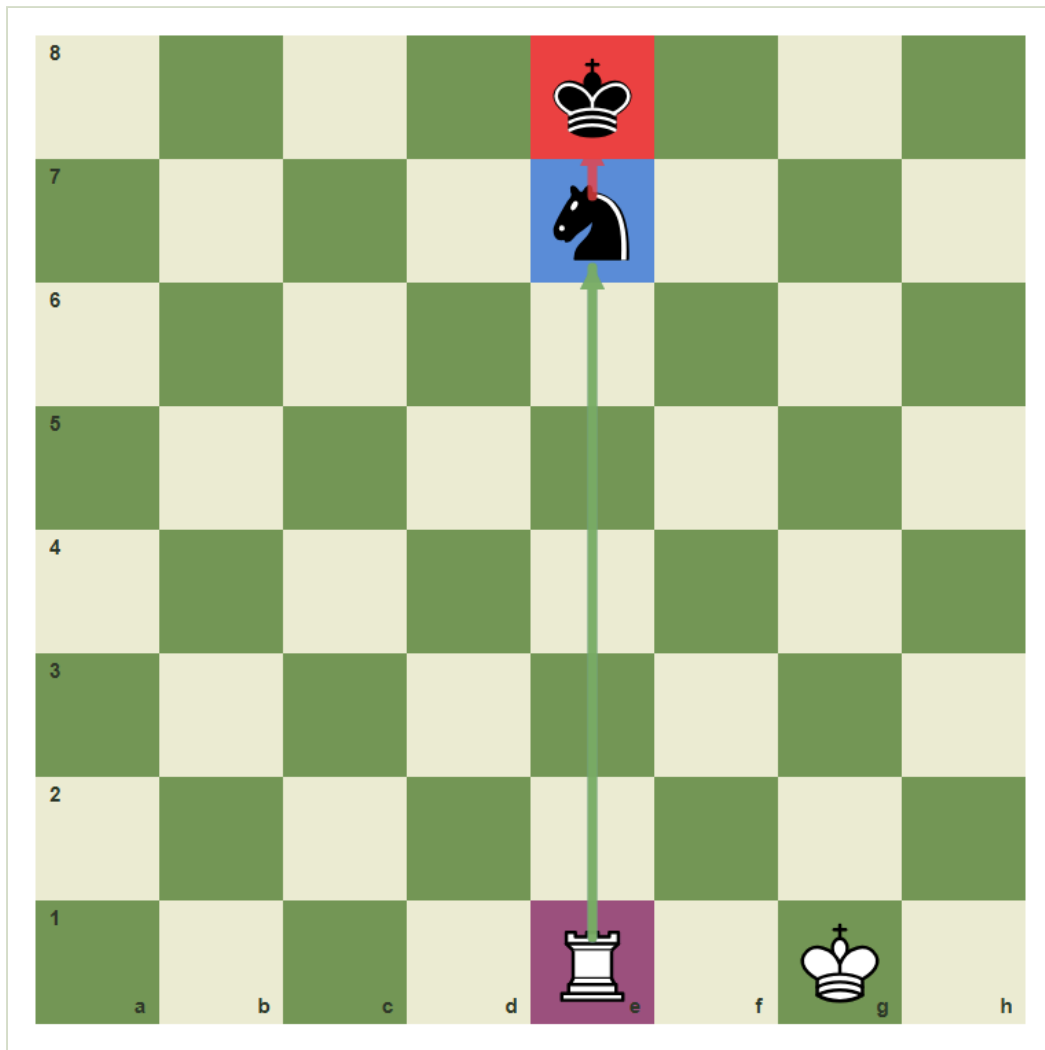
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **e7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **do not bring the queen out too early**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **do not bring the queen out too early**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Do Not Bring The Queen Out Too Early Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **do not bring the queen out too early**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken

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Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

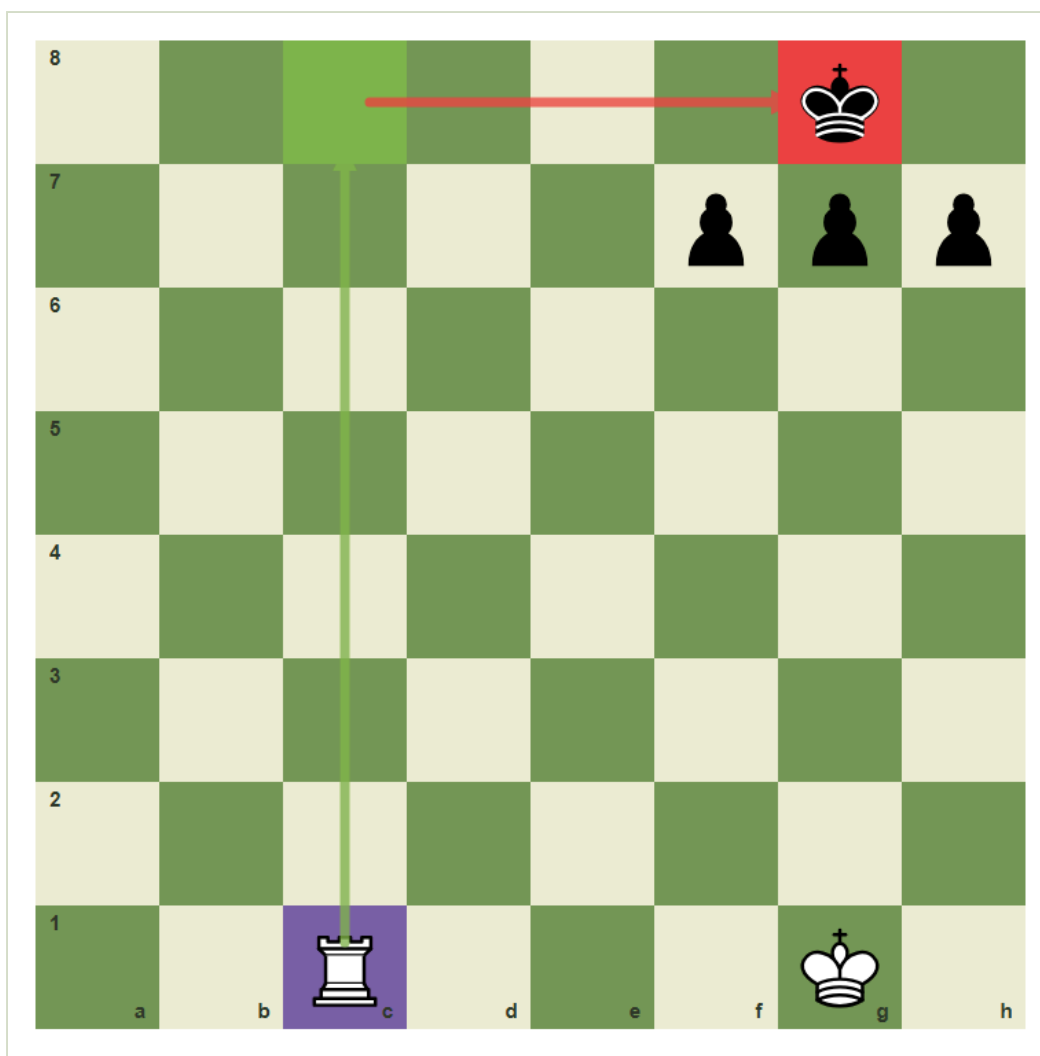
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for pawn moves that help vs weaken.
- Choose a move or plan that fits pawn moves that help vs weaken.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with pawn moves that help vs weaken.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

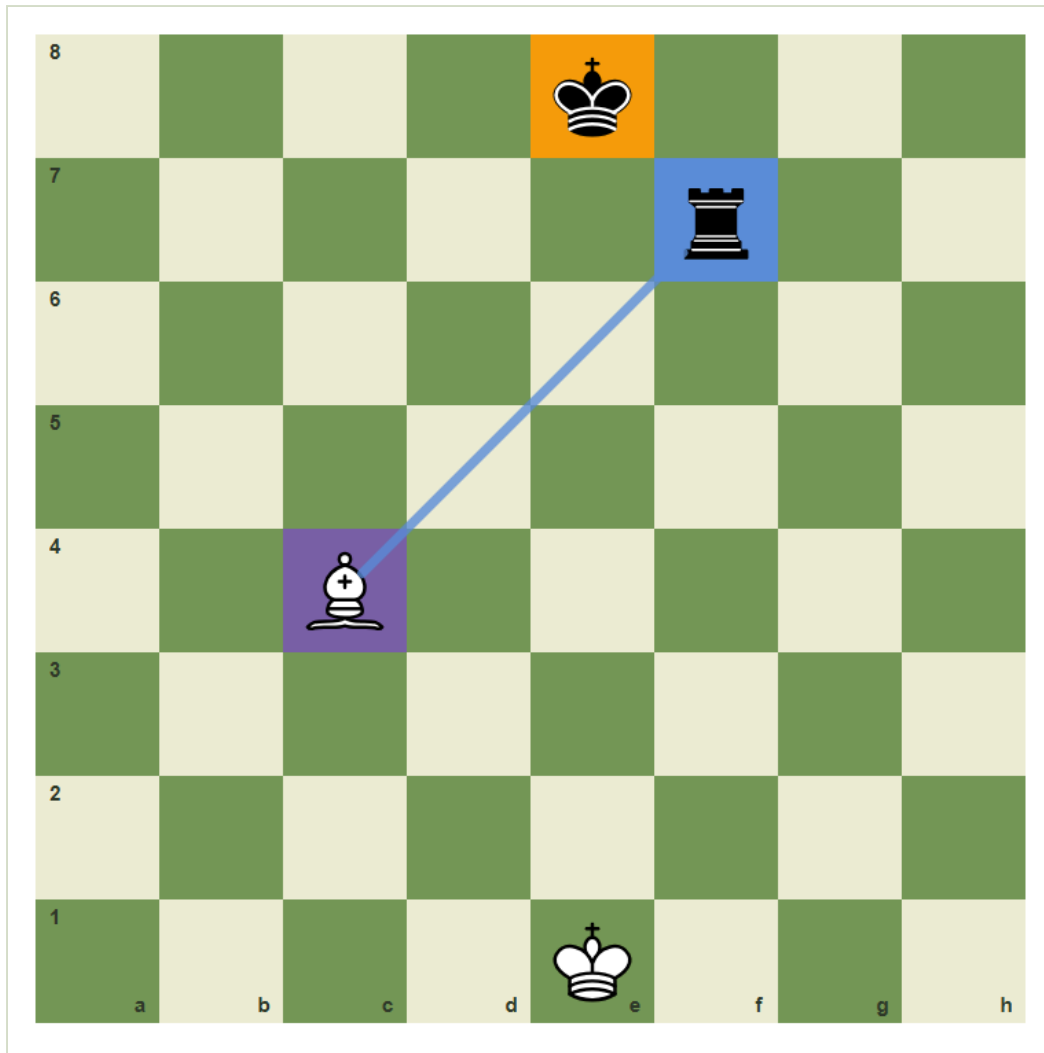
Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

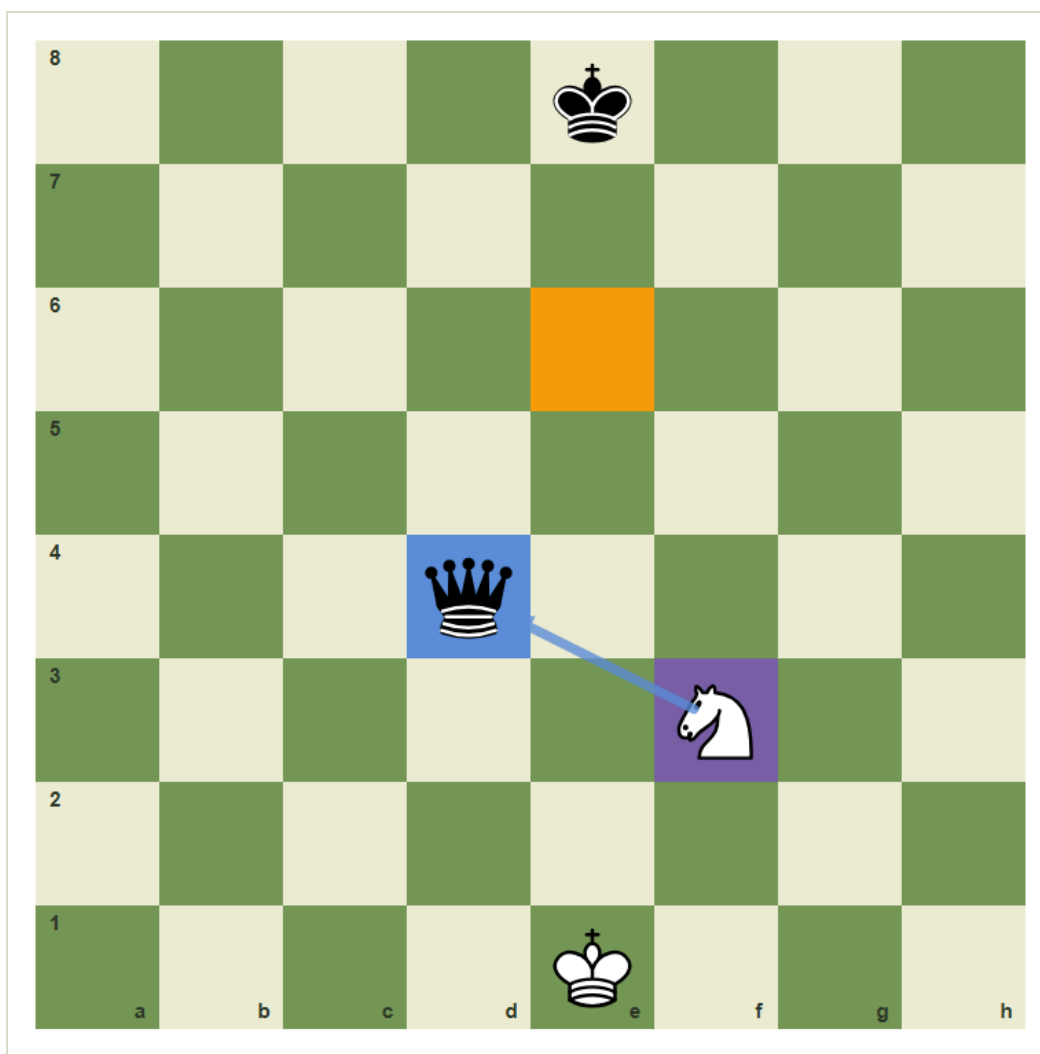


The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

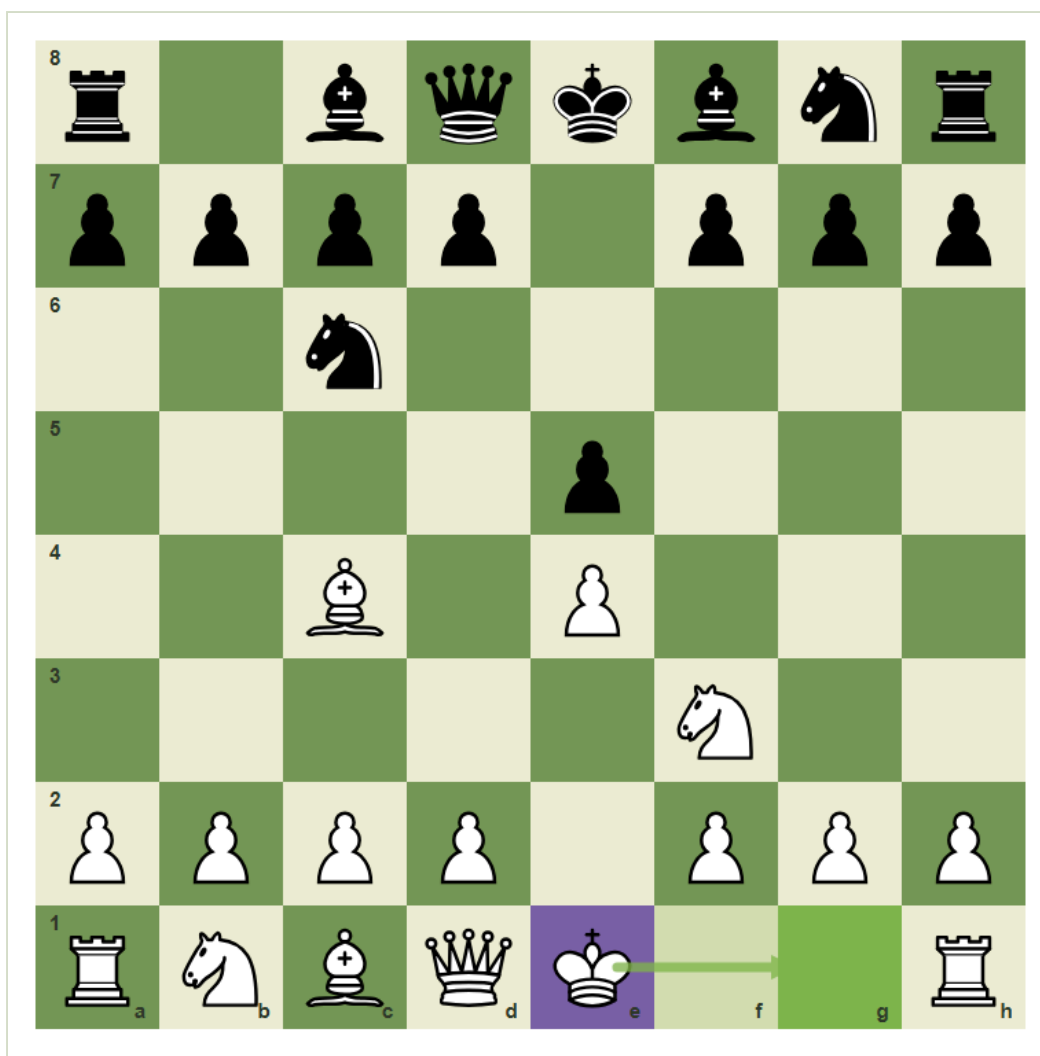
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



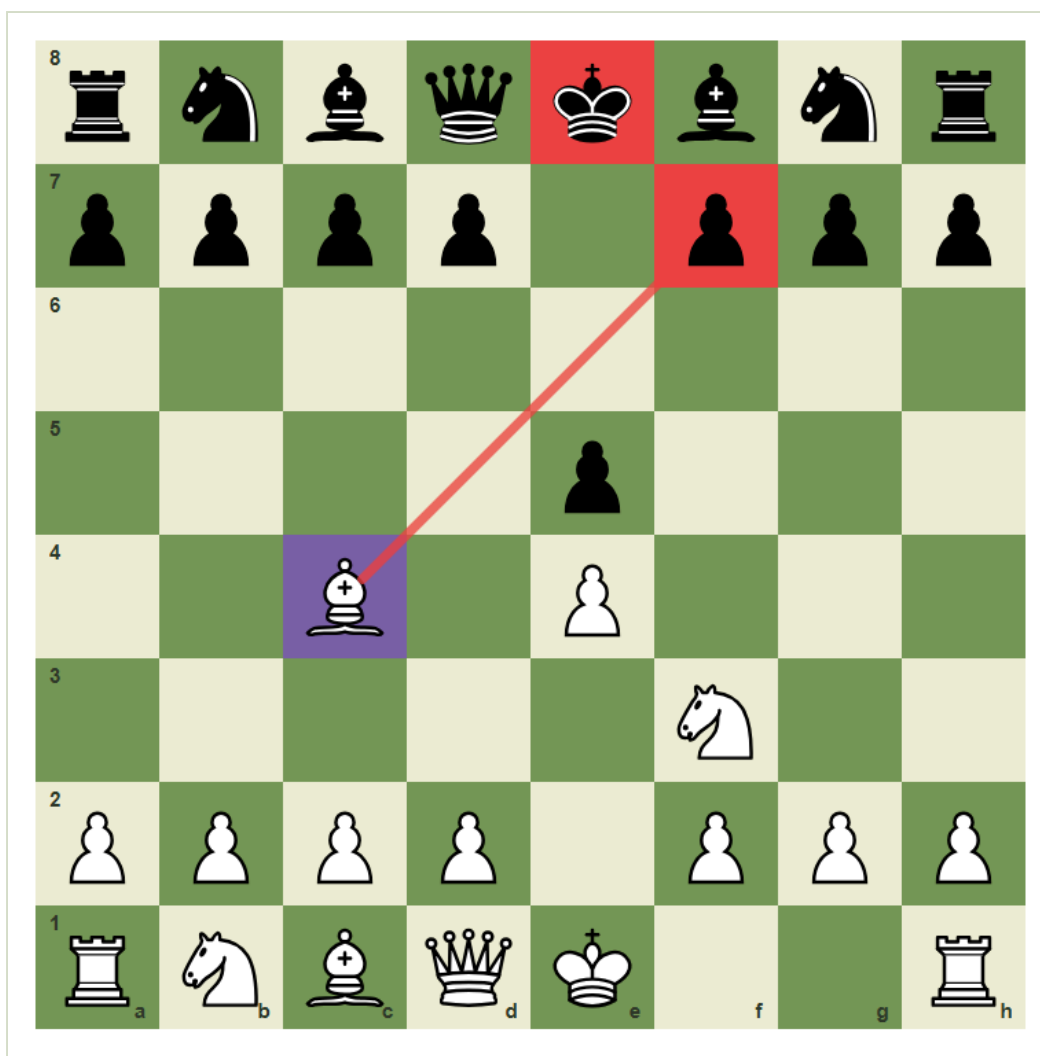
A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

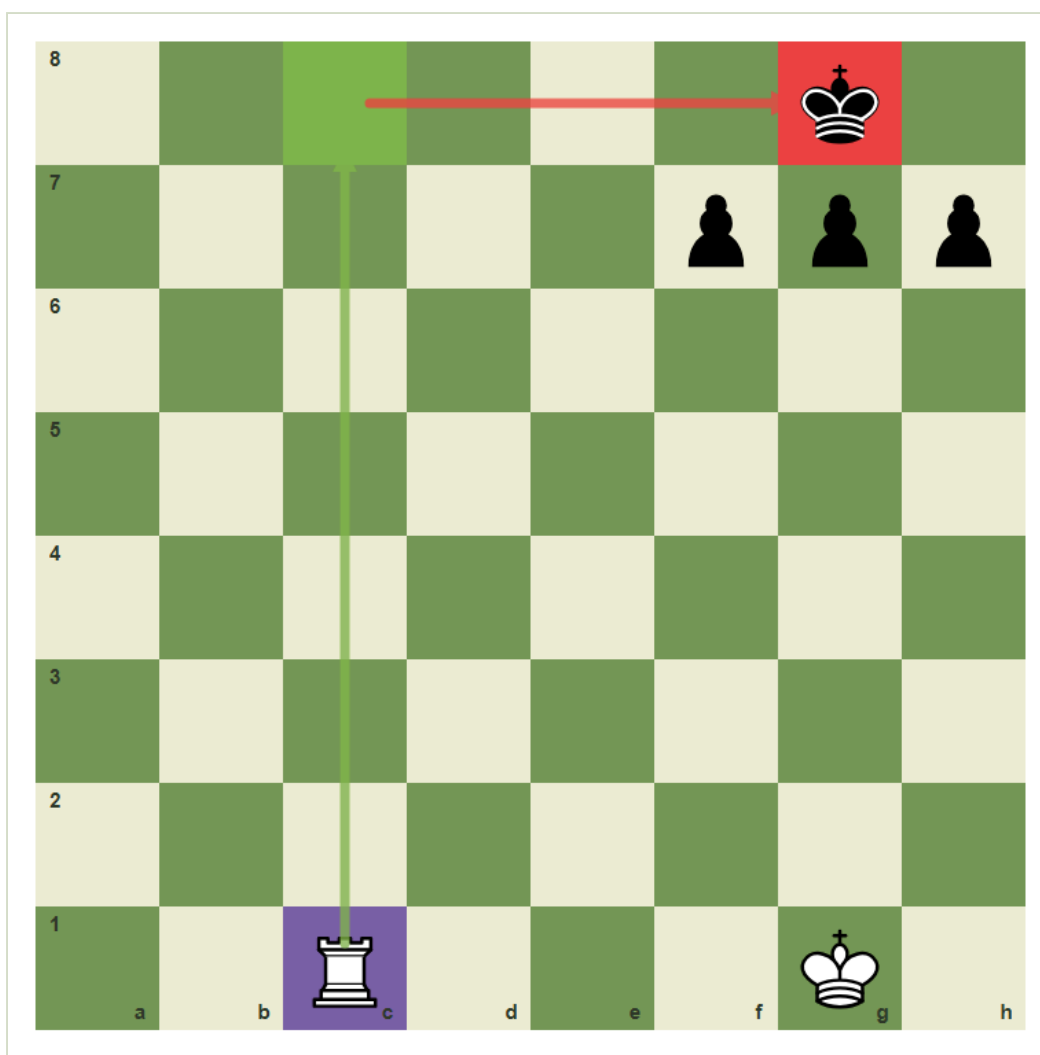
Training Diagram: review position



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

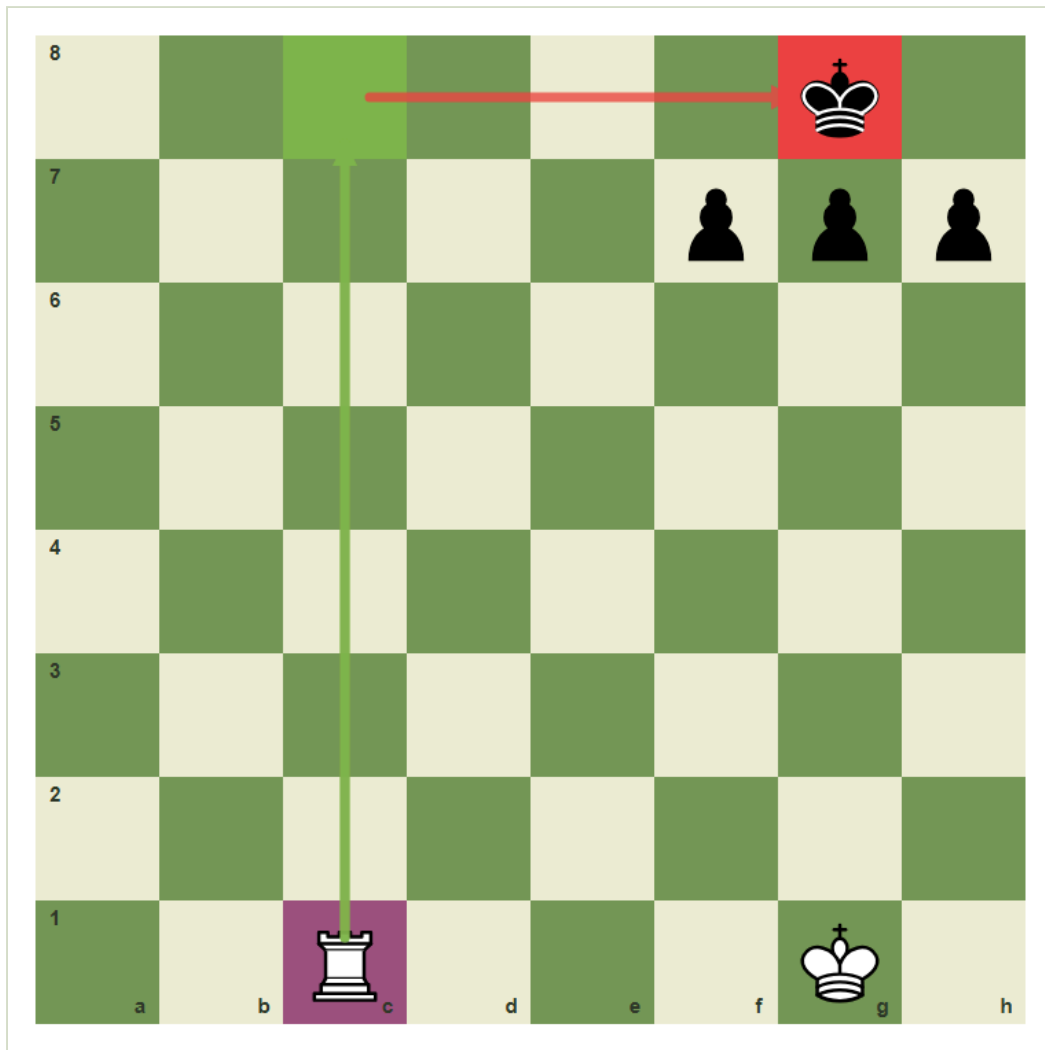
Play the highlighted move from **c1** to **c8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **pawn moves that help vs weaken**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **pawn moves that help vs weaken**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Moves That Help Vs Weaken Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **pawn moves that help vs weaken**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.e4

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Openings After 1.e4 converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

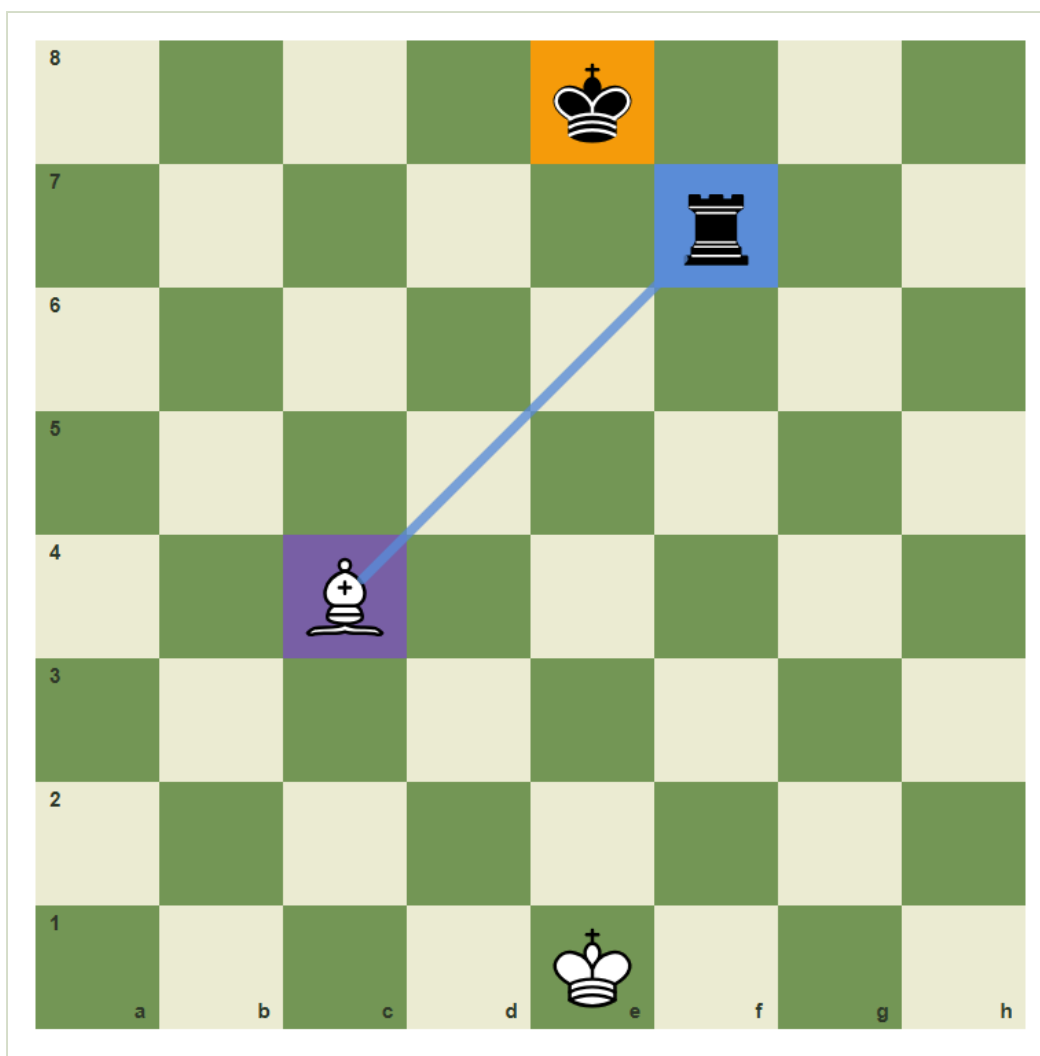
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for openings after 1.e4.
- Choose a move or plan that fits openings after 1.e4.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with openings after 1.e4.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

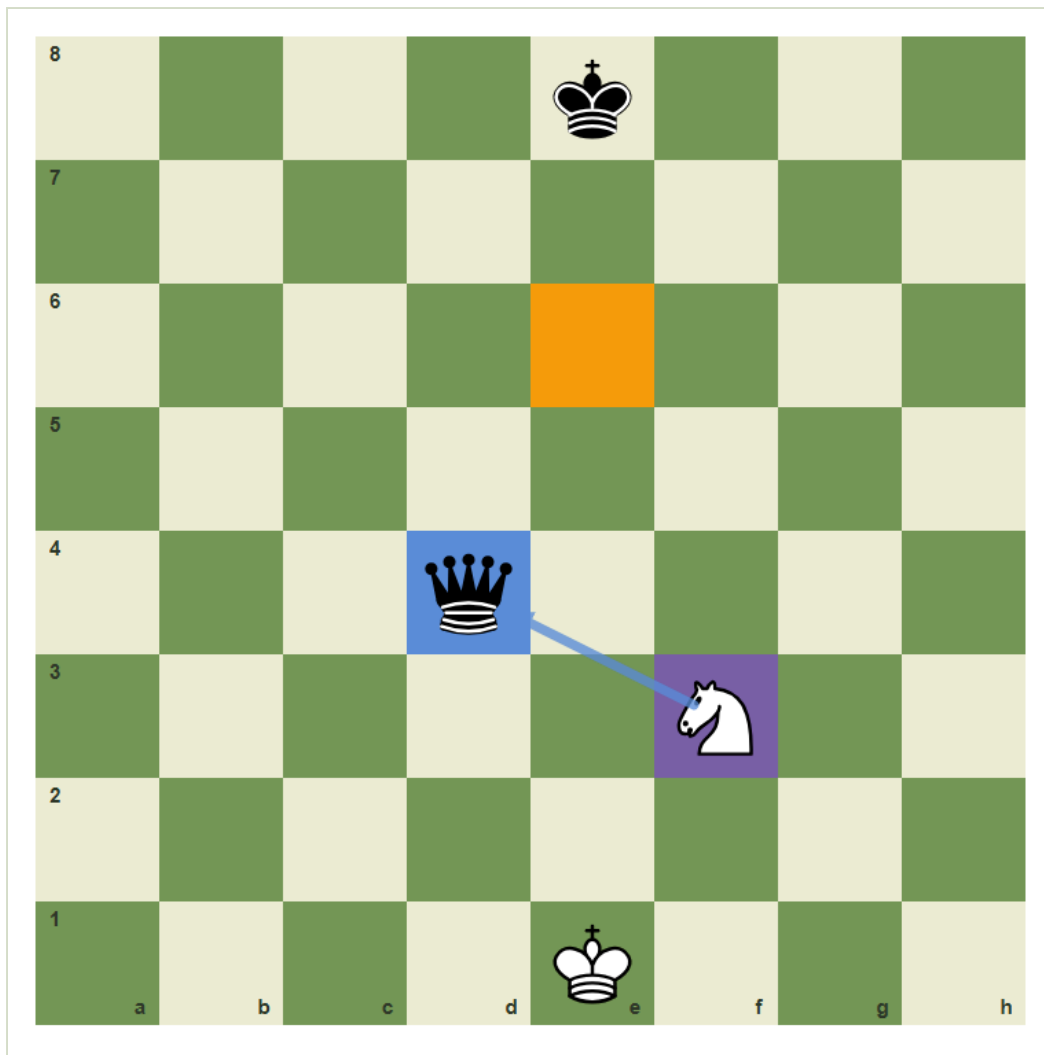
Openings After 1.e4 is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

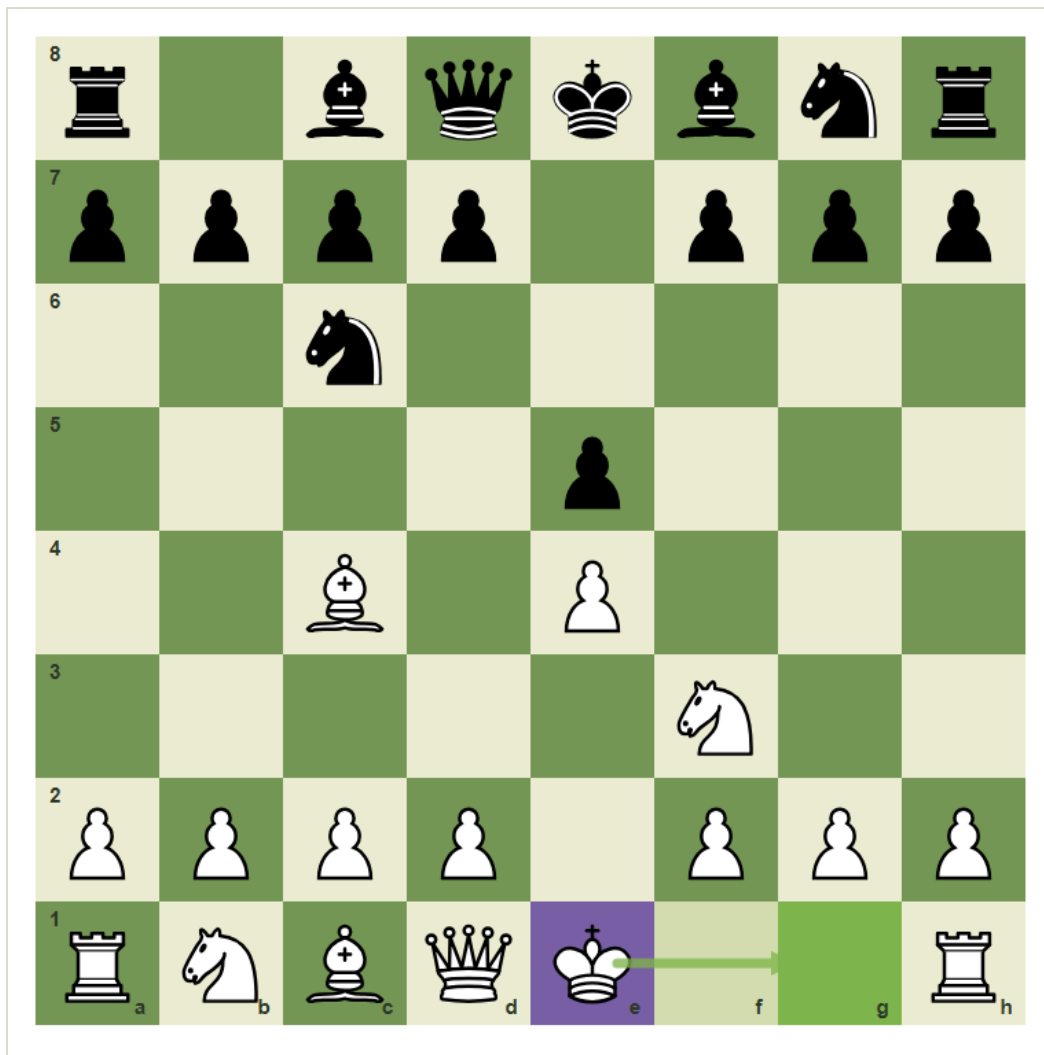


A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

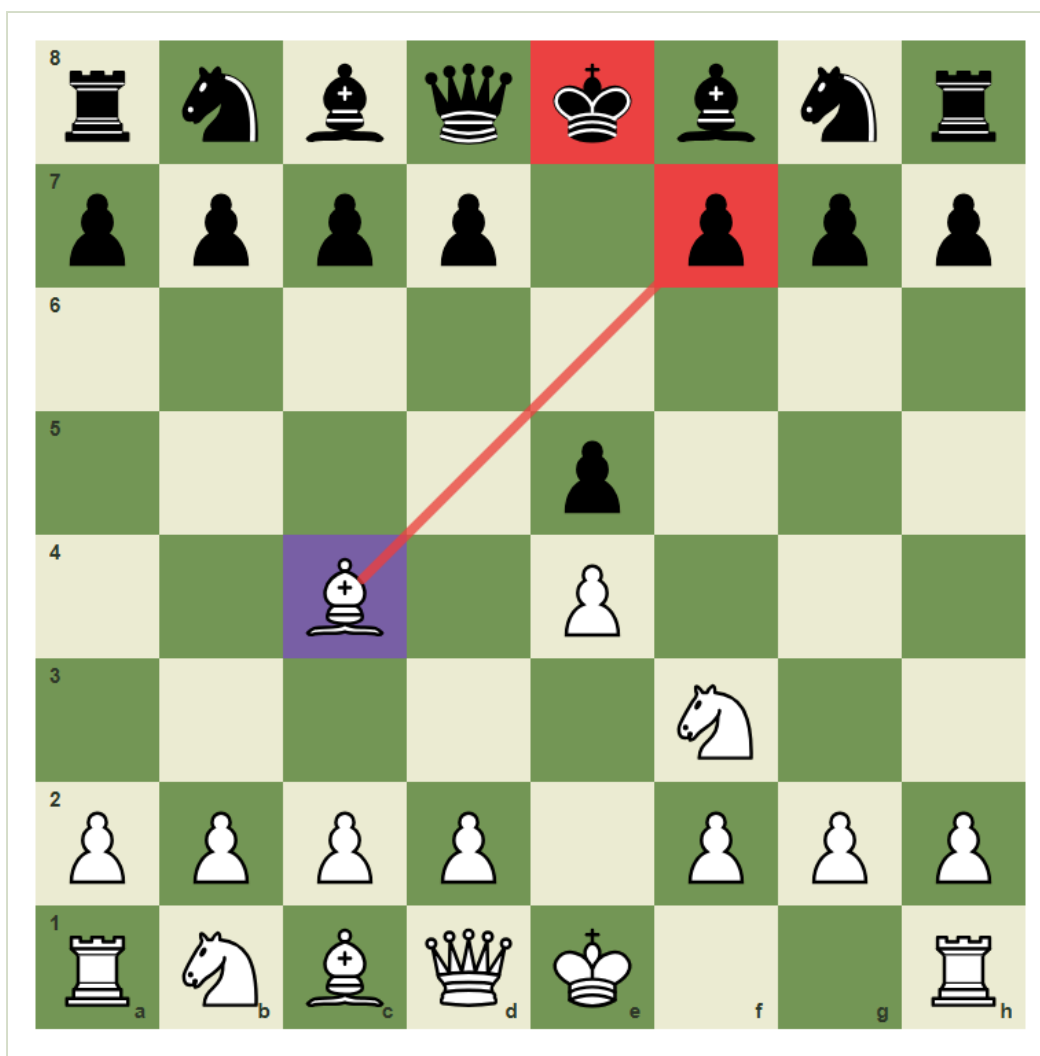
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



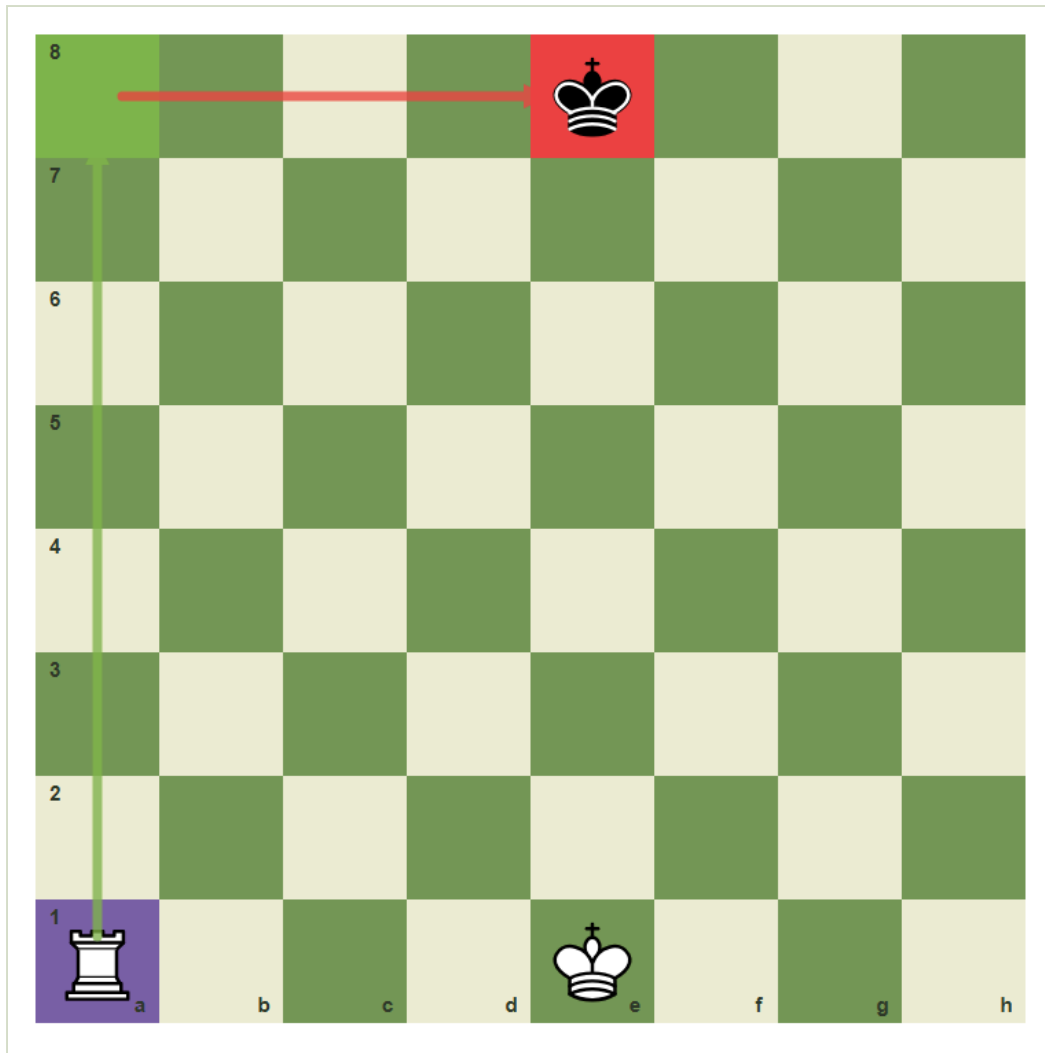
King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

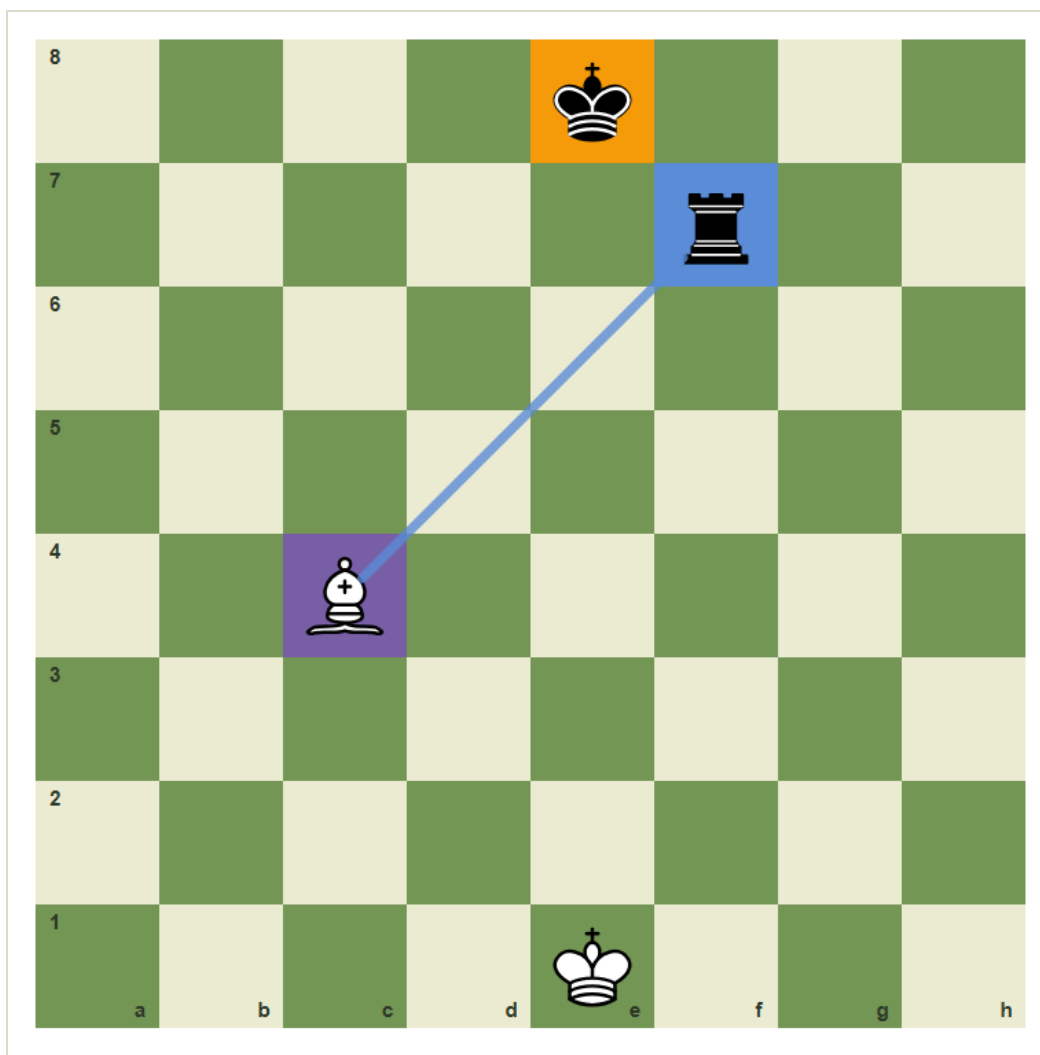
Training Diagram: review position



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

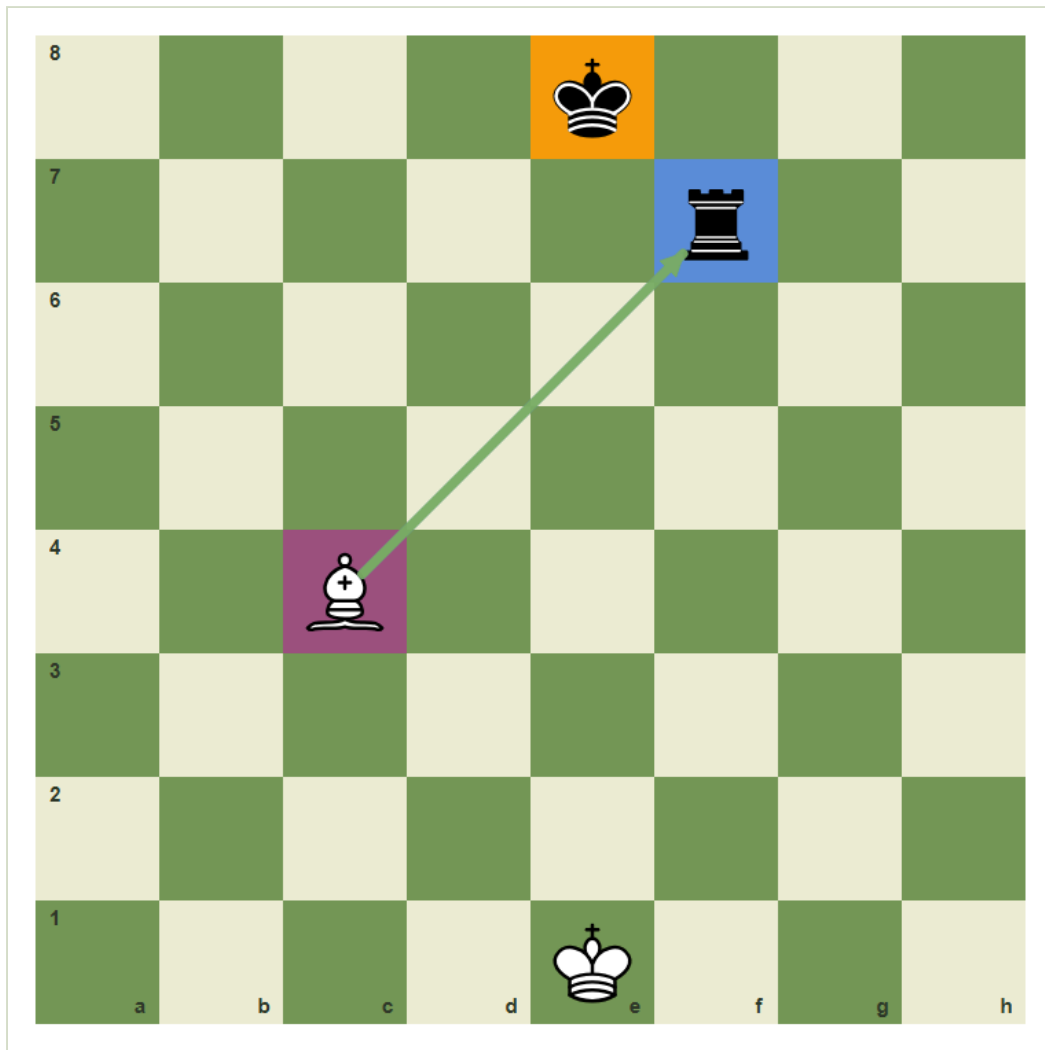
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Openings After 1.e4 Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **openings after 1.e4**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.e4 Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **openings after 1.e4**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.e4 Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **openings after 1.e4**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.d4

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Openings After 1.d4 converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

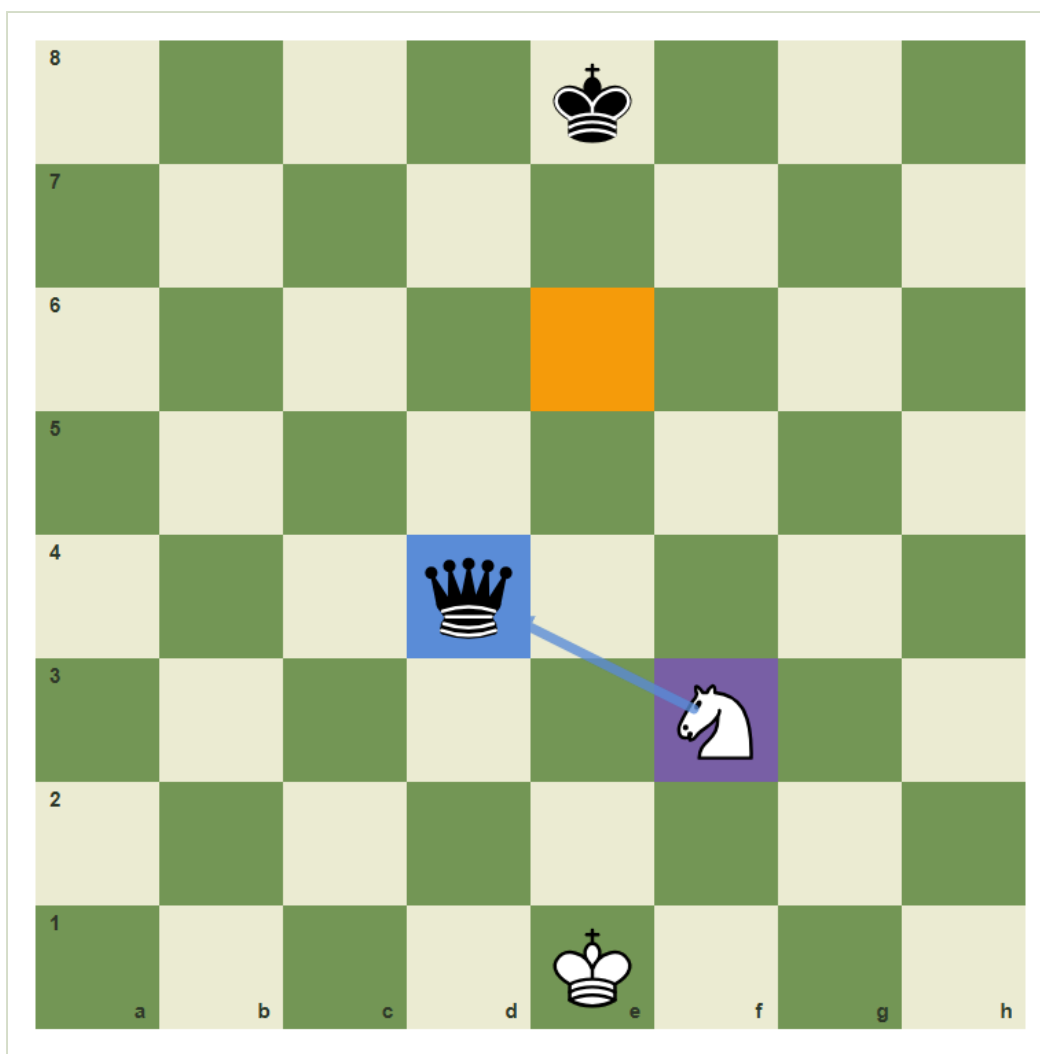
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for openings after 1.d4.
- Choose a move or plan that fits openings after 1.d4.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with openings after 1.d4.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

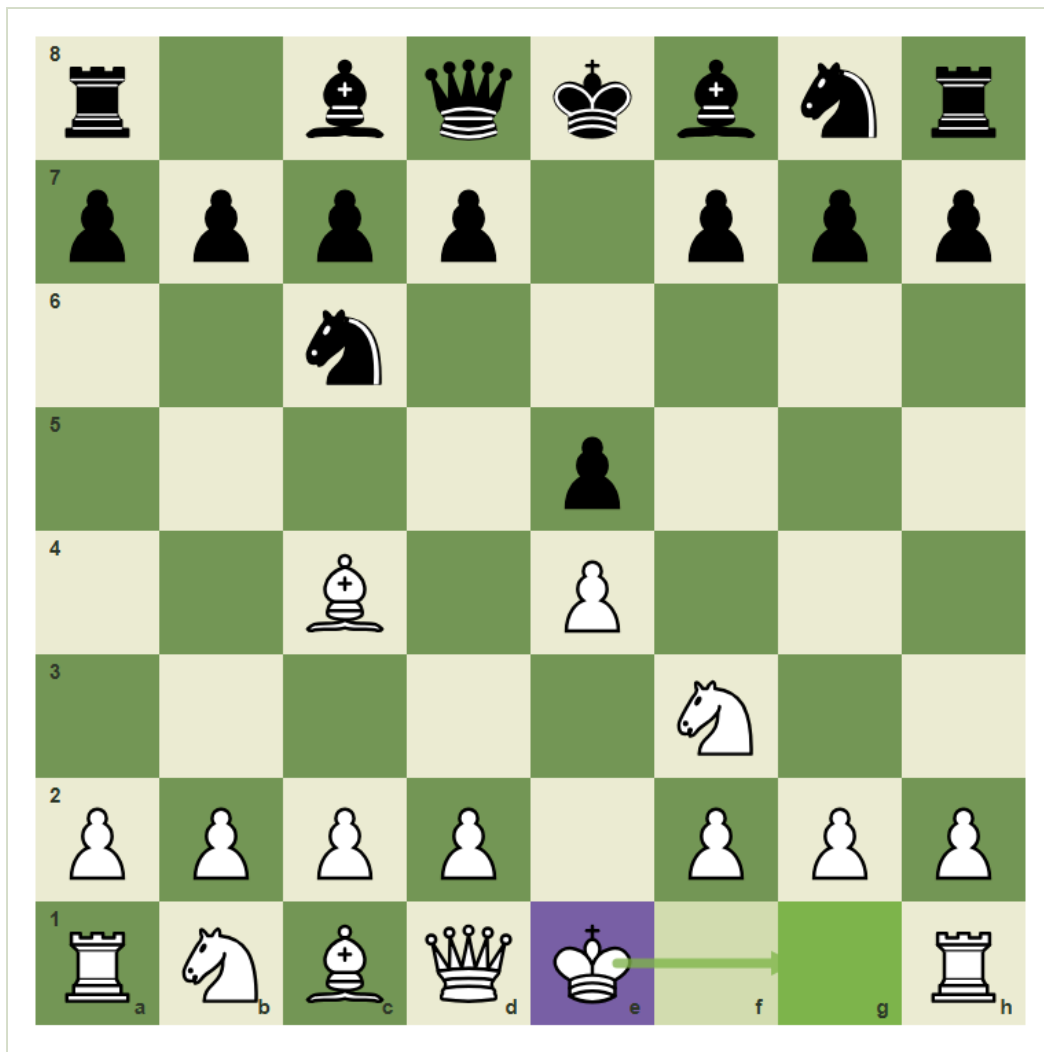
Openings After 1.d4 is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

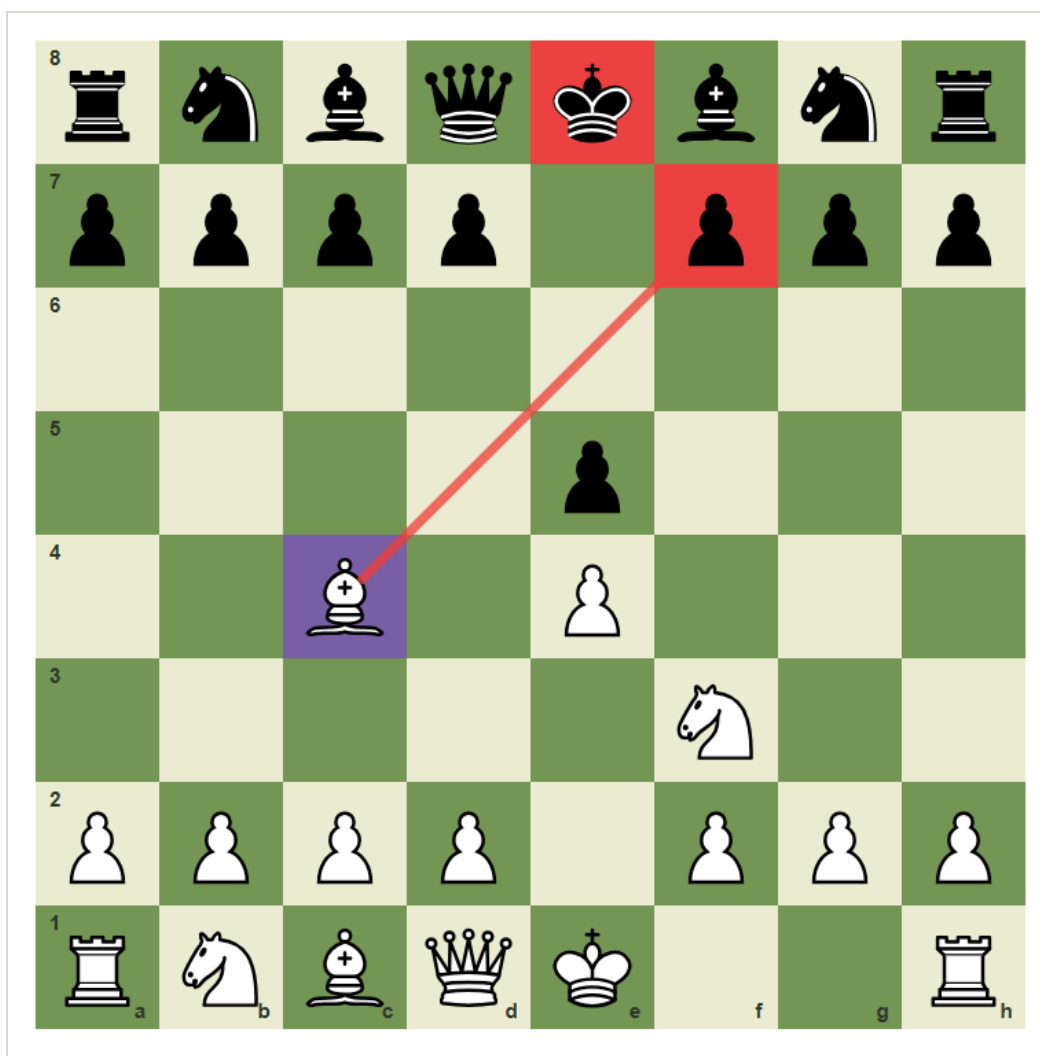


King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

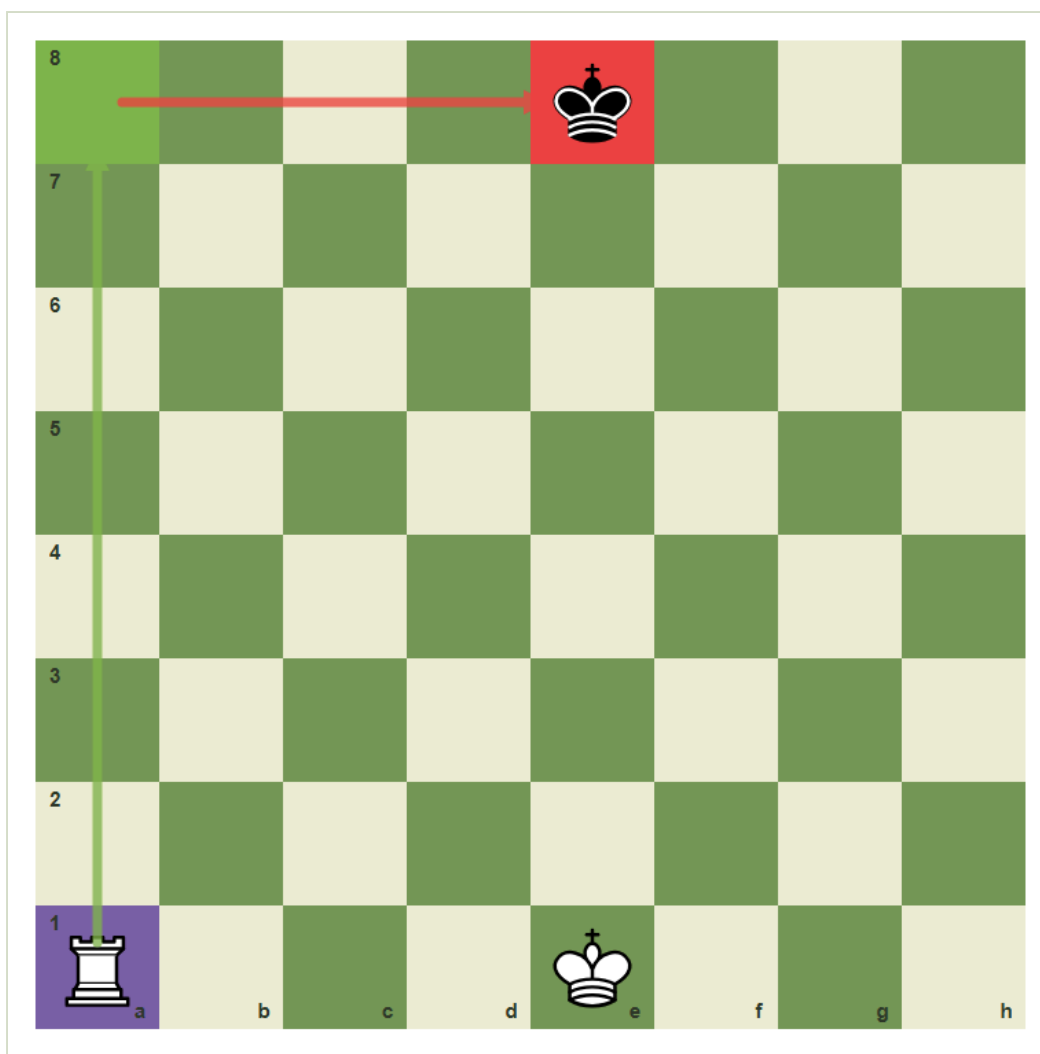
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



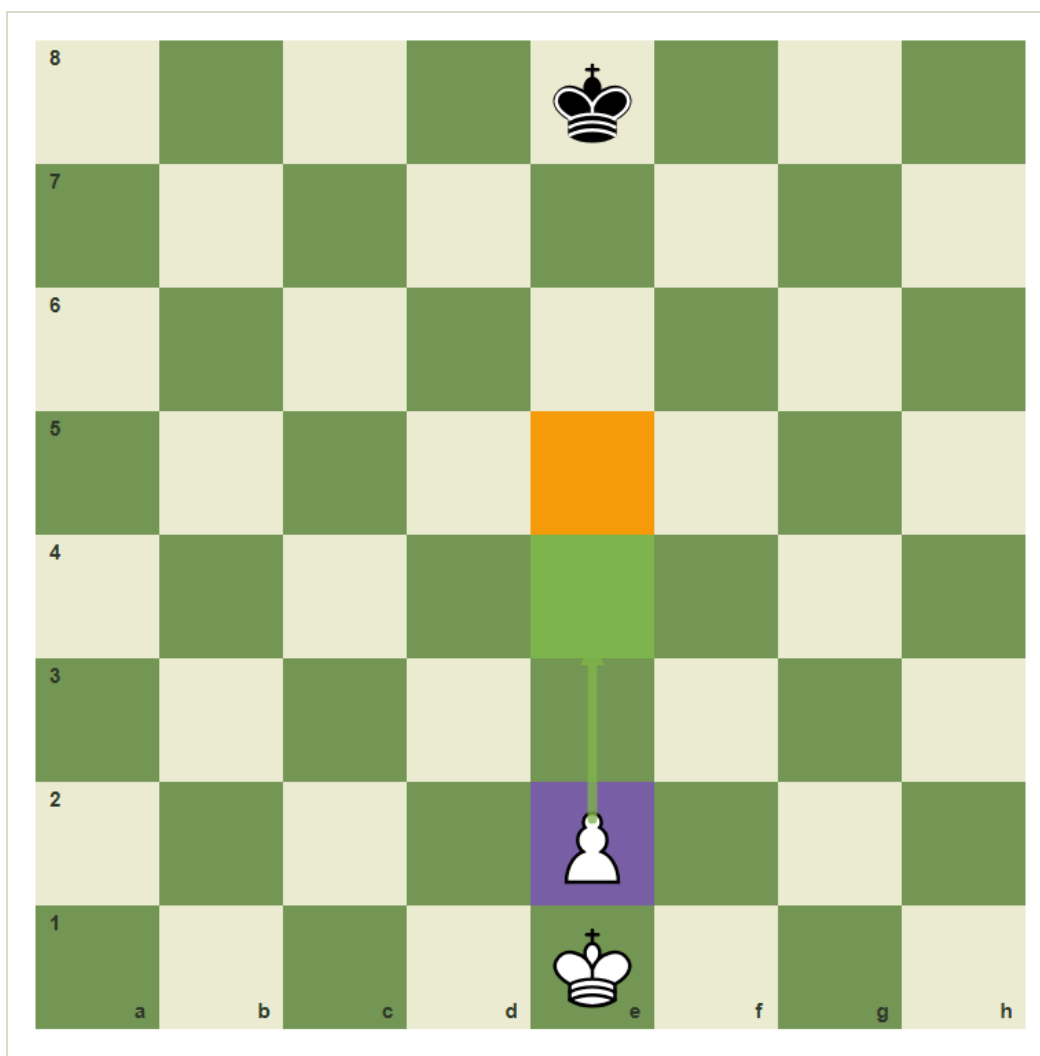
Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

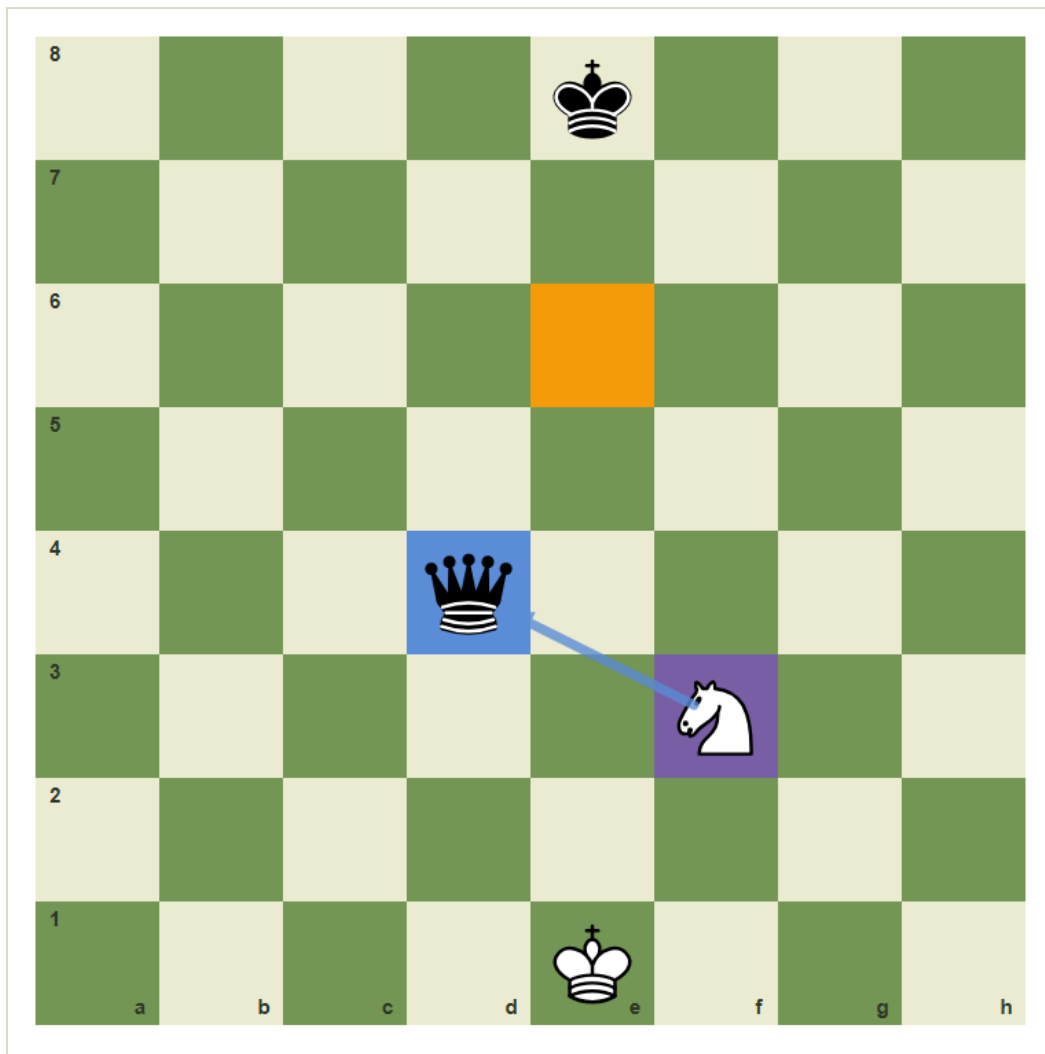
Training Diagram: review position



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

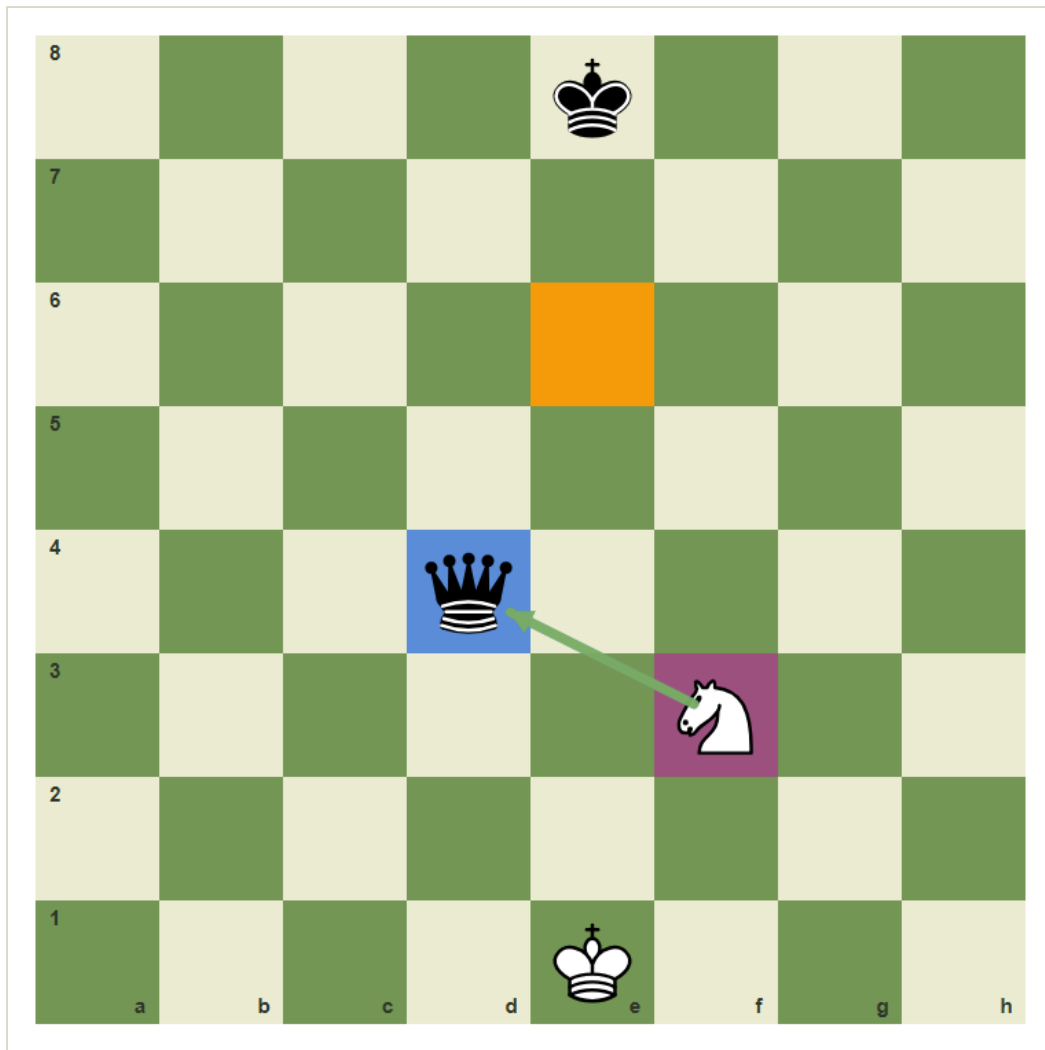
Play the highlighted move from **f3** to **d4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Openings After 1.d4 Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **openings after 1.d4**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.d4 Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **openings after 1.d4**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Openings After 1.d4 Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **openings after 1.d4**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves

Opening Habits For Real Games | 900-1200 | silver

When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

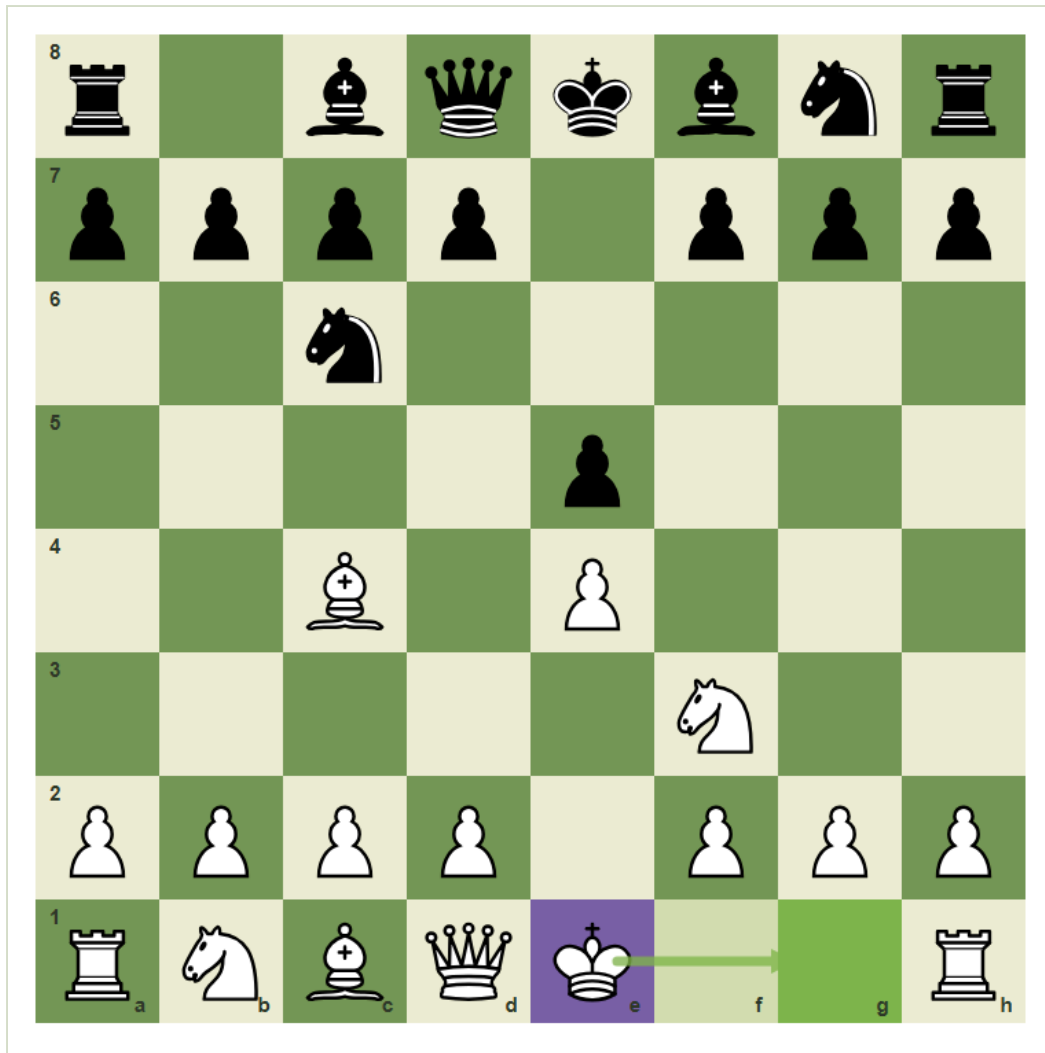
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for when the opponent plays strange moves.
- Choose a move or plan that fits when the opponent plays strange moves.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with when the opponent plays strange moves.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

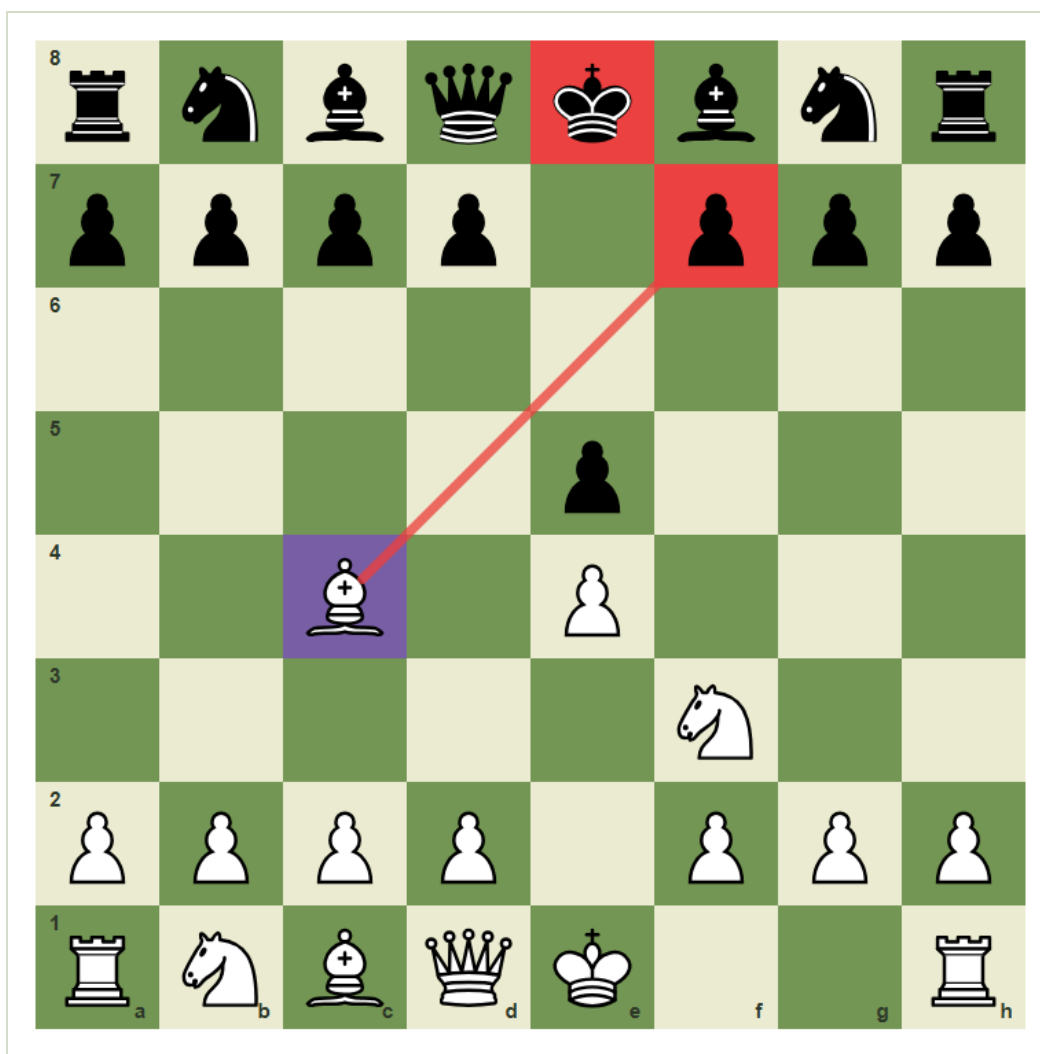
When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

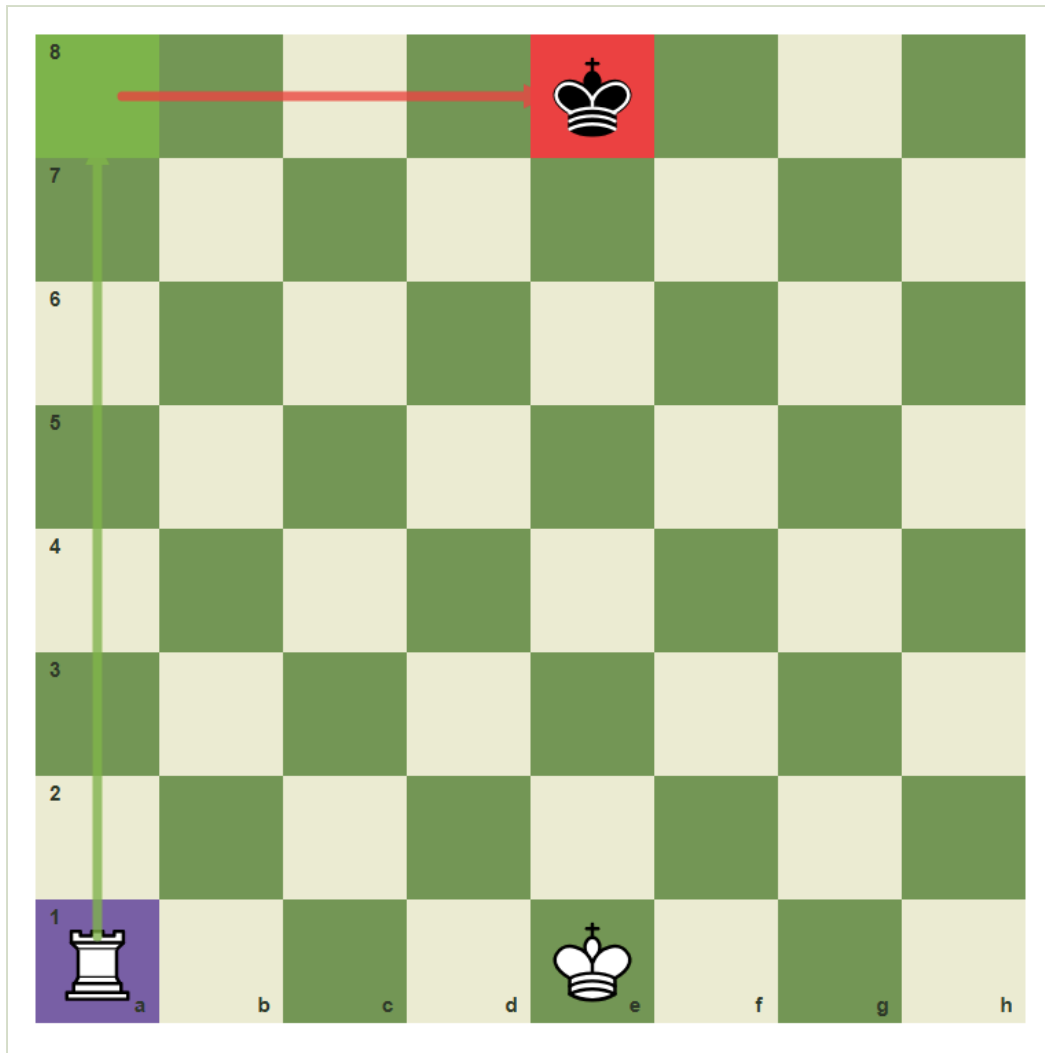


Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

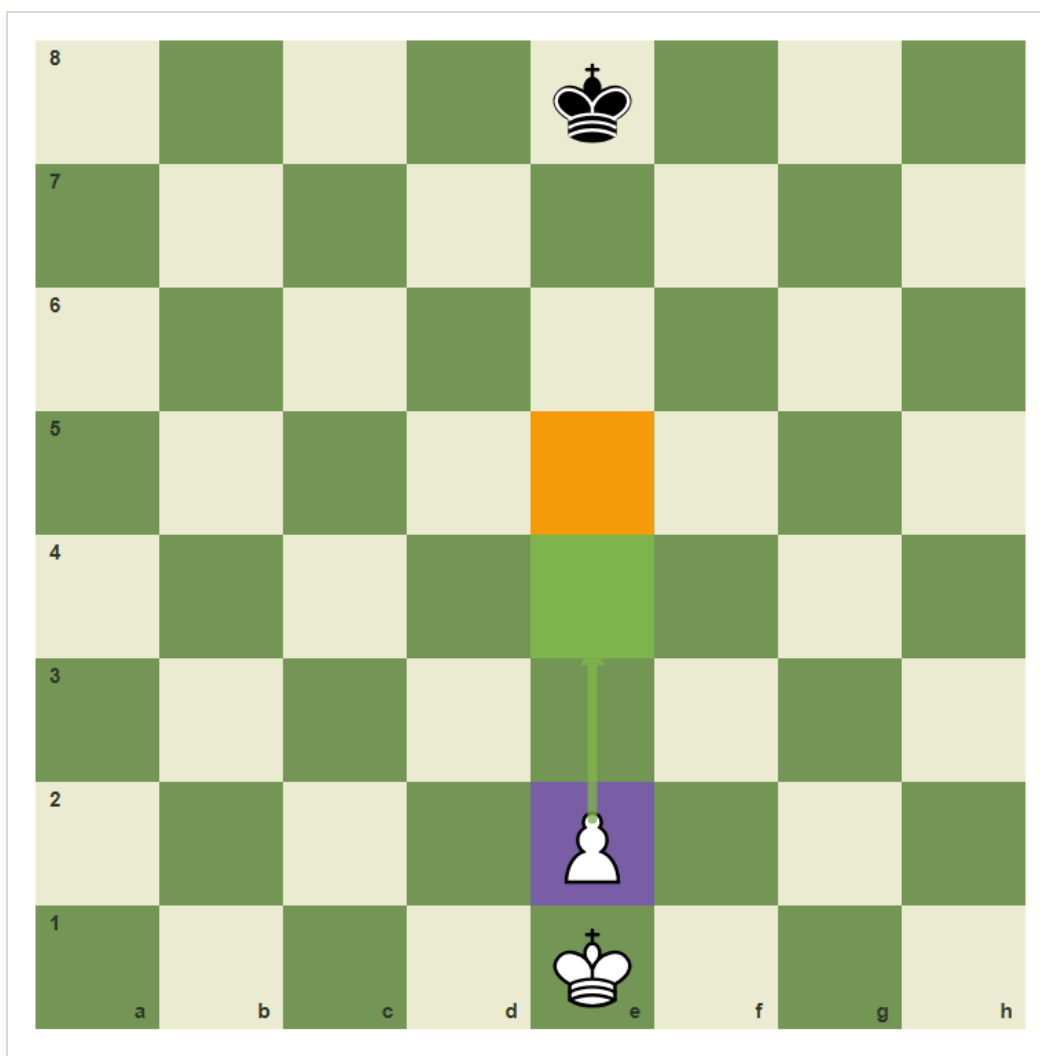
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



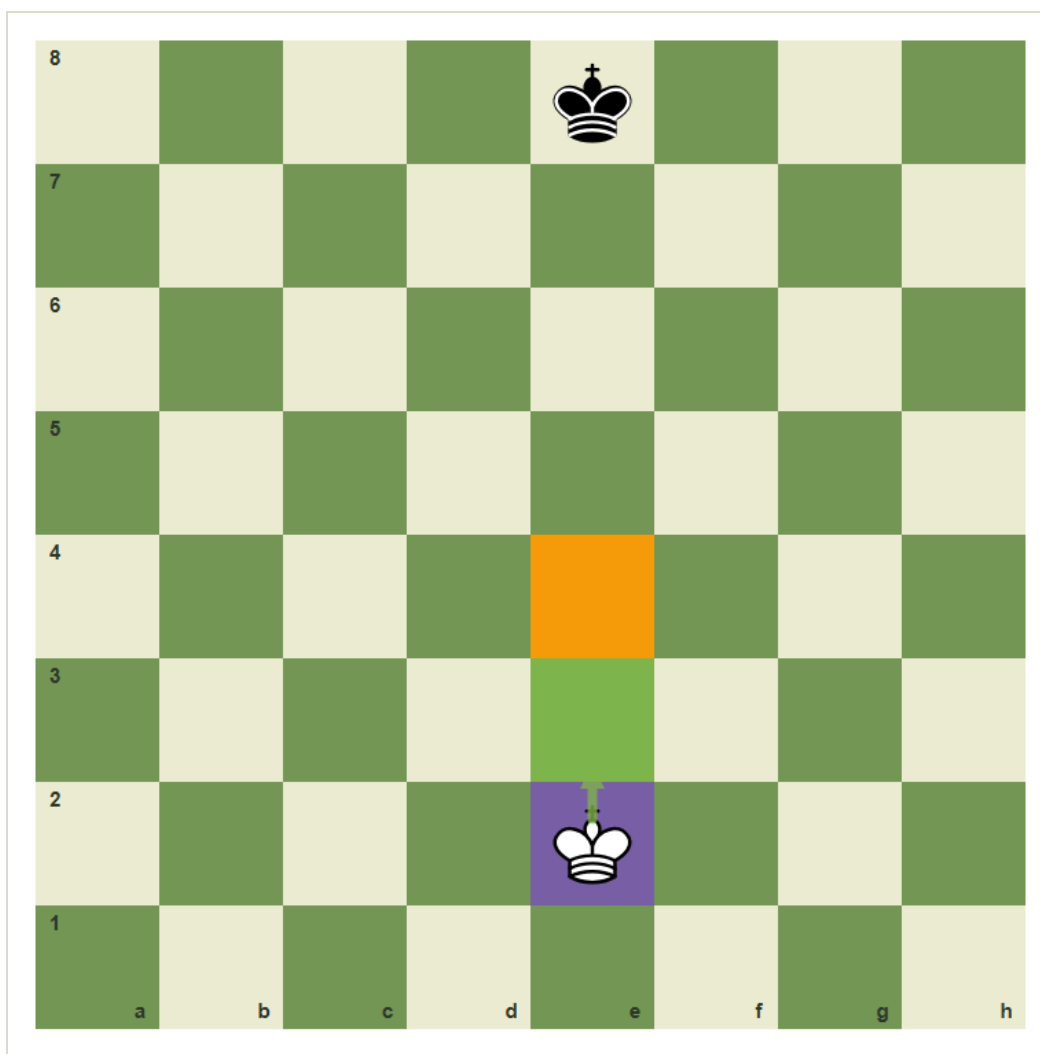
Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

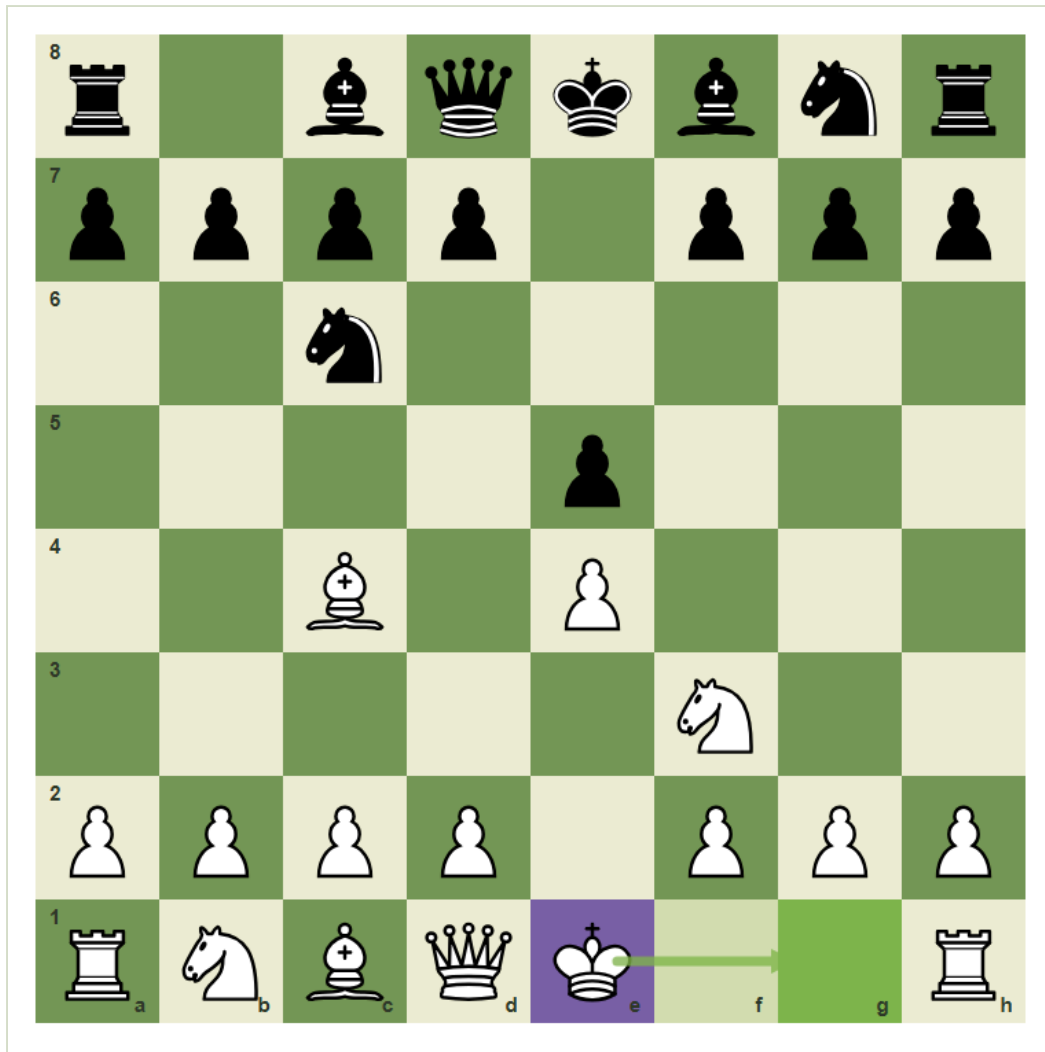
Training Diagram: review position



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

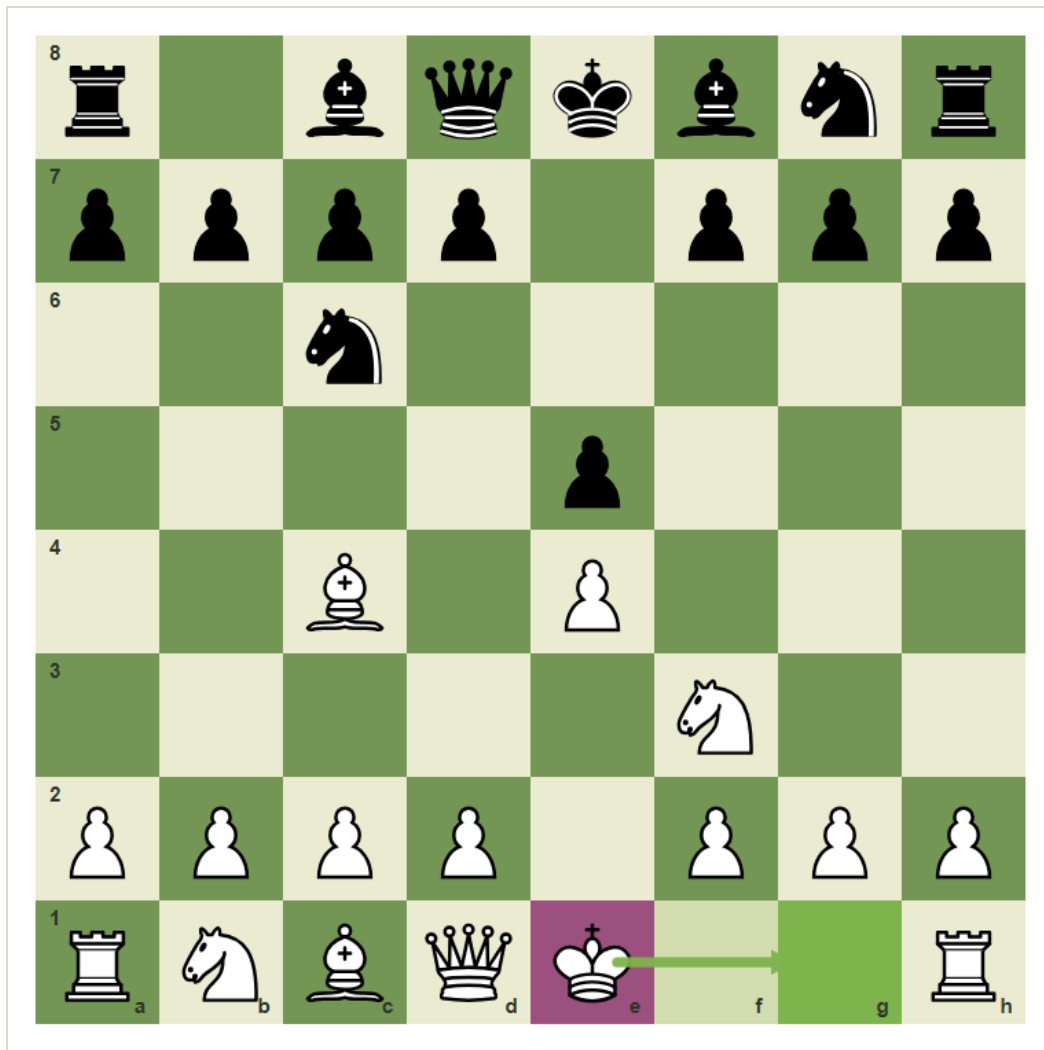
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **g1**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **when the opponent plays strange moves?**

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **when the opponent plays strange moves**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When The Opponent Plays Strange Moves Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **when the opponent plays strange moves**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

First Ten-Move Plans

Opening Habits For Real Games | 900-1200 | silver

First Ten-Move Plans converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

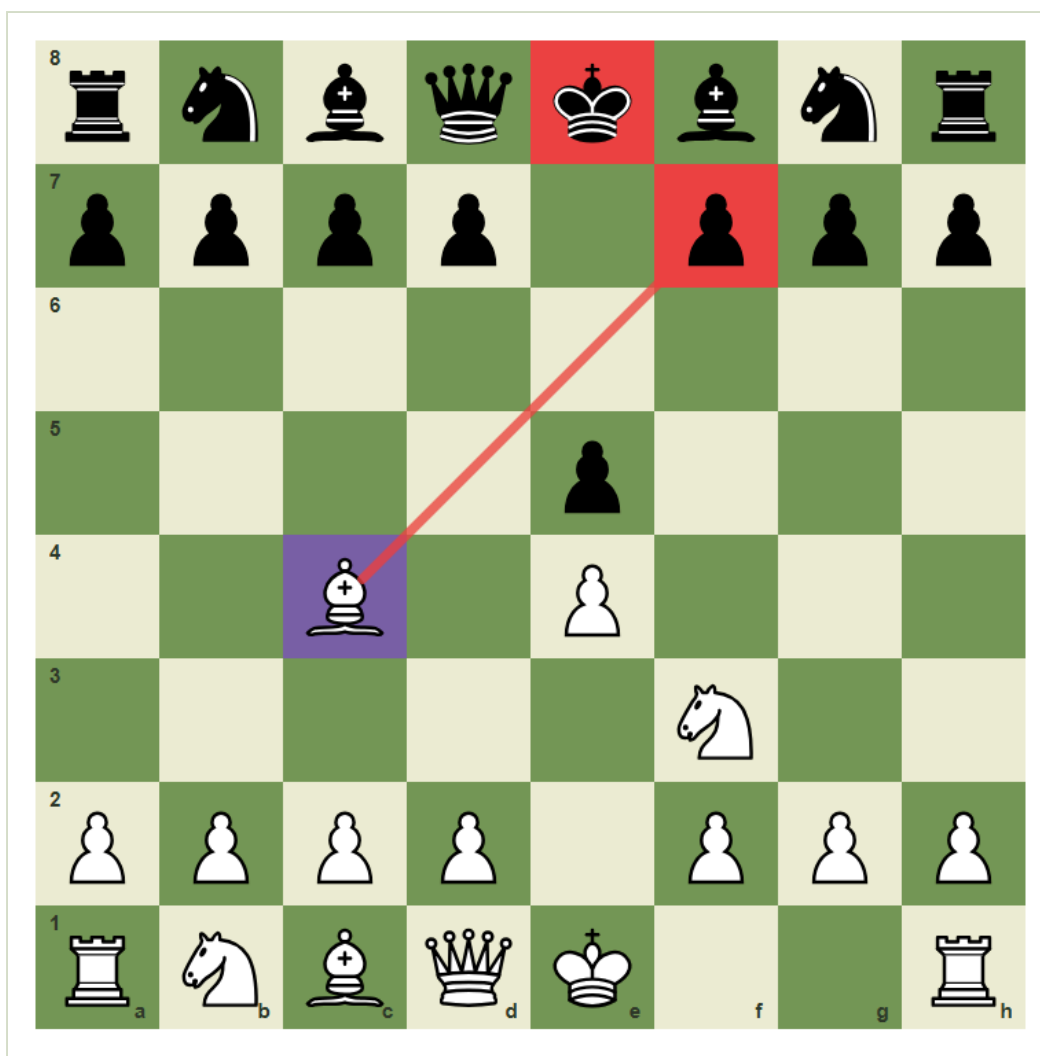
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for first ten-move plans.
- Choose a move or plan that fits first ten-move plans.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with first ten-move plans.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

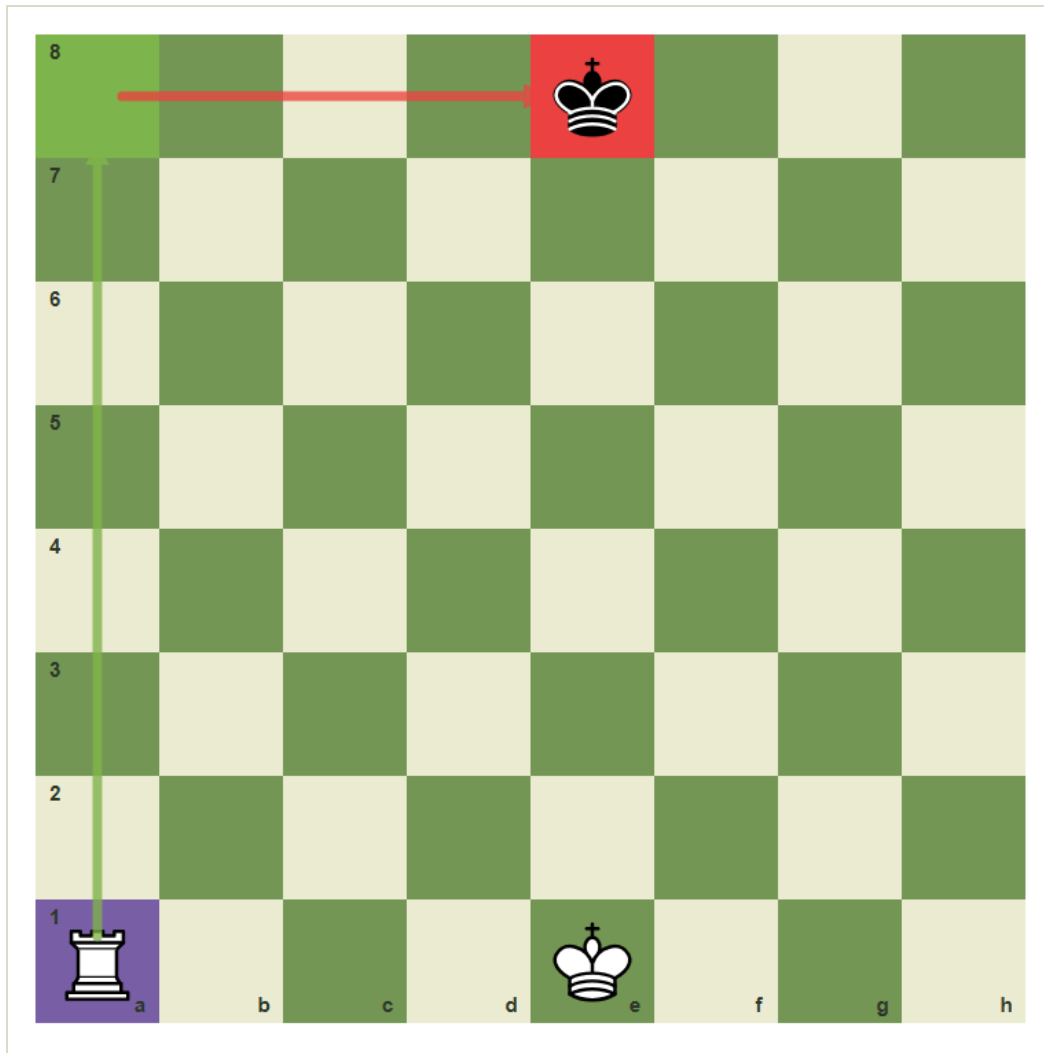
First Ten-Move Plans is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

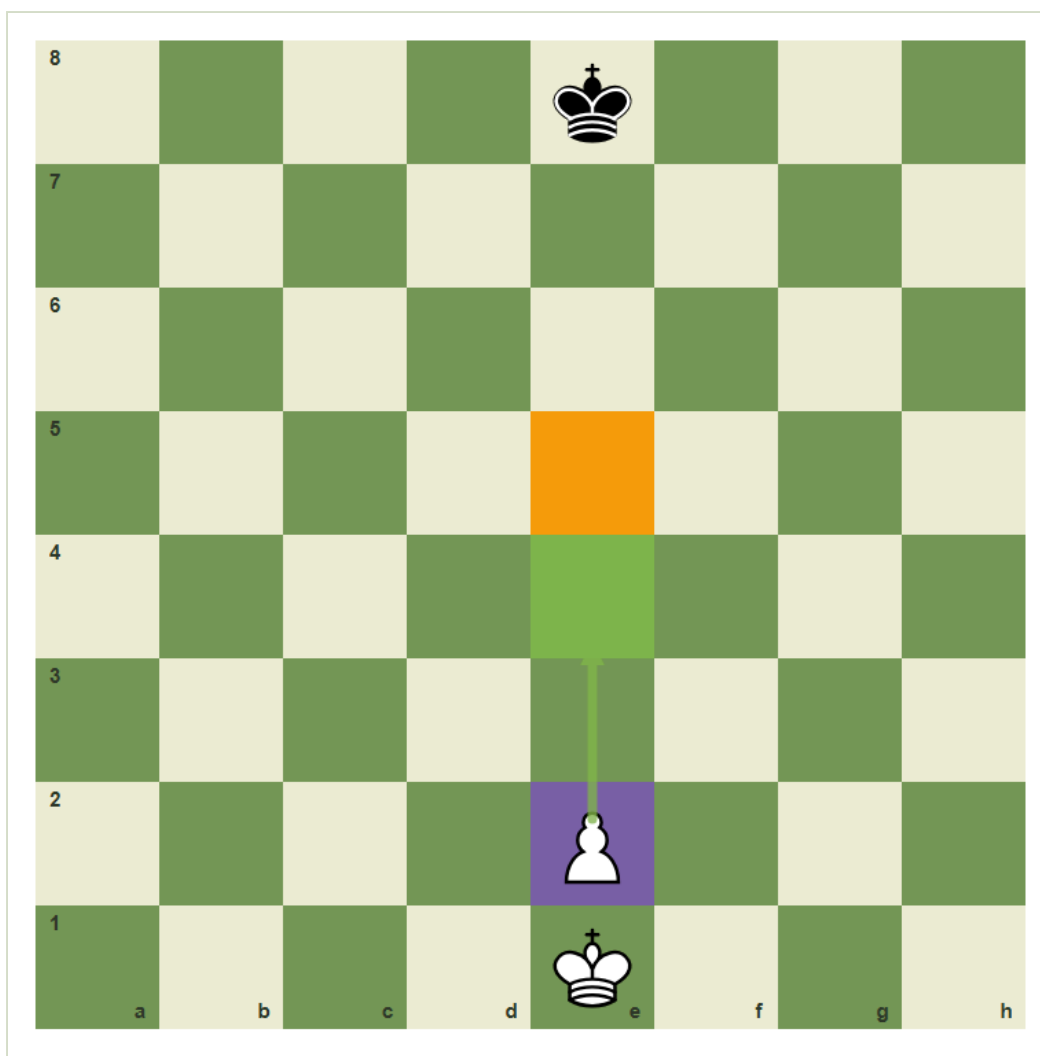


Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

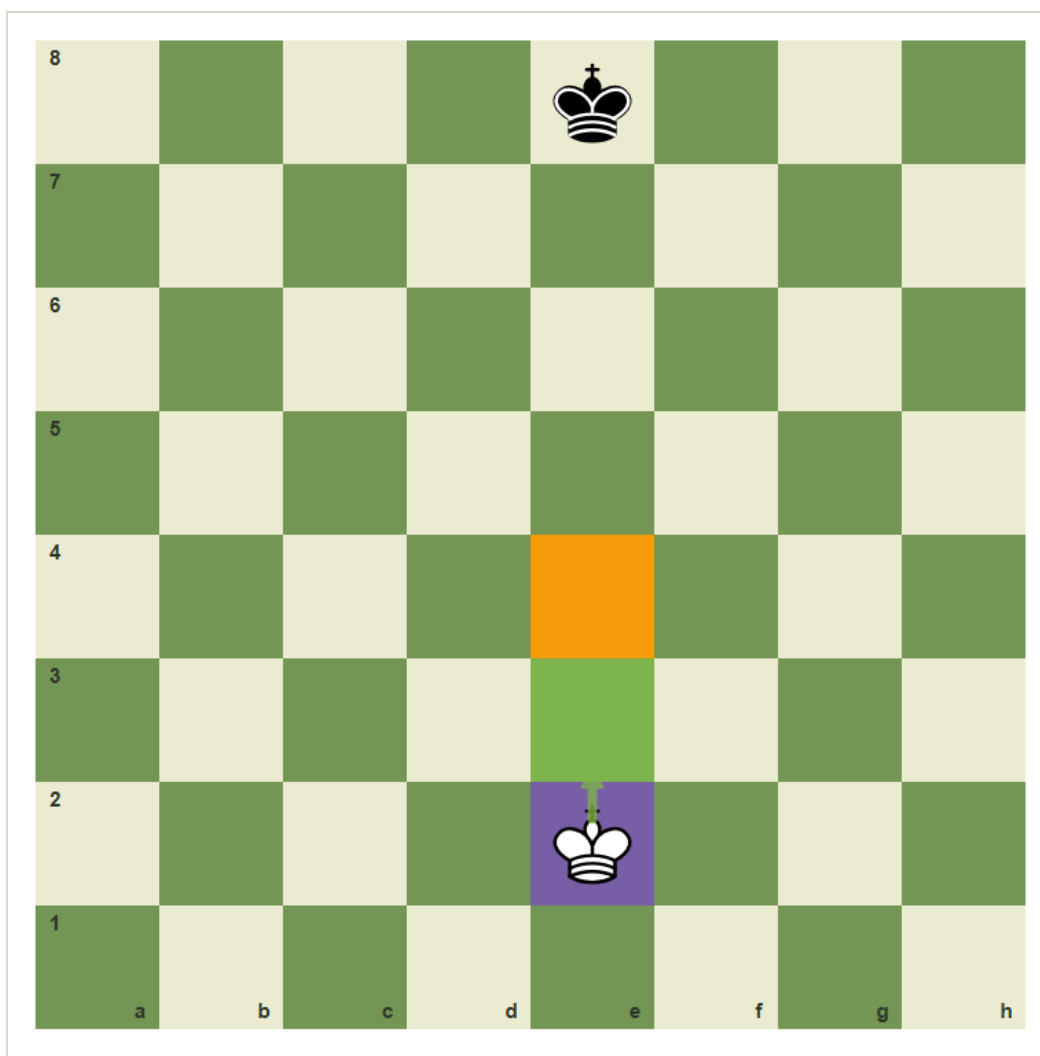
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



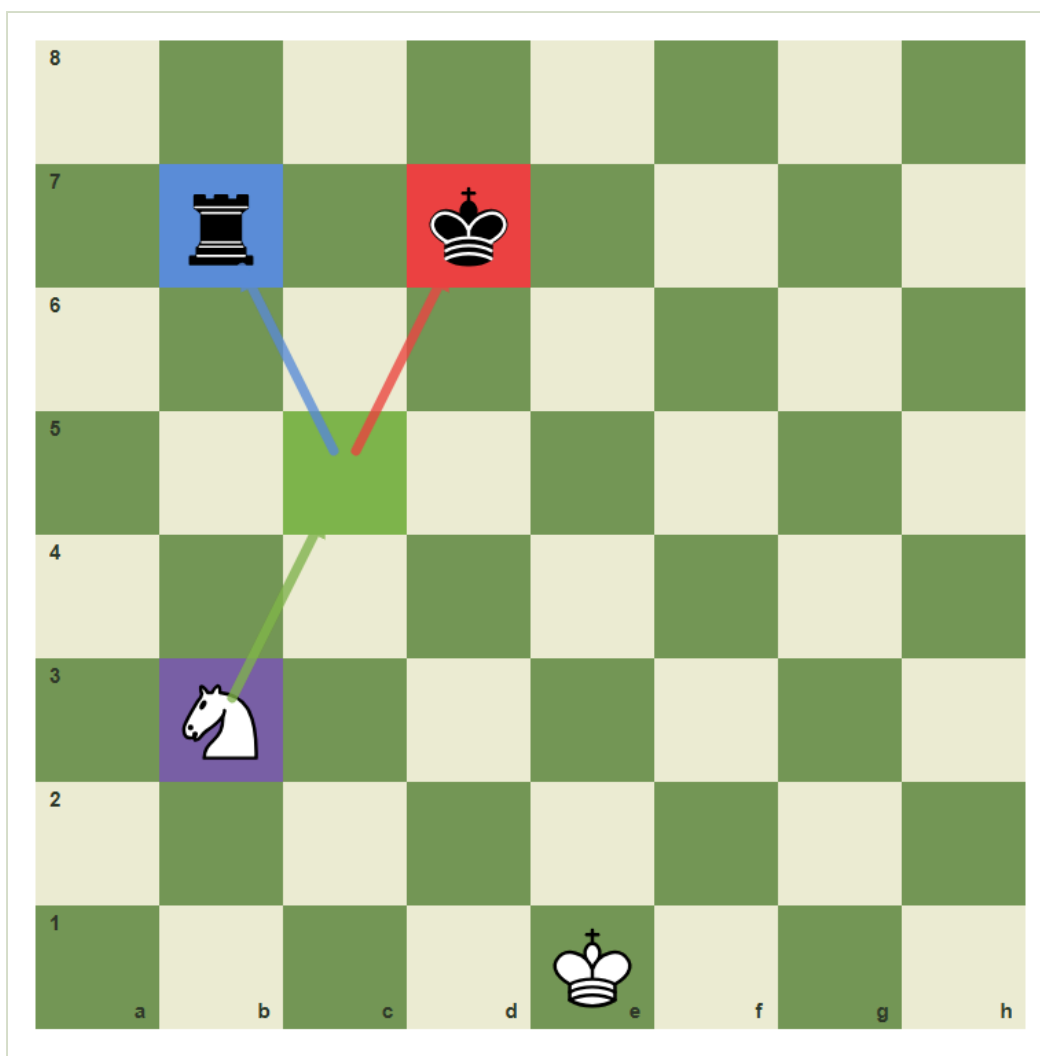
In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

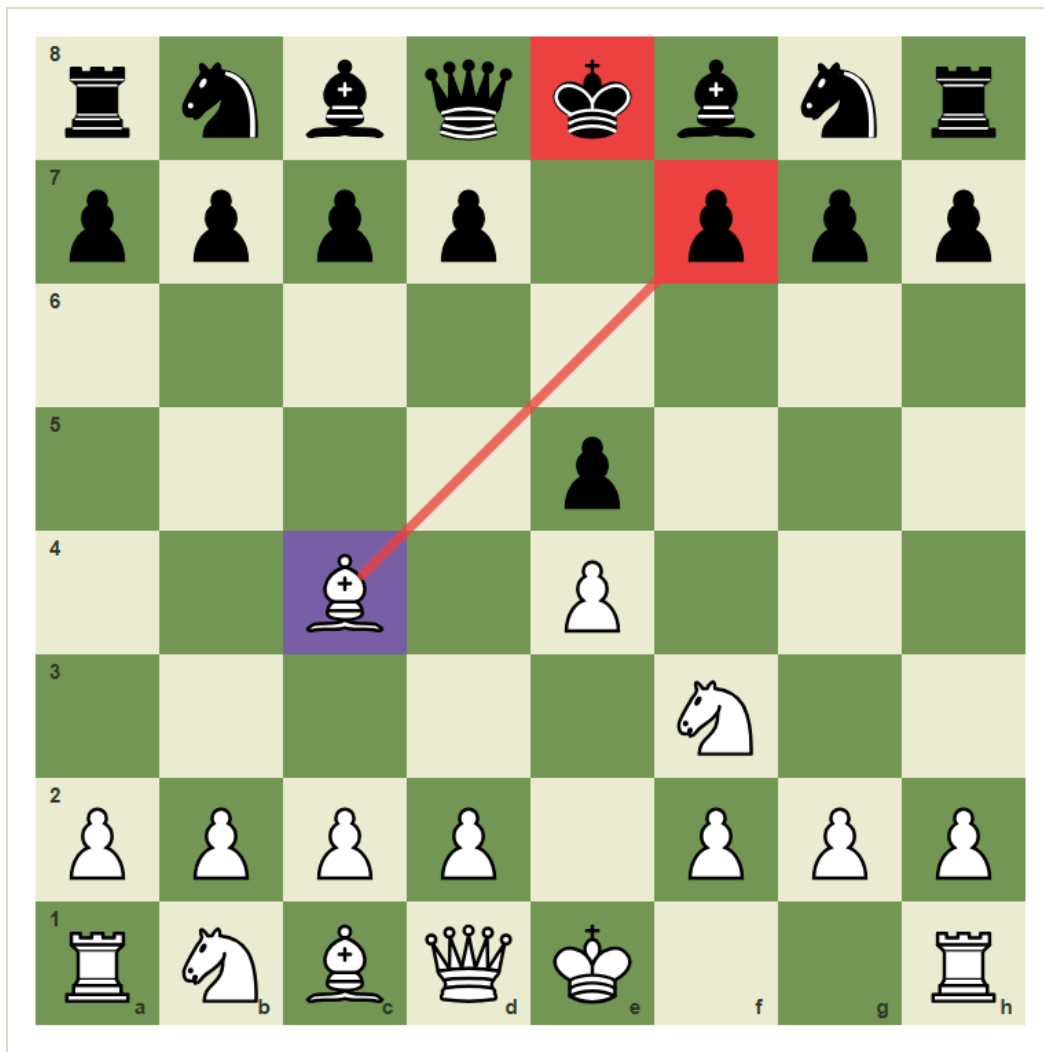
Training Diagram: review position



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

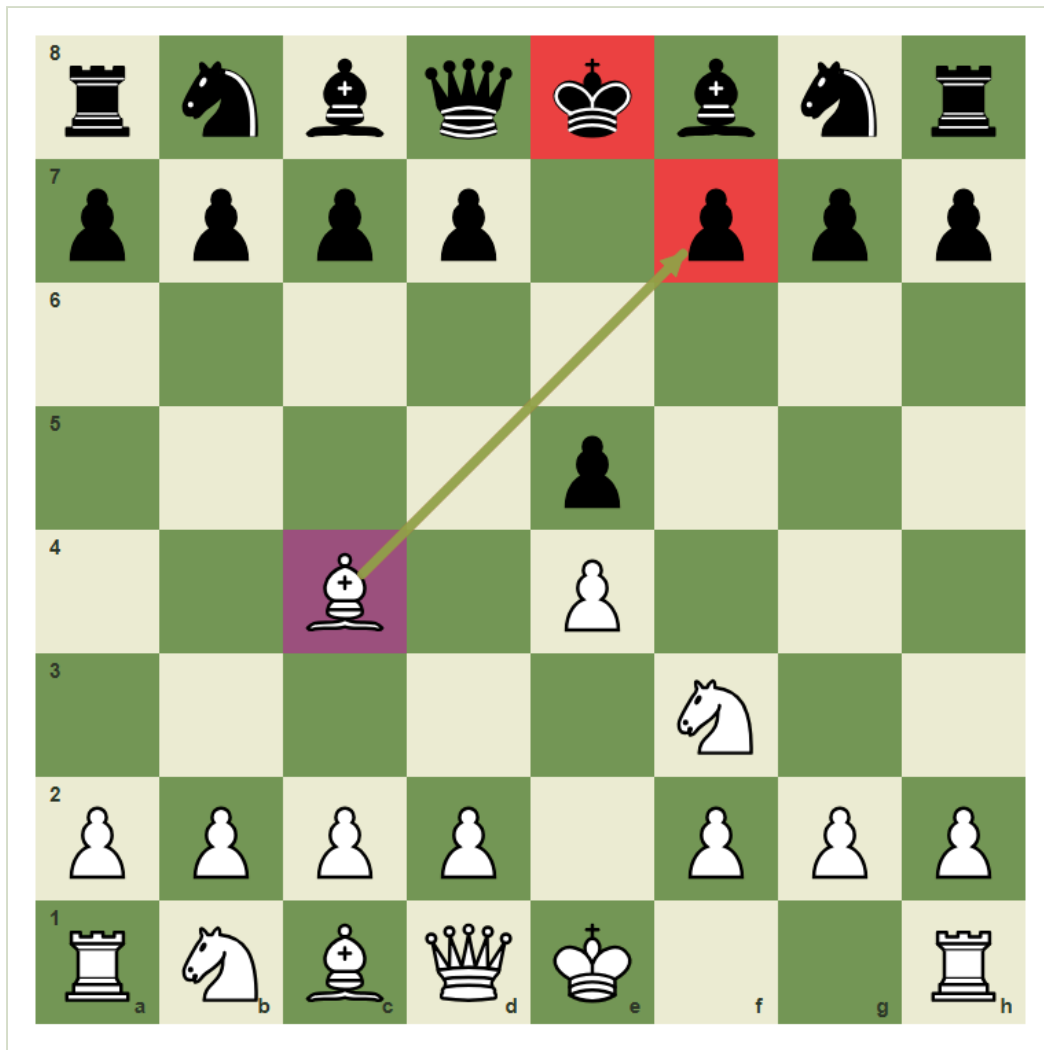
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

First Ten-Move Plans Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **first ten-move plans**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

First Ten-Move Plans Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **first ten-move plans**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

First Ten-Move Plans Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **first ten-move plans**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opening Checkpoint Games

Opening Habits For Real Games | 900-1200 | silver

Opening Checkpoint Games converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

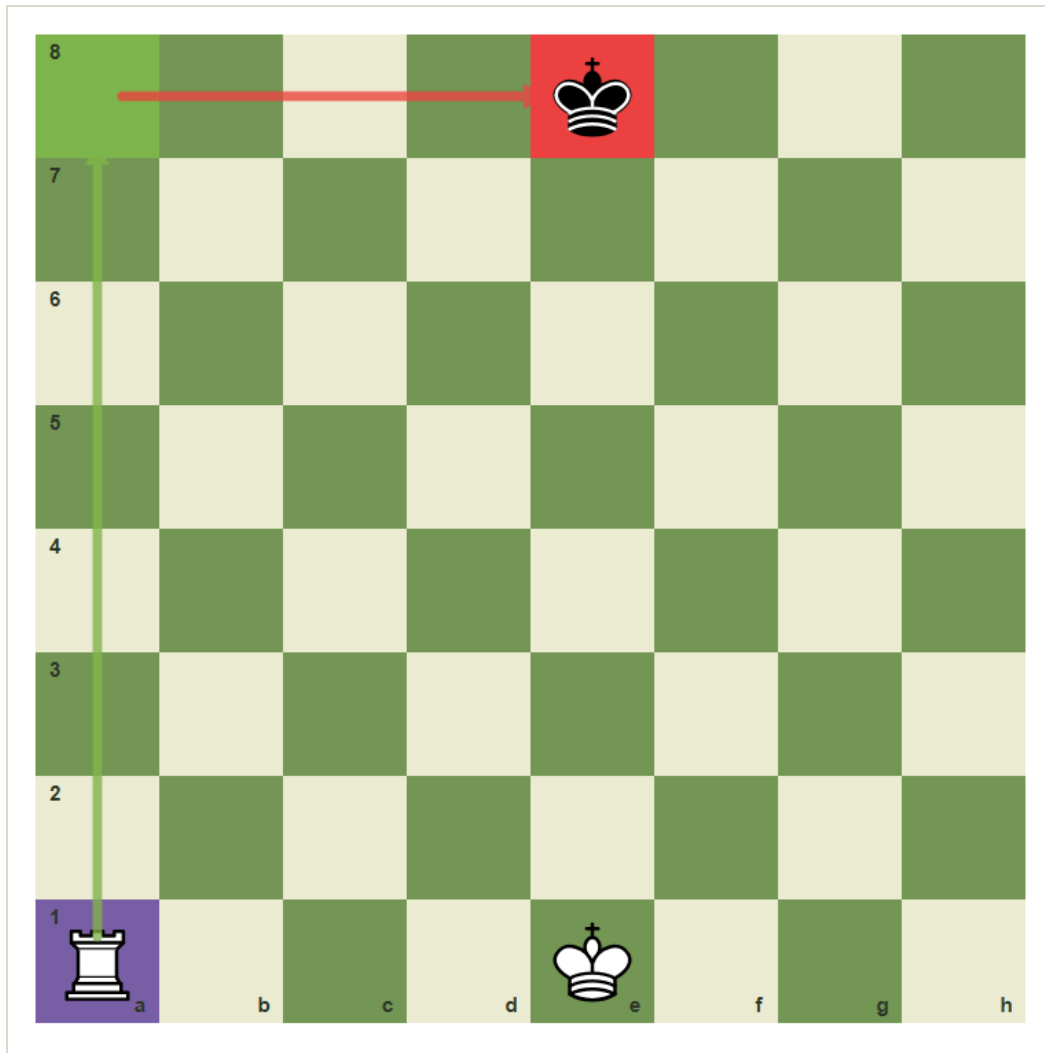
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for opening checkpoint games.
- Choose a move or plan that fits opening checkpoint games.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with opening checkpoint games.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

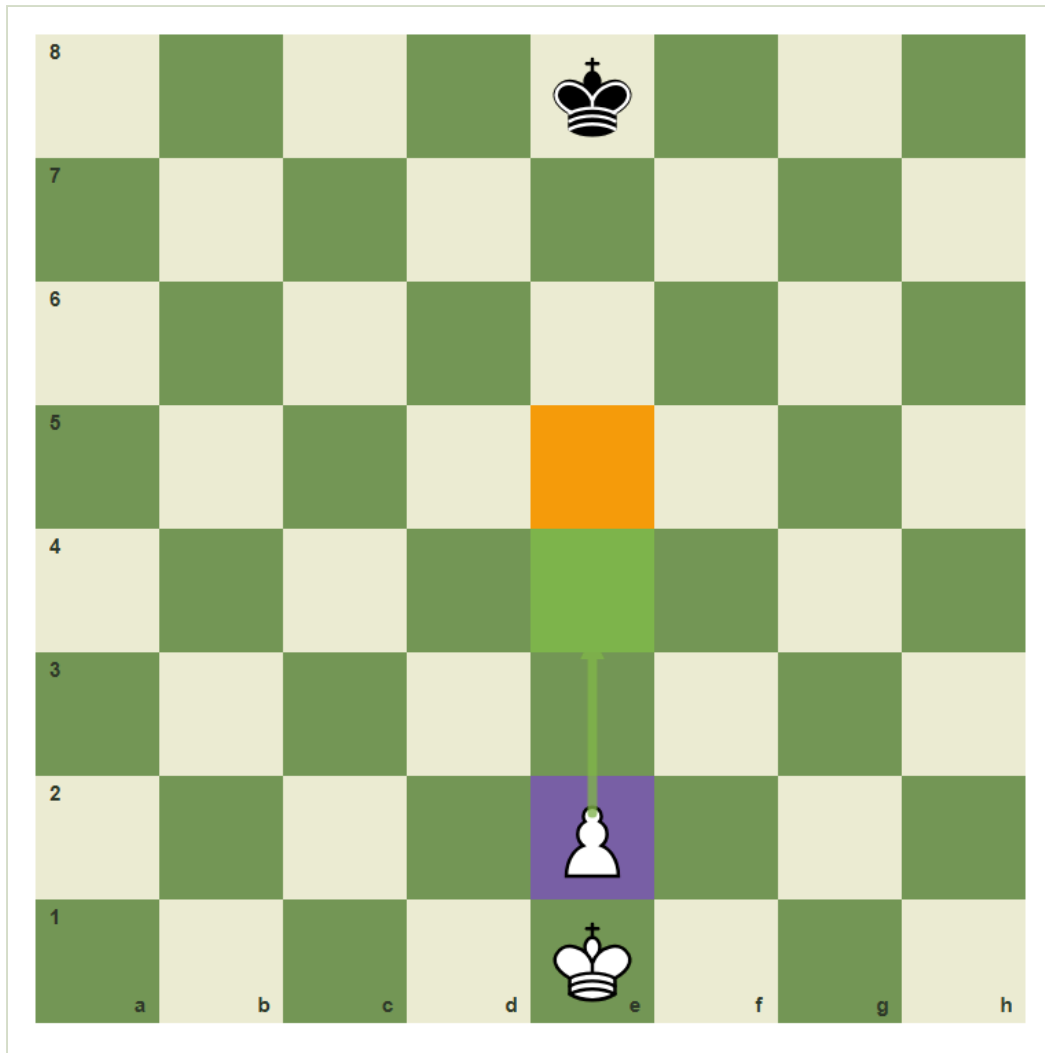
Opening Checkpoint Games is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

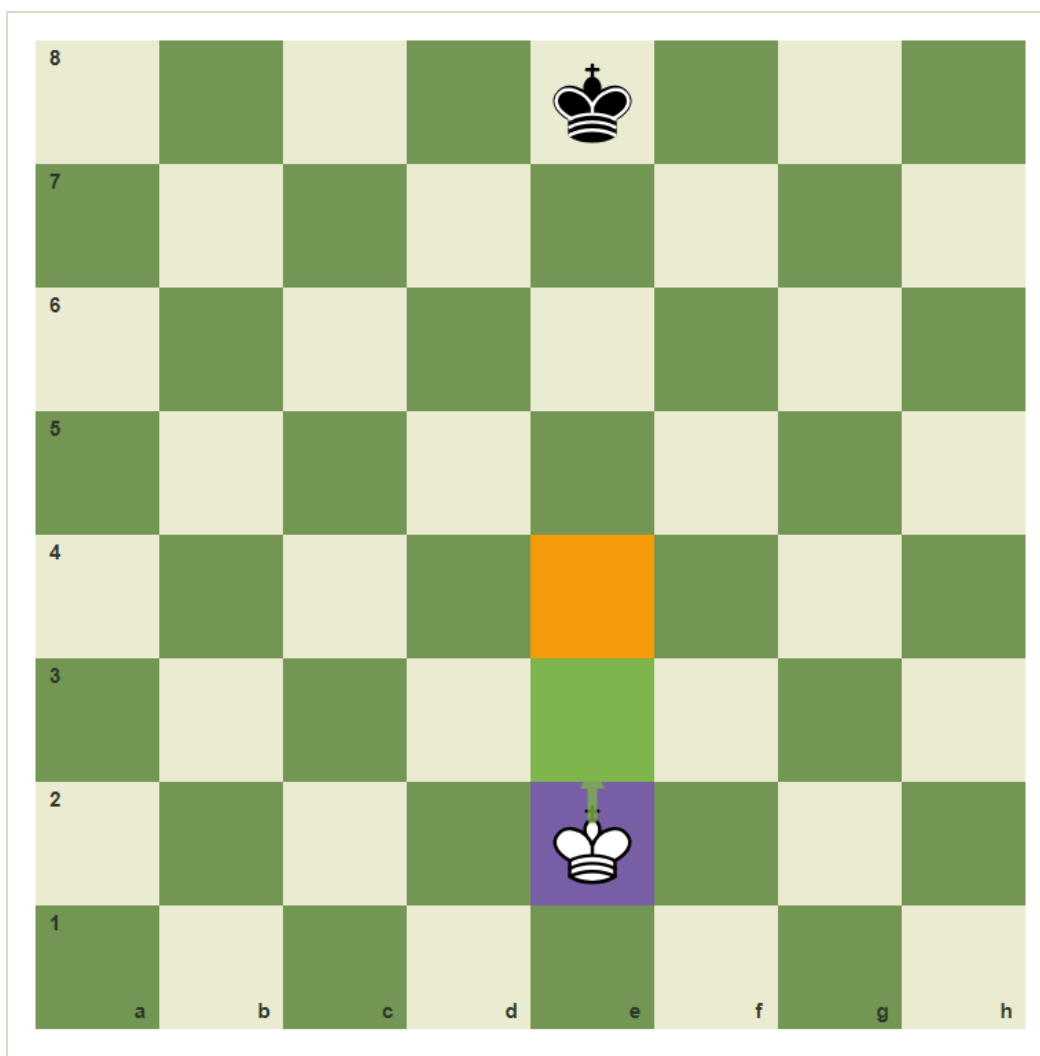


In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

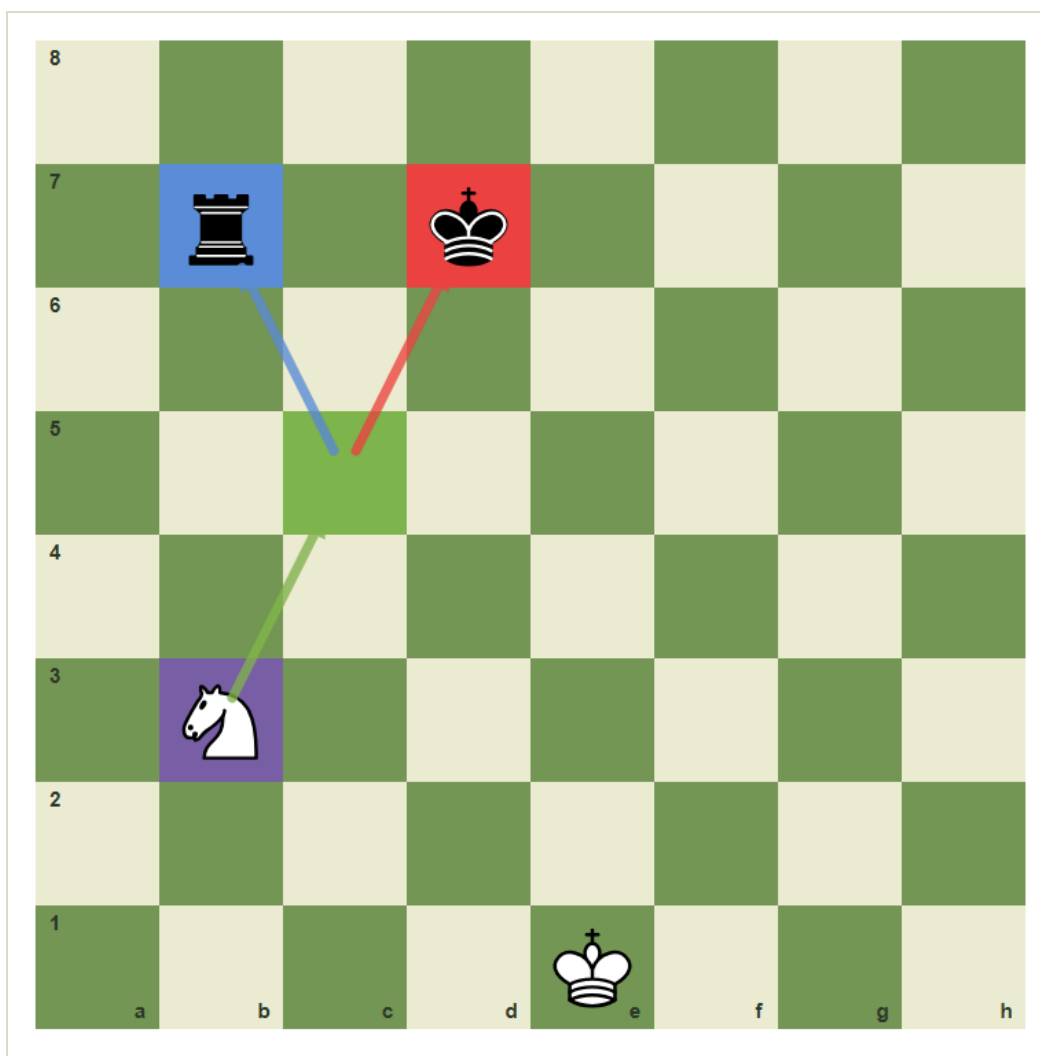
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



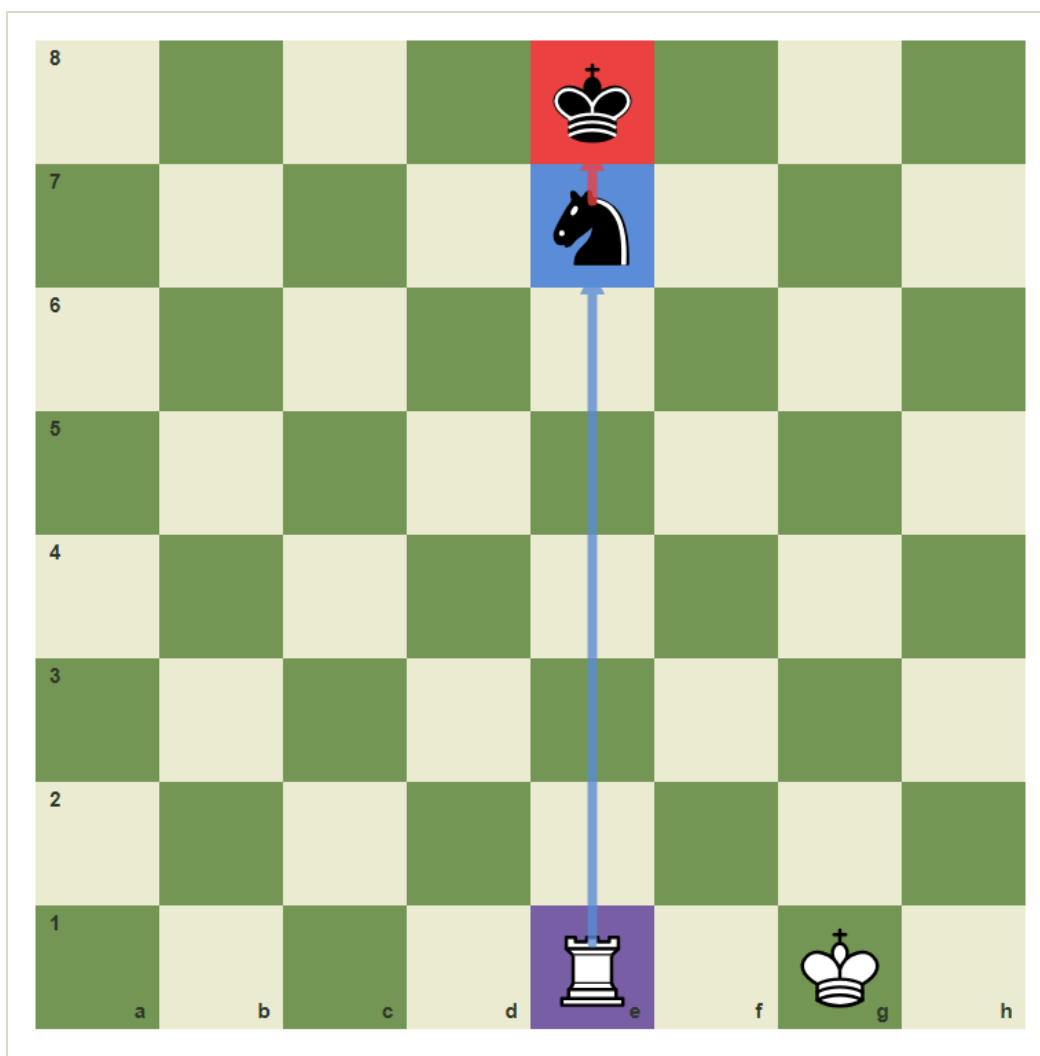
Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

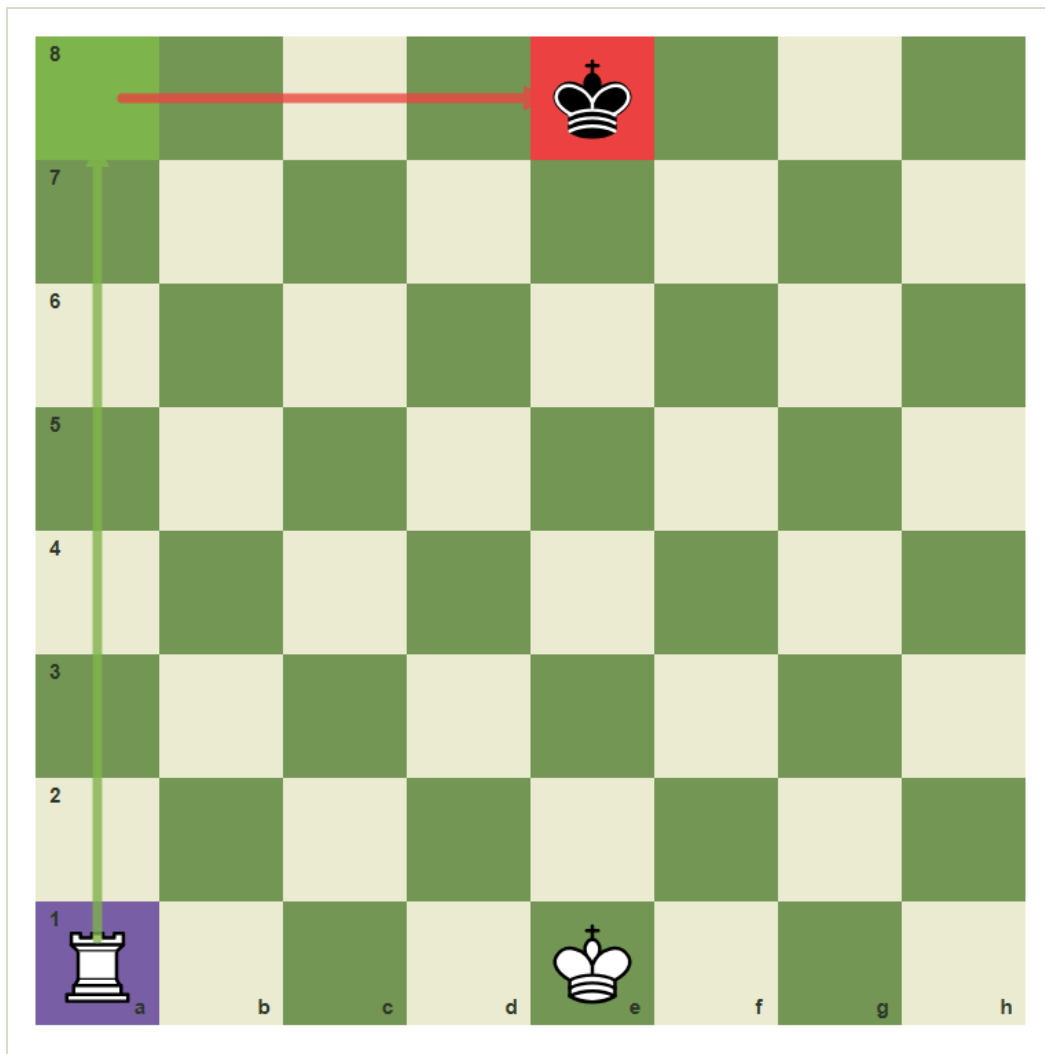
Training Diagram: review position



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

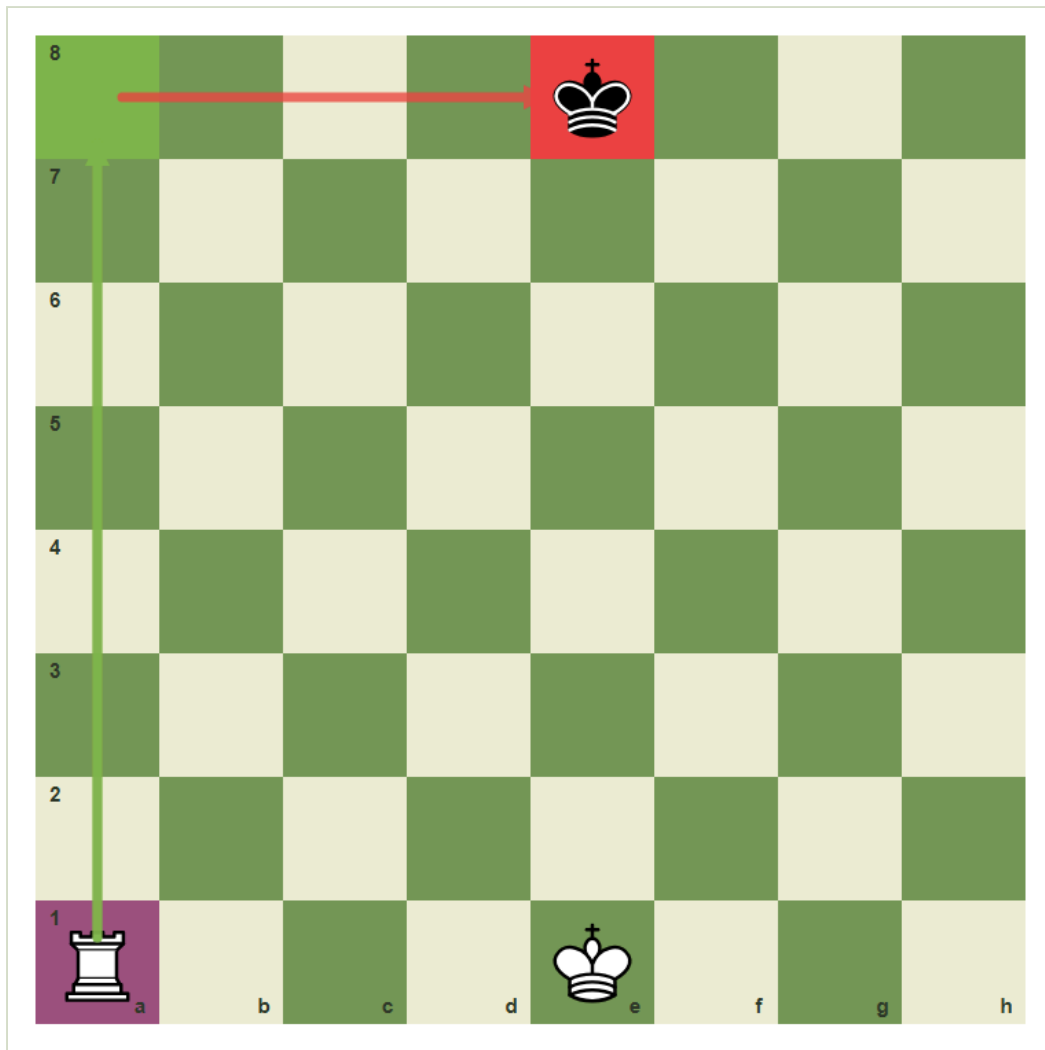
Play the highlighted move from **a1** to **a8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Opening Checkpoint Games Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **opening checkpoint games**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opening Checkpoint Games Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **opening checkpoint games**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opening Checkpoint Games Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **opening checkpoint games**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.